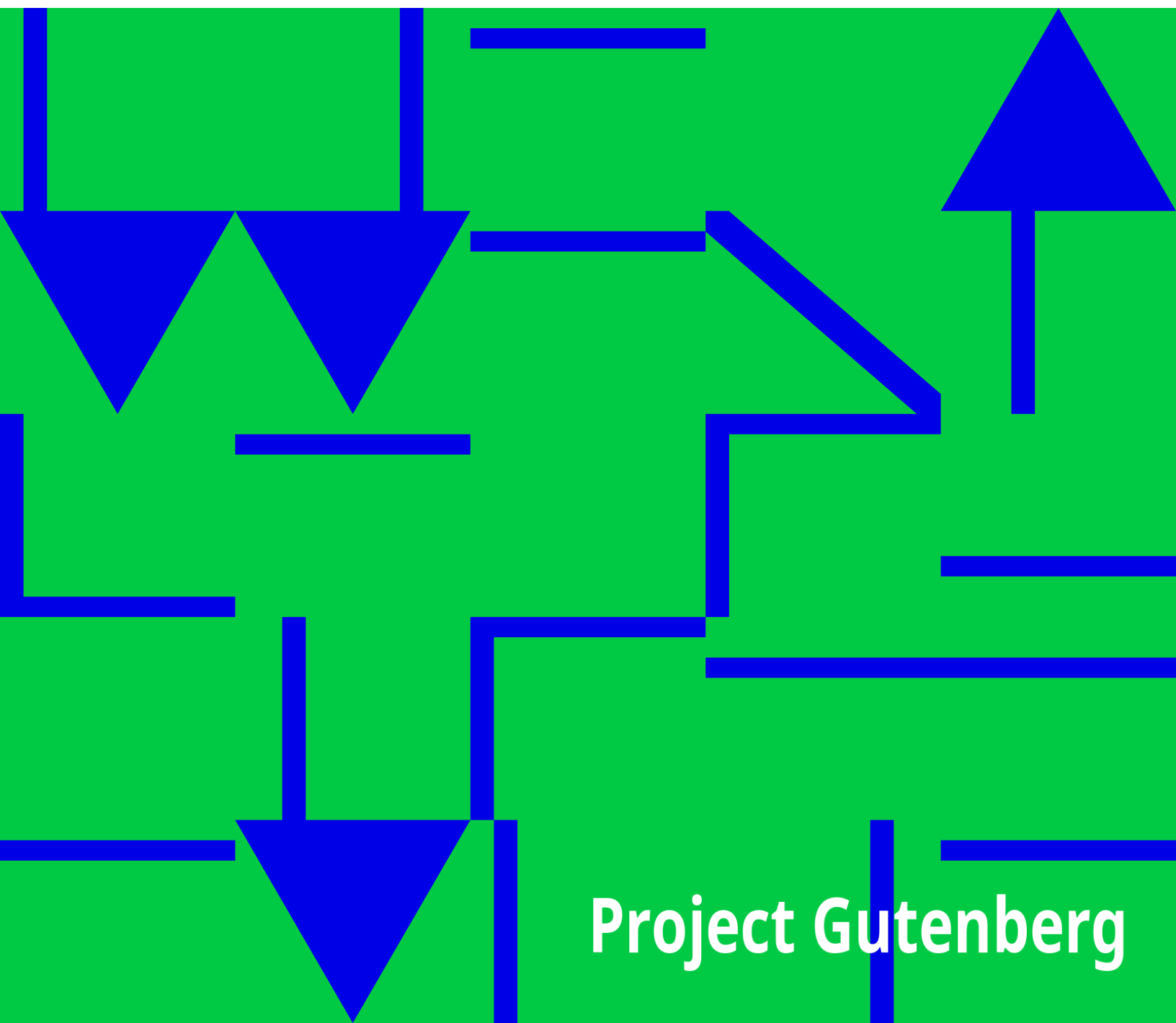


The Assemble of Goddes

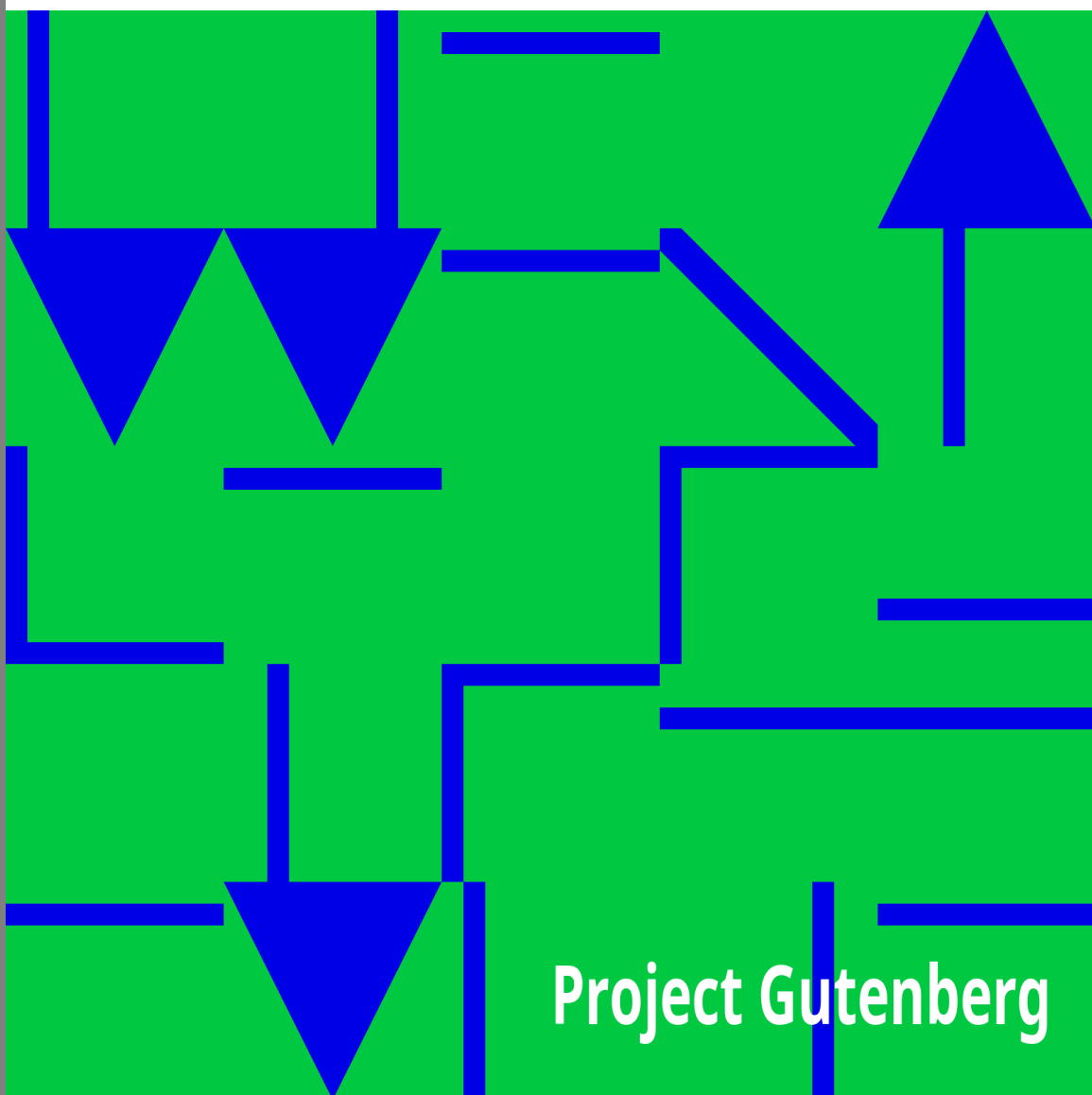
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The Assemble of Goddes

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Title: The Assemble of Goddes

Author: Anonymous

Release date: February 21, 2007 [eBook #20642]

Language: English

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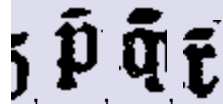
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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE ASSEMBLE
OF GODDES ***

r's note: Until recently this work was attributed to John Lydgate, but now most scholars at the author is unknown. The first mention of Lydgate's authorship of this work was ephen Hawes in 1505 as one of Lydgate's seven major works. But many scholars have er the years that this poem was written by Lydgate, because the style used doesn't mble the style of Lydgate's other works, and the vocabulary is somewhat more modern

he is known to have used. Modern scholars believe that this work was written between 1483 (about forty years after Lydgate's death). Analysis of style and vocabulary have led to conclude that the author might have been a woman. For further information about this work see *The Assembly of Gods*, edited by Jane Chance, published by Medieval Institute Press, Kalamazoo, Michigan, 1999, ISBN: 1580440223, which is also available online at [University of Michigan](#).

The form from which this e-book was transcribed is a facsimile reprint of the third printing of this work by Wynkyn de Worde circa 1500. The book was printed in blackletter font known as Wynkyn de Worde's type 3, and uses many abbreviations, which I have expanded and rendered in the following table. Abbreviations used in this book are:



—Macron over the letter. The most common one, usually meaning missing "n" or "m" after the letter. But in some cases might also mean missing "e", "er" or "re" after the letter. This happens usually when p, q or r have macrons.

—Little e over Middle-English thorn, meaning "the."

—Little t over Middle-English thorn, meaning "that."

—Little u over Middle-English thorn, meaning "thou."

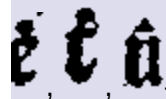
—Little t over w, meaning "with."

—Middle-English yogh, representing "gh."

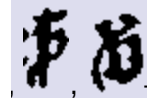
—Superscripted 9 after letter, meaning missing "us." Used only at the end of the word.

—Superscripted 2 after letter, meaning missing "e", "er" or "re." Used only at the end of the word.

—Stretched s, looking like integral sign, meaning missing "e" or "i" before letter s.



—Dot over the letter, meaning missing "e", "er" or "re" after the letter. Usually used with d, t, e and u. Combination q+d with dot means "quod."



—Strike through letter, meaning missing "e", "er" or "re" after the letter. Usually used with p, v and s. Striked through p might also mean missing "ro" or "or" after p.

y there were some letters printed upside down. I have rendered them inside brackets, ie poem uses two types of punctuation--a dot, meaning longer pause, and a slash, orter pause or comma. I have corrected many errors and noted them. Also this printing g three lines and one line had several letters missing from the middle of the line. They and the correct reading is supplied from the modern edition mentioned above. There ole of places where the word "nota" or "note" was printed, but the actual notes weren't s reprint. There's a fair chance that those notes were never printed. The original page displayed on the left margin and each links to a larger view.

The assemble of goddes

by

John Lydgate

Printed at Westminster
by Wynkyn de Worde about the year
1500

Cambridge
at the University Press
1906

reprinted formed part of the famous volume of black-letter tracts (formerly
l. 58), which came to the University Library in 1715 by the gift of King
st with the rest of the library of John Moore, Bishop of Ely. No other copy of
recorded to be in existence.

l are Caxton's type 3 (for the title) and Wynkyn de Worde's type 3, with final
rom type 1 (in the rest of the book). This type 3 is not known to have been
.99.

arks that the woodcut illustration is taken from Caxton's second edition (ab.
aucer's Canterbury Tales.

FRANCIS JENKINSON

ch 5.

l have printed 250 copies only of this facsimile, that the impressions have
ff the plates and the negatives destroyed.

P. DUJARDIN

Here foloweth the Interpretacoin of the names
of goddes and goddesses as is reherced
in this tretise folowyng as Poetes wryte



¶ Phebus is as moche to saye as the Sonne.
 ¶ Apollo is the same or elles God of syght.
 ¶ Morpleus Shewer of dremis
 ¶ Pluto God of hell.
 ¶ Mynos Iuge of hell.
 ¶ Cerberus Porter of hell.
 ¶ Colus the wynde or God of the Eyre.
 ¶ Dyana Goddesses of wode and chase.
 ¶ Phebe the Mone or Goddesses of waters.
 Aurora Goddesses of *the* morow or spryng of *the* daye
 ¶ Mars God of batyll

¶ Iupiter	God of wysdom.
¶ Iuno	Goddesse of rychesse
¶ Saturne	God of colde.
¶ Ceres	Goddesse of corne.
¶ Cupydo	God of loue.
¶ Othea	Goddesse of wysdome.
¶ Fortune	The varyant Goddesse
¶ Pan	God shepherdes.
¶ Isys	Goddesse of frute.
¶ Neptunus	God of the se.
¶ Mynerue	Goddess of <i>the</i> batail or of heruest
¶ Bachus	God of wyne.
¶ Mercuryus	God of langage.
¶ Venus	Goddesse of loue.
¶ Dyscorde	Goddess of debate & stryffe
¶ Attropos	Dethe
¶ Here endeth <i>the</i> interpretacyon of the names of Goddess & Goddesses as is reherced in the treatyse folowyng as poetes wryte.	



han Phebus the crabbe had nere his cours ronne
And toward *the* Leon his Iourney gan take
To loke on Pythagoras spere / I had begonne
¶ Syttyng all solytary allone besyde a lake.
¶ Musyng on a maner how *that* I myght make.
¶ Reason and sensualityte in one to accorde.
¶ But I coude not bryng about *the* manacorde.

¶ For longe er I myght slepe me gan oppres
¶ So ponderously I coud make none obstacle
¶ In myne hede was fall suche an heuinesse.
¶ I was fayne to drawe to myne habytacle.
¶ To rowne *with* a pylow me semyd best tryacle.
¶ So leyde I me downe my dysease to releue.
¶ Anone cam in Morpleus & toke me by *the* sleue

¶ And as I soo laye halfe in a traunse
¶ Twene slepyng & wakyng he bad me aryse.
¶ For he sayd I must yeue attendaunce.
¶ To the grete Courte of Mynes the Iustyse.
¶ Me nought auayled ayene hym to sylogyse.
¶ For hit is oft sayd by hem that yet lyues.
¶ He must nedes go that the deuell dryues.

¶ Whan I see noo better but I must go.
¶ I sayd I was redy at his commaundement.
¶ Wheder that he wolde me lede to or fro.
¶ Soo vp I arose and forth with hym went.
¶ Tyll he had me brought to the parlament.
¶ Where Pluto sate and kepte is estate.
¶ And with hym Mynos the Iuge desperate.

¶ But as we thyderwarde went by the way.
¶ I hym besought his name me to tell.
¶ Morpleus he sayde thou me call may.
¶ A syr sayde I than where do ye dwell.
¶ In heuen or in erthe eyther elles in hell.
¶ Nay he sayde myn abydyng most commonly
¶ Is in a lytyll corner called fantasy.

¶ And as sone as he thyse wordes had sayd.
¶ Cerberus the porter of hell *with* his cheyne.
¶ Brought theder Colus *in* ragges euyll arayd
¶ Agayn whom Neptunus & Dyana dyd compleynt
¶ Saynge thus O Mynos *thou* Iuge souerayn.
¶ Gyue thy cruel iugement *ayen* this traytour so
¶ *That* we may haue cause to preyse thy lord Pluto

¶ Then was there made a proclamacyon.
¶ In Plutoos name commaunded scylence.
¶ Vpon the payn of strayt correccyon.
¶ *That* Dyana & Neptunus might haue audience.
¶ To declare her grefe of the grete offence.
¶ To hem do by Colus wheron they compleined

¶ And to begyn Dyana was constreyned.

¶ Whyche thus begyn as ye shall here.

¶ Saynge in this wyse. O thou lorde Pluto.

¶ Wyth thy iuge Mynos syttyng *with* the in fere

¶ Execute your fury vpon Colus soo.

¶ Accordyng to thofence that he to me hath do

¶ That I haue no cause forther to appele.

¶ Whyche yf I do shall not be for youre wele.

¶ Remembre fyrst how I a goddesse pure.

¶ Ouer all desertes / forestes and chaces.

¶ Haue the guydyng and vnder my cure.

¶ This traytour colus hath mani of mi places

¶ Destroyd *with* his blastes & daily me manaces

¶ Where ony wood is he shall make it playne.

¶ If he to his lyberte may resorte ageyne

¶ The gretest trees that ony man may fynde

¶ In forest to shade the dere for her comforte.

¶ He breketh hem asonder or rendith he rote & rinde

¶ Out of the erthe this is his dysporte.

¶ So that the deere shall haue noo resorte.

¶ Wythin shorte tyme to noo maner shade

¶ Where thorough the game is lykly to fade.

¶ Which to my name a reproche synguler.

¶ Sholde be foreuer whyle the worlde laste.

¶ And to all the goddes an hygh dyspleyser.

¶ To see the game soo destroyed by his blaste.

¶ Wherefore a remedy puruey in haste.

¶ And lete hym be punysshed after his offence.

¶ Cousyder the cryme and yeue your sentence.

¶ And whan Dyana had made her compleynt

¶ To mynos the Iuge in Plutoos presence.

¶ Came forth Neptunus *with* vysage pale & feynt

¶ Desyrynge of fauour to haue audyence.

¶ Saynge thus Pluto to thy magnyfycence.
¶ I shall reherce what this creature.
¶ Colus hath done me out of mesure.

¶ Thou knowest well that I haue the charge
¶ Ouer all the se and therof god I am.
¶ No shyp may sayl Keruel / bote ne barge.
¶ Grete karyk nor hulke *with* ony lyuyng man.
¶ But he haue my saue conduyte than.
¶ who me offendith wythin my Iurysdyccyon
¶ Owyth to submyt him to my correccyon.

¶ But in asmoche as it is now soo.
¶ That ye hym here haue as your prysonere
¶ I shall shew my compleynt soo.
¶ wherfore I pray you that ye wyll here.
¶ And let hym not escape out of your daungere.
¶ Tyl he haue made full sethe & recompence
¶ For hurt of my name thugh his grete offence

¶ Fyrst to begyn this Colus hath ofte.
¶ Made me to retorne mi course agein nature.
¶ wyth his grete blastes whan he hath be alofte
¶ And charged me to labour fer out of mesure
¶ *that* it was grete merueyl how I might endure
¶ The com of my swete wyll testyfy.
¶ That on the se bankes lye beten full hye.

¶ Secundly where my nature is.
¶ Both to eb & flowe a[n]d so thy course to kepe.
¶ Ofte of myne entent hath he made me mys
¶ where as I shulde haue fylled dykes depe.
¶ At a full water I myght not theder crepe.
¶ Before my season came to retorne ageyn.
¶ And than went I faster than i wold certayn

¶ Thus he hath me dryuen ayen myn entente
¶ And contrary to my course naturall.

¶ where I shuld haue be he made me absente
¶ To my grete dyshonour & in especyall.
¶ Do thyng he vsed that worst was of all.
¶ For where I my sauegard graunted
¶ Ay in that coste he comonly haunted

¶ Of very pure malyce and sylfwyll.
¶ Theym to destroy in dyspyte of me.
¶ To whome I promised both in gode & yll.
¶ For to be her protectour in all aduersyte.
¶ That to theym shulde fall vpon the se.
¶ And euen sodenly or they coud beware
¶ wyth a sodeyn pyry he lapped theym in care.

¶ And full oft syth wyth hys boystous blaste.
¶ Or they myght be ware he drof hem on *the* sond
¶ And other whyle he brake top sayl & maste.
¶ which caused them to peryssh or thei cam to lond
¶ Then cursed they the tyme *that* euer thei me fand
¶ Thus amonge the people lost is my name.
¶ And so by his labour put I am to blame.

¶ Consyder this mater and ponder my case.
¶ Tender my compleynt as rygure requyreth
¶ Shew forth youre sentence with a breief clause
¶ I may not longe tary the tyme fast expyreth
¶ The offence is grete wherfore it desyreth.
¶ The more greuous payn and hasty iugement
¶ For offence don wylfully wyl non auysement

And whan *the* god pluto a whyl had him bethought
¶ He rowned *with* mynos what was to do.
¶ Then he sayde openly loke thou fayl nought
¶ Thy sentence to yeue wythoute fauoore soo.
¶ Lyke as thou hast herde the causes the too.
¶ And so euenly dele twene thise partyey twein
¶ That none of hem haue case on *the* other compleint

¶ Thenne sayd mynos full indyfferently.
¶ To Dyana & Neptunus is there ony more.
¶ That ye wyll declare ageyn hym openly.
¶ Nay in dede they sayd we kepe none in store /
¶ we haue sayd Inough to punyssh hym fore
¶ If ye in this mater be not parcyall·
¶ Remembre your name was wont to be egall.

¶ Well than sayd Mynos now let vs see.
¶ what this boystous Colus for hymself cay say
¶ For here Prima facie to vs doth appere.
¶ That he hath offended no man can say naye
¶ wherfore thou Colus wythoute more delaye
¶ Shape vs an answeare to thyne accusemente
¶ And elles I must procede vpon thy iugement

¶ And euen as colus was onward to haue said
¶ For his excuse / came in a messengere.
¶ Fro god Appolo to Pluto and hym prayde.
¶ On his behalfe that he wythoute daungere
¶ wolde to hym come & brynge wyth hym in fere
¶ Dyana and Neptunus vnto his banket
¶ And yf they dysdeyned hymself he wold hem fet.

¶ Moreouer he sayde to god Appolo
¶ Desyred to haue respyte of the iugemente
¶ Of Colus bothe of Mynos and Pluto
¶ So Dyana & Neptunus were therewith content
¶ And yf they were dysposed to assente
¶ That he myght come vnto his presente
¶ He it desyred to knowe his offence

¶ What say ye herto sayd Pluto to hem tweyn
¶ wyll ye both assente that it shal be thus
¶ ye sayd the goddesse for my parte certeyne
¶ And I also sayd this Neptunus
¶ I am well plesid quod this Colus
¶ And whan they had a whyle thus togyder spoke

¶ Pluto commaunded the court to be broke

¶ And than togeder went they in fere.

¶ Pluto and Neptunus ledynge the goddesse

¶ whome folowed Cerberus *with* his prysonere.

¶ And alderlast wyth grete heuynesse.

¶ Came I and Morpleus to the forteresse.

¶ Of the god appolo vnto his banket.

¶ where many goddes and goddesses met.

¶ Whan Appolo se that they were come.

¶ He was ryght glad & prayed theym to syt.

¶ Nay sayd Dyana this is all and some.

¶ ye shall me pardone I shall not syt yet.

¶ I shall fyrste know why Colus abyde.

¶ And what execucion shall on hym be doo

¶ For his offence / well sayd Appollo.

¶ Madame ye shall haue all your plesere.

¶ Syth that it wyll none otherwyse be.

¶ But fyste I pray you let me *the* mater here

¶ why he is brought in this perplexyte.

¶ well sayd Pluto that shall ye sone se.

¶ And gan to declare euen by and by.

¶ Bothe theyr complayntes ordynatly.

¶ And whan Appolo had herd the reporte

¶ Of Pluto in a maner smyllynge he sayd.

¶ I se well Colus thou hast small comforte.

¶ Thy selfe to excuse thou mayst be dysmayde.

¶ For to here so grete compleyntes ayen the layd

¶ And notwythstondyng if thou can say ought

¶ For thyne own wele say and tary nought

¶ Nota

¶ Forsoth sayd Colus yf I had respyte.

¶ Hereto an answere coud I counterfete.

¶ But to haue her grace more is my delyte.
¶ wherfore I pray you all for me entrete.
That I may by your request her gode grace gete
¶ And what payn or greef ye for me prouyde
¶ wythout ony grutchyng I shall it abyde.

¶ Lo good dame sayd god Appollo.
¶ what may he do more but sew to your grace.
¶ Beholde how the teres from his eyen goo.
¶ It is satysfaction half for his trespase.
¶ Now glorious goddes shew your petious face
¶ To this pore prysoner at my request.
¶ All we for youre honour thynke thus is best.

¶ And yf it lyke you to do in thys wyse.
¶ And so to foryeue hym clerely his offence.
¶ One thyng surely I wyll you promyse.
¶ If he ought rebell and make resystence
¶ Or dysobey vnto your sentence.
¶ For euery tree that he maketh fall.
¶ Out of the erthe an /C/ ryse shall.

¶ Soo that youre game shall not dyscrease
¶ For lacke of shade i dare vndertake
¶ well syr Appollo sayd she than wyll I cease
¶ Off all my rancour and mercy *with* you make
¶ And than god Neptunus of his maner spak
¶ Saying thus appollo though dyana him relese
¶ yet shall he sue to me to haue his pease.

¶ A sayd Appollo ye wende I had forgete.
¶ You for my lady Dyana the goddesse.
¶ Nay thynke not so for I wyll you entrete.
¶ As well as her wythoute longe processe.
¶ wyll ye agre that Phebus your maystresse.
¶ May haue the guydyng of your varyaunce.
¶ I shall abyde quod he / her ordynaunce.

¶ Wel than quod appolo I pray you goddis all
¶ And goddesses that ben here presente.
¶ That ye companable wyll aborde falle.
¶ Nay than sayd Othea it is not conuenyente.
¶ A dew ordre in euery place is expedyente.
¶ To be hadde wherfore ye may not lette.
¶ To be your own marshal at your own banket

¶ And whan appolo se it wolde none other be
¶ He called to hym Aurora the goddessse.
¶ And sayd though ye wepe ye shall before me.
¶ Ay kepe your course and put yourself in presse
¶ Soo he her set fyrste at his owne messe.
¶ wyth her moyst clothes *with* teres all be spreynt
¶ The medewes in may shew therof her compleint

¶ Next her sat Mars myghty god and strong
¶ wyth a flamme of fyre enuyroned all about
¶ A crown of yron on his hede a spere *in* his hond
¶ It semed by his chere as he wold haue fought.
¶ And next vnto hym as I perceyue mought.
¶ Sat *the* goddessse Dyana in a mantell fyne.
¶ Of black sylke purfyled *with* poudred ermine

¶ Lyke as he had take *the* mantell & the rynge
¶ And next vnto her arayed roally.
¶ Sat the god Iupyer in his demenyng.
¶ Full sad and wyse he semed sykerly.
¶ A crowne of tynne stood on his hede.
¶ And that I recorde of all phylosophers.
¶ *that* lytyll store of Coyne kepe in her cofres.

¶ Ioyned to hym in syttyng next there was
¶ The goddessse Iuno full rychely besene.
¶ In a sercote *that* shone as bryght as glas
¶ Of goldsmyth werk *with* spangles wrought bedene
¶ Of royall ryches wanted she none I wene.
¶ And next to her sat the god saturne.

¶ That oft syth causeth many one to morne.

¶ But he was clad me thought straungely
¶ For of froste & snowe was all his aray.
¶ In his honde he helde a fawchon all bloody
¶ It semed by his chere as he wold make a frai
¶ A baudryck of Isykles about his necke gaye
¶ He had and aboue on hygh on his hede.
¶ Couchid *with* hayl stones he wered a croun of lede

¶ And nexte in ordre was set by his syde.
¶ Ceres the goddesse in a garmente.
¶ Of sacke cloth made *with* sleues large & wyde
¶ Embrowdered wyth sheues and sycles bent
¶ Of all maner greynes she sealed *the* patente.
¶ In token *that* she was goddes of corne.
¶ Olde Poetes saye she beryth the heruest horn

¶ Then was there set the god cupydo.
¶ All fresshe & galaunte and costly in aray.
¶ Wyth ouches and rynges he was beset so.
¶ *the* paleys therof shon as though it had be day
¶ A kerchyff of plesauns stood ouer his helm ay
¶ The goddesse Ceres he loked in the face.
¶ And wyth one arme he her dyde enbrace.

¶ Next to Cupido in order by and by
¶ Of wordly wysdum sat the forteresse.
¶ Called Othea chyef grounde of polycy.
¶ Reuler of knyghthode of prudence *the* goddes
¶ Clad all in purpure was she more & lesse.
¶ Saaf on her hede a crowne there stode.
¶ Couched wyth perles oryent fyne & good.

¶ And nexte to her was god Pluto set
¶ Wyth a derke myste enuyrond al about.
¶ His clothy was made of a smoky net.
¶ His colour was bothe wythin & wythoute.

¶ Foule / derke & dymme his eyen grete & stoute.
¶ Of fyre & sulfure all his odoure wase.
¶ That wo was me whyle I beheld his face

¶ Fortune the goddesse *with* her perty face.
¶ Was vnto Pluto next in order sette.
¶ Varyant she was ay in shorte space.
¶ Her whele was redy to turne wythout let.
¶ Her gowne was of gawdy grene clamelet.
¶ Chaungeable of sondry dyuerse colours.
¶ To *the* condycyons accordyng to her shoures

¶ And by her sat thoughe he vnworthy were.
¶ The rewde god Pan of shepherdes *that* gyde
¶ Clad in russet frese & breched lyke a bere.
¶ Wyth a grete terbox hangyng by his syde.
¶ A shepcrok in his hond he spared for no pryde.
¶ And by his fete lay a prekered curre.
¶ He rateled in *the* throte as he had *the* murre.

¶ Isys the goddes bare hym company.
¶ For at the table next she sat by his syde.
¶ In a close kyrtell embrowdered curiously
¶ *with* braunches and leues brood large & wyde.
¶ Grene as any grasse in *the* somer tyde.
¶ Of all maner frute she had the gouernaunce
¶ Of fauours odyferous was her sustynauns

¶ Next to her than was god Neptunus set.
¶ He sauoured lyke a fyssher of hym i spak before
¶ It semed by his clothes as they had be wet.
About hym in his gyrdelsted hing fysshes mani a xx
¶ Of his straunge aray merueyled I sore.
¶ A shyp wyth a top and sayle was hys creste.
¶ Me thought he was gayly dysgysed at *the* fest.

¶ Than toke mynerue the goddes her sete.
¶ Ioyntly to Neptunus all in curas cladde.

¶ Gauntelettis on hondes & sabatouns on her fete
¶ She loked about as though she had be mad.
¶ An hamer and a sythe on her hede she hadde
¶ She wered two bokelers one by her syde.
¶ that other ye wote were this was al her prid

¶ Than cam *the* god bachus & by her set hym doun
¶ Holdynge in his honde a cuppe full of wyne.
¶ Of grene vyne leues he wered a Ioly croun
¶ He was clad in clustres of grapes gode & fine
¶ A garlonde of yuy he chose for his sygne.
¶ On his hede he had a thredbare kendall hode.
¶ A gymlot and a fauset therupon stode.

¶ Next hym sat phebus wyth her colour pale.
¶ Fat she was of face but of complexon feynte.
She sayd she rewled Neptunus & made hym bayl
¶ And ones in *the* monthe *with* phebus was she meint
¶ Also ne were she Ceres were ateynte
¶ Thus she sat & tolde the myght of her nature
¶ & on her hede she wered a croun of siluer pure

¶ Ioyntly to her Marcurys toke his see.
¶ As came to his cours wytnesse the zodyake.
¶ He had a gylden tonge as fyll for his degree
¶ In eloquence of langage he passed al *the* pake
¶ For in his talkyng no man coud fynde lake
¶ A box wyth quycksyluer he had in his honde /
¶ Multyplyers know it wel in euery londe

¶ By hym sat dame Venus *with* colour crystalline
¶ Whos long here shone as wyre of gold bryght
¶ Cryspe was her skyn her eyen columbyne
¶ Rauysshed myne herte her chere was so lyght
¶ Patrones of plesaunce be named wel she myght
¶ A smocke was her wede garnysshed curyusli
¶ But all other she had a wanton eye

¶ On her hede she wered a red coper crowne
¶ A nosegay she had made ful plesauntly
¶ Bytwene her & aurora Apollo set hym doune
¶ Wyth his beames bryght he shone so feruently
¶ That he therwyth gladyd al *the* company
¶ A crown of pure gold was on his hede set
¶ In syne *that* he was mayster & lorde of *that* banket

¶ Nota

¶ Thus was the table set round aboute
¶ Wyth goddes & goddesses as i haue you told
¶ Awaytyng on the bord was a grete route
¶ Of sage phylosophers & poetes many fold
¶ There was sad Sychero & Arystotle olde
¶ Tholome Dorothe wyth Dyogenes
¶ Plato Myssehala and wyse Socrates

¶ Sortes & Saph[y]rus *with* hermes stode behynd
¶ Auycen & Aueroyes wyth hem were in fere
¶ Galyen & ypocras that physyk haue in mynd
¶ wyth help of Esculapyon toward hem drow ner
¶ Vyrghyle Orace Ouyd and Omere
¶ Euclide and albert yaue her attendaunce
¶ To do the godds & goddesses plesaunce

¶ Horeberded Orpheus was there *with* his harpe.
¶ And as a poyt musycal made he melody
Other minstral had ther non saf Pan *gan* to carpe
¶ Of his leud bagpyp which caused *the* compani
¶ To law yet many mo ther *were* yf i shuld not ly
¶ Som yong som old both better and werse
¶ But mo of theyr names can I not reherce

¶ Of al maner deyntes there was habundaunce
¶ Of metes & drynkes foyson plenteuous
¶ In cam Dyscord to haue varyaunce
¶ But there was no roum to set her *in* that hous
¶ The goddis remembred the scysme odious

¶ Among the thre goddesses *that* she had wrought
¶ At the fest of Peleus wherfore they thought

¶ They wold not *with* her dele in a venture
¶ Lest she hem brought to som inconuenyente
¶ She seyng this was wroth out of mesure
¶ And in that grete wrath out of *the* paleyse went
¶ Sayng to herself that chere shuld thei repent
¶ And anone *with* Attropes happed she to mete.
¶ As he had ben a gost came in a wyndyng shete

¶ She toke hym by *the* hond & rowned in his ere
¶ And told hym of the banket *that* was so delycate.
How she was receyued & what chere she had *there*
¶ And how euery god sat in his astate
¶ Is it thus *quod* attropos what in *the* deuyls date
¶ Well he sayd I se well how the game goth
¶ Ones yet for your sake shal I make hem wroth

¶ And whan she had hym al togyder told
¶ From her he departed & of her toke his leue /
¶ Sayng *that* for her sake his way take he wolde
¶ In to the paleys his maters to meue
¶ And or he thens went he trowed hem to greue.
¶ Wyth such tydynges as he wold hem tel
¶ So forth he went & spake wordes fell

¶ Whan he came in the *presence* of *the* goddis [a]lle
¶ As he had ben mad he loked hym a bout
¶ His shete from his body downe he let fall
¶ And on a reud maner he saluted al the route
¶ Wyth a bold voys spekyng wordes stoute
¶ But he spake all holow as it had ben one
¶ Had spoke in a nother world *that* had wo begon

¶ He stode forth boldly *with* grym countenaunce
¶ Sayng on this wyse as ye shal here
¶ All ye goddes yeue attendaunce

¶ Vnto my wordes *without* all daungere
¶ Remembre how ye made me your offycere
¶ Al tho wyth my darte fynally to chastyse
¶ That *thou* dysobeyed or wolde your law dyspise

¶ And for the more surete seiled my patent
¶ Gyuynge me full power so to occupy
¶ Wherto I haue employed myn entent
¶ And that can dame Nature testefy
¶ If she be examyned she wyll not it denye
¶ For whan she forsakyth ony creature
¶ I am al redy to take *hym* to my cure

¶ Thus haue I deuly wyth al mi dylygence.
¶ Executed the offyce of olde antyquyte
¶ To me by you graunted by your comyn sentece
¶ For I spared none hygh nor low degre
¶ So that on my parte no faute hath be
¶ For as sone as ony to me commytted was
¶ I smote *hym* to *the* hert he had none other grace

¶ Ector of Troy for al his cheualry
¶ Alexander the grete & myghty conqueroure
¶ Iulys Cezar *with* al his companye
¶ Dauyd nor Iosue nor worthy Artur
¶ Charlis the noble that was so gret of honour
¶ Nor Iudas Machabee for al his trew herte
¶ Nor Godfrey of Boleyn coud me not asterte

¶ Nabugodonozor for al his grete pryde
¶ Nor the kyng of Egypt cruel Pharao
¶ Iason ne Hercules went they neuer so wyde.
¶ Cosdras Hanyball nor gentyll Sypyo·
¶ Cyrus Achylles nor many another mo
¶ For fayr nor foule gat of me no grace
¶ But al be at *the* last I seased hem *with* my mace.

¶ Thus haue I brought euery creature

¶ To an ende both man fysshe foule and best
And euery other thyng in whome dame nature
¶ Hath only Iurysdyccion eyther most or lest
¶ Except oonly one in whome your be hest
¶ Is to me broke for ye me promysed
That my myght of none shold haue be dyspysed

¶ Wherof the contrary daoe I well a uow
¶ Is trew for one there is that wyl not apply
¶ Vnto my correction nor in no wyse bow
¶ To the dynt of my darte for dole nor desteny·
¶ What comfort he hath nor the cause why
¶ That he so rebellyth I can not think of ryght
But yf ye hym graunted your alders saf condyght.

¶ And yf he so haue than do ye not as goddis.
¶ For a goddys wrytyng may not reuersed be.
¶ Yf it shold I wold not gyue you ii pesecoddis
¶ For graunt of your patent of offyce nere of fee.
¶ Wherefore in this mater do me equyte
¶ Accerding to my patent for tyl this be do
¶ Ye haue no more my seruyse nor my gode wyl

¶ And whan al the goddis had attropos hered
¶ As they had ben wode brayd vp attones
¶ & sayd they wold not rest tyll he were conquered
¶ Taken and dystroyed body blode and bones
¶ And that they swere grete othes for *the* nonis
¶ Her lav to dyspyce that was so malapert
¶ They sayd he shuld be taught for to be so pert

¶ Wel sayd Appollo yf he on erth be
¶ wyth my brennyng chare I shall hym confound
¶ In feyth quod neptunus & he kepe these
¶ He may be well sure he shall be drownd
¶ A syr sayd Mars this haue we wel found
¶ That ony dysubeyed oure goodly precept
¶ We may well think we haue to long slept

¶ But neuertheles where I may hym fynd
¶ wyth thunder & lyghtning about I shall hym chase
¶ And I quod Saturnus before and behynd.
¶ *with* my bytte cold shall shew hym harde grace
¶ well sayd Mercuryus yf I may se his face.
¶ For euer of his spech I shall hym depryue
¶ So that hym were better dede than alyue

¶ Ye quod Othea yet may he well be
¶ In the eyr where he wyll & ax you no leue
¶ wherfore my counseyl is that all we
¶ May entrete Neptunus his rancour foryeue.
¶ And than I dout not Colus wyl hym myscheue
¶ So may ye be sure he soal you not escape
¶ & ellis of you anger he wyll make but a iape.

¶ But for to tel you how Colus was brought.
¶ In daungere of Pluto yet had I forget
¶ wherfore on this mater forther wyl I nought.
¶ Procede tyll I therof haue knowlege you let
¶ It befell on a day the weder was wete
¶ And Colus thought he wold on his dysport.
¶ Goo t[u] reioyse his spyrytis and comforte

¶ He thought he wold se what was in *the* ground
¶ And in a krauers forth he gan hym dresse
¶ A drough had the erthe late before found.
¶ That caused it to chyne & krauy more & lesse /
¶ Sodenly by wete constreyned by duresse
¶ Was the ground to close his superfycyall face.
¶ So streyt that to scape colus had noo space

¶ This seyng Colus be styll wythin abode.
¶ Sekyng where he myght haue gene fer or nere.
¶ A[n]one he was espyed and one to Pluto rode
¶ And told hym how Colus was in his daungere.
¶ Than sayd he to Cerberus fet me *that* prysonere /
¶ Tyl I haue hym sene let hym not go at large /

¶ As *the* wylt answere of hem I yeue the charge

¶ Thus was this Colus take prysonere
¶ Than happed it so that the sa[m]e day
¶ Pluto had prefyxed for a grete mater
¶ Mynos to syt in his robe of Ray
¶ Wherefore Cerberus toke the next way
¶ And led hym to the place where the court shalbe
¶ where I told you Morpleus brought me

¶ So thyder c[a]me Dya[n]a caryed in carre
¶ To make her compleynt as I told you all
¶ And so dyd Neptunus *that* doth make and mar
¶ Walewyng *with* his wawys & tomblyng as a ball
¶ Her matters they meued fal what may befall
¶ There was the fyrst syght *that* euer I them saw
¶ And yf I neuer do eft I care not a straw

¶ But now to my matter retourne agayn
¶ And tu begyn new where I left.
¶ whan al the goddis had done her besy payne.
¶ The way to contryue how it shuld be reft
¶ Of his lyf Attropos had no cause eft
¶ To compleyn than Phebus stert vpon her fete /
¶ And sayd I pray you let me speke a word yet

¶ Othea menyth wel to say on this wyse
¶ But al to entret Neptunus i hope shal not nede
¶ Me semyth I alone durst take *that* entesprise.
¶ Er I am begyled or ellis I shal spede
¶ How say ye Neptunus shal I do this dede.
¶ Wy[l] ye your rancour seale at my request
¶ Madame quod he reule me as ye lykyth best

¶ Gr[a]mercy sayd she of your good wyll
¶ That it pleysyth you to shew me that fauorus
¶ Wherefore the goddys hygh pleysur to fulfyll
¶ Performe my desyre & leue al olde rancoure

¶ For our elders wele & sauynge of oure honour
¶ Agayn this colus that ye long haue had
¶ It is done quod he forsoth than am I gladd

¶ Sayd he now than Colus be *thou* to vs trewe
¶ Kepe well the eyr and oure grete rebell
¶ May we than sone euer to vs subdew
¶ Yes and that quod Colus shall here tell
¶ Nowhere in the eyr shall he rest nor dwel
¶ If he do therof put me in the faute
¶ Wyth my bytter blastes so shal I hym asaut

¶ What sayd the god Pluto what is his name.
¶ That thus presumyng agayn vs to rebell
¶ Vertu quod attropes *that* haue he mykyl shame
¶ He is neuer confounded thus of hym here I tell
¶ A sayd this pluto in dede I know hym wel
¶ He hath ben euer myn vtter ennemye
¶ Wherefore this mater agayn hym take wyll I

¶ For all the baytes *that* we for hym haue layde
¶ Wythout my helpe be not worth a pere
¶ For though ye all the contrary had sayd
¶ yet wold he brede right nigh your althris ere
¶ No maner of thyng can hym hurt or dere
¶ Saue only a sone of my bastard
¶ Whos name is vice he kepyth my vawarad.

¶ Wherefore you Cerberus now I the charge
¶ Of Colus & wyl that thou heder fet
¶ My dere sone Vyce & say that I hym charge.
¶ That he to me come without ony let
¶ Armed at all poyntes for a day is set
¶ That he *with* Vertu for al *the* goddis sake
¶ In our defence must on hym batayl take.

¶ Forth then went Cerberus *with* his fyry chein
¶ Brought thyder vyce as he commaunded was

¶ Agayn noble Vertu *that* batayl to dercygne
¶ On a glydyng serpent rydyng a grete pace
¶ Formed lyke a dragon scaled hard as glas
¶ whoos mouth flammed fyre *without* fayll
¶ wyngis had it serpentyne & a long tayll

¶ Armed was vyce all in cure boyll
¶ Harde as horne blacker fer than sute
¶ An vngoodly sort folowed hym perde
¶ Of vnhappy capteyns of myschyfe crop & rot
¶ Pryde was the fyrst *that* next hym rode god wote
¶ On a roryng Lyon next whome came Enuye
¶ Syttyng on wolfe he had a scornful eye

¶ Wrath bestrode a wyld bore & next hym gan ride.
¶ In his hond he bare a bloody sword
¶ Next whom cam couetise *that* goth so fer & wide
¶ Rydyng on a Olyfaunt as he had ben a ferd
¶ After whom rode Gloteny wyth his fat berd
¶ Syttyng on a bere wyth his grete bely
¶ And next hym on a gote folowed Lechery

¶ Sloth was so slepy he came all behynd
¶ On a dull asse a full wery pase
¶ Thyse were *the* capteins that vyce coud fynde
¶ Best to set his feld & folow on the chase
¶ As for pety capteyns many mo there was
¶ As sacrylege symony & dyssymulacyon
¶ Manslaughter mordre theft & extorcyon

¶ Arrogaunce Presumpcyon wyth contumaci
¶ Contempcyon Contempt & Inobedyence
¶ Maly[s]e Frowardnes grete Ielasy
¶ wodnes Hate Stryf and Impacyence
¶ Vnkyndnes Oppressyon *with* wofull neglygence.
¶ Murmur Myschef Falshod & detraccyon
¶ Vsury Periury Ly and adulacyon

¶ Wrong Rauyne Sturdy vyolence
¶ Fals Iugement *with* Obstynacyon
¶ Dysceyt Dronknes & Improuydence.
¶ Boldnes in yll *with* foule and Rybaudy.
¶ Fornycacyon Incest and Auoutry
¶ Vnshamfastnes *with* Prodygalyte
¶ Blasfeme vaynglory & worldly vanyte

¶ Ignoraunce Dyffydence *with* Ipocrysy
¶ Scysme Rancour Debate and Offence
¶ Heresy Errour *with* Idolatry.
¶ New fangylnes and sotyll false Pretence
¶ Inordynat desyre of worldly excellence
¶ Fayned pouerte wyth apostasy
¶ Dysclauder scorn & vnkynd Ielousy

¶ Hoordom baudry false mayntenaunce
¶ Treyson abusyon and pety brybry
¶ Vsurpacyon *with* horryble vengauce
¶ Came alder last of that company
¶ All thyse pety capetayns folowed by and by.
¶ Shewyng theymsel in the paleyse wyde
¶ And say they were redy that batayl to abyde

¶ Idylnes set the comyns in aray
¶ Without the palayse on a fayr felde
¶ But there was an ost for to make a fray
¶ I trow suche a nother neuer man beheld
¶ Many was the wepyn among hem *that* they weld
¶ What they were *that* came to that dysporte
¶ I shall you declare of many a sondry sort

¶ There were bosters crakers & brybours
¶ Praters sasers stretchers and wrythers
¶ Shamefull shakelers soleyne slaueours
¶ Oppressours of people and myghty crakers
¶ Mayntenours of quarels horryble lyers
¶ Theues traytours *with* false heretykes

¶ Charmars sorcerers & many scysmatykes.

¶ Preuy symonyakes wyth false vsurers

¶ Multyplyers coyn wasshers & clyppers

¶ Wrong vsurpers wyth grete extorcyoners

¶ Bacbyters Glosers and fayre flaterers.

¶ Malycyous murmurers with grete claterers

¶ Tregetours Tryfelers Feyners of tales.

¶ Lastyuous lurdeyns and Pykers of malys.

¶ Rouners Vagabundes Forgers & lesingis.

¶ Robbers Reuers Rauenous Ryfelers.

¶ Choppers of Chyrches Fynders of tydynges

¶ Merrers of maters and mony makers.

¶ Stalkers by nyght wyth Euysdroppers.

¶ Fyghters Brawlers Brekers of louedayes

¶ Getters Chyders Causers of frayes.

¶ Tytyuyllis Tyrauntis *with* Tourmentours.

¶ Corsyd apostatis Relygyous dyssymulers:

¶ Closshers Carders wyth comon hasardours.

¶ Tyburne colops and Purskytters.

¶ Pylary knyghtys double tollyng Myllers.

¶ Gay Ioly tapters *with* hostelers of the stewes.

¶ Hores and Bawdes that many bale brewes

¶ Bold blasphemers wyth false Ipocrytes.

¶ Brothellers Brokers abhomynable swerers.

¶ Dryuylls Dastardes dyspysers of ryghtis

¶ Homocydes Poyseners & comon morderers

¶ Scoldis Caytyues Comberous clappers.

¶ Idolatres Enchauntors *with* false regenates.

¶ Sotyl ambydextrys and sekeers of debatis.

¶ Pseudo Prophetes false Sodemytes.

¶ Quesmers of chyldren wyth fornycatours.

¶ wetewoldes that suffre syn in their syghtis.

¶ Auoutrers and abhomynable auauntours.

¶ Of syn grete clappers & makers of clamours
¶ Vnthyftes & vnlustes came al to that game
¶ *with* luskis & loselis *that* might not thryue for shame

¶ These were the comons *that* came thider *that* day.
¶ Redy bowne in batayl Vertu to abyde.
¶ Apollo theym beholdyng began to say·
¶ To the goddys & goddesses beyng there *that* tide
¶ Me semyth conuenient an herowd to ryde
¶ To Vertu & byde hym to batayl make hym boune
¶ Hymself to defend forsoth it shal be sone.

¶ And let hym not be sodeynly take.
¶ All dyspur[u]eyed or that he beware.
¶ For than shold our dyshonour awake.
¶ If he were cowardly take in a snare.
¶ Ee quod Vyce for that haue I no care.
¶ I wyl auauntage take where I may.
¶ That heryng Morpleus preuely stale away.

¶ And went to warne Vertu of al this afray.
¶ And bad hym awake and make hymself strong
¶ For he was lyke to endure that daye.
¶ A grete mortall shoure er it were euensonge.
¶ *with* Vyce wherfore he bad hym not longe.
¶ Tary to send after more socoure.
¶ If he dyde it shold torne hym to dolour.

¶ And brefely the mater to he declared.
¶ Lyke as ye haue herd begynnyng and ende.
¶ Well quod Vertu he shall not be spared
¶ To the feld I wyl go how it wende.
¶ But gramercy Morpleus myn own dere frende
¶ Of your trew hert & faythfull entente.
¶ That ye in this mater to meward haue ment.

¶ This done Morpleus departed away.
¶ Fro Vertu to the palayse retornyng agayn.

¶ None hym aspyed that I dare well say.
¶ In whych tyme Vertu dyde his besy payn
¶ People to reyse his quarell to maynteyn.
¶ Ymagynacyon was his messengere.
¶ He went to warne people both fer & nere.

¶ And bad hem come in all hast they myght
¶ For to strength Vertu for wyth out fayll.
¶ He sayd he shold haue long or it were nyght.
¶ Wyth Vyce to do a myghty strong batayl.
¶ Of vngracyous gestes he bryngyth a gret tayll
¶ Wherefore it behouyth to help at this nede.
¶ And after this shal Vertu rewar yore mede

¶ Whan ymagynacyon had gone his cyrcuyte
¶ To Vertue & frendis thus all about.
¶ Wythin short tyme many men of myght
¶ Gadered to Vertu in all that they myght.
¶ They hym comforted & bad hym put no doute.
¶ His vtter enemy Vyce to ouerthrowe.
¶ Thoughe he with hym brought neuer so gret arow

¶ And whan Vertu se the sustaunce of his oost
¶ He prayed all the comons to the feld hem hye
¶ Wyth her pety capteyns both lest and moste
¶ And wyth his capteyns shold folow redely.
¶ For he sayd he knew well *that* vyce was ful nye.
¶ And who myght fyrst of *the* feld recouer *the* centre
¶ Wold kepe out *that* other he shuld not esely entre

¶ Then sent he forth Baptym to *the* feld before
¶ And prayed hym hartely it to ouerse·
¶ That no maner trayn nor coltrop therin wore
¶ To noy nor hurt hym nor his meyne.
¶ And whan he thyder came he began to se.
¶ How Vyce his purseua[u]nt cryme orygynall.
¶ Was entred before and had seased vp all.

¶ But as sone as herof Baptym had a syght.
¶ He fled fast away and left the feld alone.
¶ And anone Baptym entred wyth his myght.
¶ Serchyng al about where this cryme had gone
¶ But the feld was clene default found he none.
¶ Then came Vertu after with his gret oste.
¶ And his myghty capteyns both lest and most

¶ But to enfourme you how he thyder came.
¶ And what maner capteins he to *the* feld brought
¶ Hymselfe sekerly was the fyrst man.
¶ Of all his grete host *that* thyderwarde sought.
¶ Syttyng in a chare *that* rychely was wrought.
¶ Wyth golde and peerles & gemmes precyous.
¶ Crowned with laurer as lord vycoryous.

¶ Foure doubty knyghtes about *the* chare went.
¶ At euery corner one hit for to gyde.
¶ And conuey accordyng to Vertue his entent.
¶ At the fyrst corner was Ryghtwysnesse *that* tyde.
¶ Prudence at the seconde was set to abyde.
¶ At *the* thryd strength *the* fourth kept temperaunce.
¶ These *the* chare gyded to Vertue his pleasaunce.

¶ Next to *the* chare seuen capyteyns there roode.
¶ Echone aftre other in ordre by and by.
¶ Humylyte was *the* fyrst a lambe he bestroode.
¶ With contenaunce demure he rood full soberly.
¶ A fawcon gentyll stood on his helme on hy.
¶ And next after hym came there Charyte.
¶ Rydyng on a tygre as fyll to his degre.

¶ Roody as a roose ay he kept his chere.
¶ On his helme on hyghe a pellycan he bare.
¶ Next whom cam pacyence *that* no where hath no pere
¶ On a camell rydyng as voyde of all care.
¶ A fenix on his helm stood so forth gan he fare.
¶ Who next hym folowed but lyberalyte.

¶ Syteng on a dromedary *that* was both good & fre.

¶ On his helm for his crest he bare on ospray.

¶ And next after hym folowed abstynence.

¶ Rydyng on an hete was trapure and gay.

¶ He semed a lorde of ryght grete excellence.

¶ A popyniay was his crest he was of gret dyfferece.

¶ Next hym folowed chastyte on an vnicorne.

¶ Armed at all poyntes behynde & beforne.

¶ A tortyldoue he bare on hyghe for his crest.

¶ Than came good besynesse last of *the* seuen.

¶ Rydyng on a panter a sondry coloured best.

¶ Gloriously beseen as he had come from heuen.

¶ A crane on his hede stood his crest for to steuen.

¶ All these .vii. capteyned had standardis of pryce.

¶ Eche of hem accordyng after his deuyse.

¶ Many pety capteyns after these went.

¶ As trew feyth & hope mercy pease & pyte.

¶ Ryght trouth mekenesse *with* rood ente[n]t.

¶ Goodnes concorde & parfyte vnyte.

¶ Honest trewe loue with symplyte.

¶ Prayer fastyng preuy almysdede.

¶ Ioyned with *the* artycles of the crede.

¶ Confessyon contrycyon & satysfaccyon.

¶ With sorow for synne & grete repentaunce.

¶ Foryeuenesse of trespas *with* good dysposycyon.

¶ Resystence of wrong performyng of penance.

¶ Holy deuocyon wyth good contynauce

¶ Presthode hem folowed with the sacramentis

¶ And sadnesse also wyth the commaundementes

¶ Suffraunce in trouble wyth Innocensy

¶ Clennes contynence and virgynyte

¶ Kyndnes reuerence *with* curteysy

¶ Content & pleased wyth pyteous pouerte

¶ Entendynge wel mynstryng equitye
¶ Twene ryght & wrong hole indyfferently
¶ And labouryng the seruyse of god to multiply

¶ Refuse of ryches & worldly vaynglory
¶ Perfeccyon wyth perfyght contemplacyon
¶ Relygyon professyon wel kept in memory
¶ Verry drede of god wyth holy predycacyon
¶ Celestyall sapyence wyth gostly inspyracyon
¶ Grace was the guyde of al this meyne
¶ Whome folowed konnyng *with* his genealogy

¶ That is to say gramer and Sophistry
¶ Philosophy naturall logyke and Rythoryke
¶ Arsmetrycke geometry wyth astronomye
¶ Canon and Cyuyll melodyous musyke
¶ Noble Theology and corporal physyke
¶ Moralyzayson of holy scrypture
¶ Profound poetry and drawyng of pycture

¶ Thyse folowed connyng & thyder wyth hin cam
¶ Wyth many one mo offryng her seruyse
¶ To Vertu at that nede but notwythstondyng than
¶ Some he refused and sayd in nowyse
¶ They shuld wyth hym go & as I coud auyse
¶ Thyse wore her names fyrst Nygrommancy
¶ Geomansy magyke and glotony

¶ Adryomansy Ornomancy *with* pyromancy
¶ Fysenomy also and pawmestry
¶ And al her sequeles yf I shal not lye
¶ Yet connyng prayed Vertu he wold not deny
¶ Theym for to know nor dysdeyn his eye
¶ On hem to loke wherto Vertu graunted
¶ How be it in his werres ge wold not they haunted

¶ So had they connyng lyghly to depart
¶ From Vertu his feld and they seyng this

¶ By comyn assent hyred them a carte
¶ And made hem be caryed toward Vyce Iwys.
¶ Fro thens forth to serue hym this wold not mys
¶ For loth they were to be maysterles
¶ In stede of the better the worse there they ches

¶ But forth to relese al the remenaunt
¶ Of pety capteins that wyth Vertu were
¶ Moderate dyet and wysdom auenant
¶ Euen weyght and mesure ware of contagious gere
¶ Loth to offend and louyng ay to lere
¶ Worshyp and profyte *with* myrth in maner
¶ Thyse pety capteyns wyth Vertu were in fere

¶ Comons hem folowed a grete multitude
¶ But in came pyson to that other syde
¶ I trow there was not brefely to conclude.
¶ The .x. man that batayl to abyde.
¶ Yet neuertheles I shal not from you hyde.
¶ what maner people they were & of what secte
¶ As nere as my wyt therto wyll me derect.

¶ There were noble and famous doctours.
¶ Example yeuers of lyuyng gracyous.
¶ Perpetuel prestes and dyscrete confessours.
¶ Of holy scrypture declarers fructuous.
¶ Rebukers of syn & myscheues odyous.
¶ Fysshers of soules & louers of clennes.
¶ Dyspysers of veyn and worldly rychesse.

¶ Peasyble prelatys Iustycyal gouernours.
¶ Founders of chyrches wyth mercyfull peres.
¶ Reformers of wrong of her progenytours
¶ On peynfull pore pyteous compassyoners
¶ well menyng marchauntes *with* trew artefecers
¶ Vyrgyns pure and also Innocentes
¶ Hooly matrones *with* chast contynence

¶ Pylgrymes & palmers *with* trew laborers
¶ Holy heremytes goddys solycytours
¶ Monesteryal monkes & well dysposed freres
¶ Chanons and nonnes feyth professoures
¶ Of worldly people trew coniugatours.
¶ Louers of Cryst Confounders of yll.
¶ And all that to godward yeue her good wyll

¶ Mayntenours of ryghte verey penytentes.
¶ Dystroyers of errour causers of vnyte.
¶ Trew actyf lyuers that set her ententis
¶ The dedis to performe of mercy and pyte
¶ Contemplatyf people that desyre to be.
¶ Salytary seruauntis vnto god alone.
¶ Rather *then* to habound in rychesses echone.

¶ Thyse wyth many mo than I reherce can
¶ were come thyder redy that batayl to abyde.
¶ And take such part as fyl to Vertu than
¶ Vyce to ouerco[m]e they hoped for al his pride
¶ Al though he had more people on his syde
¶ For the men that Vertu had were ful sure.
¶ To trust on at nede & connyng in armure

¶ Macrocosme was the name of the feld
¶ where this grete batayll was set for to be
¶ In the myddys therof stode consyence & beheld
¶ whyche of hem shold be brought to captyuyte
¶ Of that noble tryumph Iuge wold he be
¶ Synderesys sate hym wythin closed as a park
¶ *with* his table in his honde her dedys to marke.

¶ To come in to the feld were hygh wayes .v.
¶ Fre to both partyes large brode and wyde
¶ Vertu wold not tari but highed hym thyder bliue
¶ Lest he were by vyce deceyued at that tyde
¶ Long out of the feld loth was he to abyde
¶ In auenture that he out of it were kept.

For than wold he haue thought he hade to long slept

¶ In this mene tyme whyle Vertu thus proceded
¶ For hym & his people the feld for to wyne.
¶ He charged euery man by grace to be guyded
¶ And al that euer myght *the* feld to enter ynne.
¶ In all that season went orygynal synne.
¶ To let Vyce know how Baptym *with* his hoste.
Had entred Macrocosme & serched euery cooste

¶ A sayd Vyce I se well it is tyme.
¶ Baners to dysplay & standardes to auaunce.
¶ Al most to long haddest *thou* taryed cryme.
¶ To let vs haue knolege of this purueyaunce.
¶ yet I trow I shal lerne hem a new daunce.
¶ Wherefore I commaund you al *without* delaye
¶ Toward the felde draw in all the hast ye may

¶ Than sayd *the* god Pluto *that* al men myght here
¶ Vyce I the charge as thou wylt eschew.
¶ Our heuyous Indynynacyon *thou* draw not arere
¶ But put *the* forth boldly to ouerthrowe Vertu.
¶ In fayth quod Attropos & I shal after sew /
¶ For yf he escape oure hondys this day.
¶ I tell you my seruyse haue lost for ay.

¶ Forth than rode Vyce *with* al his hole strength
¶ On his stede serpentyne as i told you byfore.
¶ The ost that hym folowed was of a grete length.
¶ Among whom were penouns & g[u]ylters mani a score^[1]
¶ Of hys pety capteynes he made many a knight
¶ For they shuld not fle but manly *with* him fight

¶ He doubod Falshod with Dyssymylacyon.
¶ Symony Vsury Wrong and Rybawdy.
¶ Malyce Deceyt Lye wythout Extorcyon.
¶ Periury Dyffydence and Apostasy.
¶ Wyth boldnes in yl to bere hym company.

¶ Thyse .xiiii. knyghtes made vyce that daye.
¶ To wyn her spores they sayd they wold assay

¶ In lyke wyse Vertu doubred on his syde:
¶ Of pety capteyns other fourtene.
¶ Whyche made her auou wyth hym to abyde:
¶ Her spores wold they wyn *that* day shold it be sene
¶ Thyse wore her names yf it be as I wene
¶ Feyth Hope & Mercy Trouth & also Ryght.
¶ *with* Resystence of wronge a full hardy wyghte

¶ Confessyon Contrycyon wyth Satysfaction
¶ Verrey drede of God Performyng of penaunce
¶ Perfeccyon Connyng and Good dyspocision
¶ And all knyght to Vertu they were by alyauns
¶ Wherefore to hym they made assuraunce.
¶ That feld to kepe as long as they myght.
¶ And in his quarel agayn Vyce to fyght.

¶ The lord of Macrocosme & rewer of *the* fee
¶ Was called Frewyll chaunger of the chaunce:
¶ To whome Vertu sent embassatours thre
¶ Reson dyscresyon & good remembraunce.
¶ And prayed hym be fauorable his honoure to enhans
¶ For but he had his fauour at *the* poynt of nede.
¶ He stood in gret doute he coude not lightly spede.

¶ In lyke wyse Vyce embassatours thre.
¶ For his party vnto Frewyll sent.
¶ Temptacyon folly & sensualityte.
¶ Prayng hym of fauour that he wolde assent.
¶ To hym as he wolde at his commaundement.
¶ Haue hym eftsones whan he lyst to call.
¶ On hym for ony thyng *that* afterward myght fall.

¶ Answered yaue he none to neyther party.
¶ Saue oonli he sayd *the* batayll wolde he se
¶ To wete whiche of hym shold haue *the* vycory.

¶ Hit hyng in his balaunce *the* ambyguyte.
¶ He sayd he wolde not restrayne his lyberte.
¶ Whan he come where sorow shold awake.
¶ Than it shold be know what part he wyl take

¶ Whan Vertu & Vyce be her ambassatours.
¶ Knew of this answeere they stood in gret doute.
Neuertheles they seyde they wold endure tho shours
¶ And make an ende shortly of *that* they went aboute.
¶ Soo forth came Vyce *with* all his grete route.
¶ Er he came at *the* felde he sent yet priuely.
¶ Sensualyte before in maner of a spy.

¶ Whiche sewe *the* felde *with* his vnkynde seede.
¶ That caused Vertu after mykyll woo to feele
¶ For therof grewe nought but all oonly weede.
¶ Whiche made the grounde as sleper as an yele.
¶ He went ayene to vice & tolde hym euery dele.
¶ How he had done and bad hym come a way.
¶ For he had so purueyde *that* vyce sholde haue *the* day

¶ Soo as it happed at *that* felde they mete.
¶ Frewyll vertu and vice as tripartite.
¶ Saaf vertu a litil before the felde had gete.
¶ And ellis his auantage forsoth had be ful lyght
¶ Not for then encombred so was neuer wyght.
¶ As vertu & his men were with the ranke wede
¶ That in *the* felde grew of sensualitees sede

¶ But as soone as vyce of vertu had a syght.
¶ He gan swage gonnes as he had be woode
¶ That heryng vertu commaunded euery wyght
¶ To payce hym vnder the sygne of *the* rode.
¶ And bad hem not drede but kepe styll where thy stode.
¶ It was but a shour shold sone confounde
¶ wherfore he commaunded them stand & kepe her ground

¶ And whan vyce cam nerer to the felde.

¶ He callyd sore for bowes & bad hem shote faste
¶ But vertu & hys meyny bare of with *the* sheld.
¶ Of the blyssyd Trynyte ay tyll shot was past.
¶ And whan shot was done vyce cam forth at last.
¶ Purposyng the felde wyth assaute to wyn.
¶ But vertu kept it long he myght not enter theryn.

¶ All that tyme Frewyll stode & hym bethought.
¶ To which he myght leue & what part he wold take.
¶ At last sensualite had hym so fer brought.
¶ That he sayd playnly he vertu wold forsake.
¶ And in vyce hys quarell all his power make.
Nota Iwis quod reason *that* is not for the beste.
¶ Noforse sayd frewyll I wyll do as my lyst.

¶ Vertu was full heuy when he see frewyll
¶ Take part with vyce but yet neuerthelesse.
¶ He dyde that he myght the felde to kepe styll.
¶ Tyll vyce with frewyll so sore gan hym oppresse.
¶ That he was constrayned clerely by duresse.
¶ A lytyll tyne abacke to make abew retret.
¶ All thyng consydered hit was the best feet.

¶ Fyrst to remembre how vyce parte was.
¶ Ten ayen one strenger by lyklynnesse.
¶ And than how frewyll was with hym alas.
¶ Whoo coude deme vertu but in heuynesse.
¶ Moreouer to thynke how that slyper grasse.
¶ That of sensualyte hys onkynde seede grew.
¶ Vnder foot in standyng encombred vertew

¶ Yet notwithstandyng vertue his men all.
¶ Nobelly theym bare and faught myghtyly.
¶ How be it *the* sleper grasse made many of hem fall.
¶ And from thense in maner departe sodenly.
¶ That seyng vyce his hoost began to shout & cry.
¶ And sayd on in Pluto name on & all is oure.
¶ For this day shal Vyce be made a conquerour.

¶ Thus Vertu was by myght of vyce & Frewyll
¶ Dryuen out of the feld it was the more pyte·
¶ How by it yet Baptym kept his ground styll.
¶ And *with* hym abode feyth hope & vnyte.
¶ And konnyng also *with* a grete meyne.
¶ Confessyon contrycyon were redy at her hond.
¶ And Satysfaction Vyce to wythstond.

¶ But al the tyme whyle Vertu was away.
¶ A myghty conflycte kept they *with* Vycys rout.
¶ And yet neuertheles for al that grete afray.
¶ Hope stod vpryght & feyth wold neuer lout
¶ And euermore sayd Baptym syres put no dout.
¶ Vertu shal return & haue his entent.
¶ This feld shal be ours or let me be shent.

¶ And whyl thyse pety capteyns sustend thus *the* feld
¶ Wyth Vertu his reward come good perseuerauns
¶ An hugy myghty hoost & whan he beheld.
¶ How Vertu hym withdrew he toke dysplesauns.
¶ And whan he to hym cam he sayd ye shal your chans
¶ Take as it fallyth wherfore returne ye must.
¶ Yet ones for your sake *with* Vyce shal I Iust.

¶ Alas that euer ye shold lese your honour.
¶ And therwyth also *the* hygh perpetuel crown.
¶ Which is for you kept in the celestyal tour.
¶ Wherfore be ye called chrystys champyon.
¶ How is it that ye haue noo compassyone.
¶ On baptye feyth & hope konnyng & vnite.
¶ That stand so hard bestad & fyght as ye may see.

¶ All the tresour erthely vnder *the* fyrmament
¶ That euer was made of goddys creacyon.
¶ To reward theym euenly were not equyualent.
¶ For her noble labour in his affleccyon.
¶ Wherfore take vpon you your Iurisdyccyon
¶ Rescu yonder knyghtes & recontynu fyght.

¶ And els a dew your crown for al your gret myght

¶ Vith these & suche wordys as I haue you tolde

¶ By good perseueraunce vttred in this wyse.

¶ Vertu hym remembred & gan to vexe bolde.

¶ And sayd yeue trew knyghtis to rescu I auyse

¶ Let vs no lengar tary from this entrepryse.

¶ Agayn to *the* felde soo Vertu retourned.

¶ That caused hem be mery *that* long afore had morned

¶ Auaunt baner *quod* he in *the* name of Iesu

¶ And with *that* his people set vp a gret shoute.

¶ And cryed with a loude voce a Vertu a Vertu.

¶ Then began Vyce his hoost for to loke a boute.

¶ But I trow perseueraunce was not long withoute

¶ He bathed his swerd in his foos blood.

¶ The boldest of hem all not ones hym withstoode.

¶ Constaunce hym folowed & brought hym his spere

¶ But when perseueraunce saw Vyce on his stede.

¶ No man coude hym let tyll he came there.

¶ For to byd hym ryde I trow it was no nede.

¶ All Vertu his oost prayed for his good spede.

¶ Agayn Vyce he rode with his grete shaft.

¶ And hym ouerthrew for all his sotyll craft.

¶ That seyng Frewill came to conscyence.

¶ And gan hym to repente *that* he with hym had be.

¶ Prayeng hym of counsell for his grete offence.

¶ That he agayn Vertu had made his arme.

¶ What was best to doo to humylyte:

¶ *Quod* conscyence must *thou* go so he hym thyder sent

¶ Dysguysed *that* he were not knowen as he wente.

¶ And whan he thyder came humylyte hym toke.

¶ A token & bad hym go to conffessyon.

¶ And shew hym his mater with a peteous loke

¶ Whiche done he hym sent to contrycyon.

¶ And fro thensforthe to satysfaccyon.
¶ Thus fro poost to pyler was he made to daunce.
¶ And at the last he went forthe to penaunce.

¶ But now for to tel you when Vyce was ouerthrow
¶ A gret part of his oost about hym gan resorte.
¶ But he was so febyll *that* he coude noman know.
¶ And whan they se *that* they knew no comforte.
¶ But caryed hym away be a preuy porte.
¶ And as they caryed dyspeyre with hym met.
¶ With Vyce his rewarde he cam theym for to fet

¶ Then came there downe goodly ladyes tweyn.
¶ From the hyghe heuen aboue the fymamente.
¶ And sayd the gret Alpha & Oo moost souereyn.
¶ For that nobell tryumphe had hem thyder sent.
¶ One of hem to dryue Vyce to grete tormente.
¶ With a fyry strong *that* she bare in her hande.
¶ And so he dede dyspere & all his hole bande.

¶ The name of this lady was called Prestyence.
¶ She neuer left Vyce ne none *that* wolde hym folow.
¶ Tyll they were commytted by *the* dyuyne sentence.
¶ All to payne perpetuell & Infynyte sorow.
¶ Right wysnes went to se *that* noman shold hem borow.
¶ Thus al entreted sharpely were they tyll Cerberus
¶ Had hem beshut within his gates tenebrus.

¶ And all *the* whyle *that* Prestyence *with* her scorge smert
¶ To rewarde Vyce gan her thus occupy.
¶ With all his hole bende after her desert.
¶ That other gloryous lady *that* came fro heuen on hy.
¶ Hauyng in her honde the palme of vycory.
¶ Came downe to Vertu & toke hym to *that* present.
¶ Sayeng thus that Alpha & Oo hath hym sent.

¶ And as ferre as I ryght coude vnderstonde
¶ That ladyes name was Predestynacyon.

¶ Vertu & his oost she blessyd with her honde.
¶ And in heuyn graunted hem habytacyon.
¶ Whereto eche of hem reseruyd was a crowne.
¶ She sayd in token that they enherytours.
¶ Of the glory were & gracious conquerours.

¶ Wych done the ladyes ayen to gyder met
¶ And towarde heuen vp they gan to fly
¶ Embraced in armes as they had ben knyht.
¶ Togyder *with* a gyrdyl but so sodenly.
¶ As *they* were vanysshid saw I neuer thyng *with* ey.
¶ And anone Vertu wyth al his company.
¶ Kneled dounn & thanked god of *that* vyctory.

¶ Yet had I forget whan Vyce was ouerthrow.
¶ To haue told you hou many of Vycys hoost.
¶ Gan to seke pease & darked dounn ful low.
¶ And besought mercy what so euer it coste.
¶ To be her mene to Vertu els *they* were but lost.
¶ And some in lyke wyse to feyth & hope sought.
¶ What to do for pease they sayd they ne roughete.

¶ Some also Baptym sewed to be her mene.
¶ Som to one som to other as thei hem gete myghte.
¶ But al to Confessyon went to make hem clene
¶ And as *they* came to consyence he theym bad go lyghte.
¶ Er than old attropes of hem had a syght.
¶ For yf he so theym toke lost they were for euer
¶ He sayd Vyce to forsake better late thyn neuer.

¶ Som eke for socour drew to circumcision.
¶ But by hym coud they gete but smal fauoure.
¶ For he in that company was had but in derysyon
¶ Neuerthelesse to feyth he bad hem go laboure.
¶ Prayng theym for olde acquyntance theym socoure
¶ Wel quod feth for his sake I shal do *that* I may doo
¶ But fyrste for the best way baptym go ye to.

¶ For by hym sonest shal ye recouer grace.
¶ Which shal to Vertu bryng you by processe.
¶ Wherefore in ony wyse loke ye make good face.
¶ And let noman know of your heuynes.
¶ So they were by baptym brought out of destres
¶ Turned al to Vertu & whan this was done.
¶ Vertu cummaunded Frewyl before hym come.

¶ To whom thus he sayd I haue grete merueyl
¶ Ye durst be so bold Vycys party to take.
¶ Who bad you do so & yaue you that counseyl.
¶ Iustly vnto that ye shal me preuy make.
¶ Then sayd Frewyll & swemfully spake.
¶ Knelyng on his kne wyth a chere benygn.
¶ I pray you syr let pyte your eres to me enclyne.

¶ And I shall yow tel the verrey soth of all.
¶ How it was & who made me that way drawe.
¶ For soth sensuallyte his propre name they call.
¶ A sayd reason then I know wel that felowe.
¶ Wyld he is & wanton of me stant hym none awe.
¶ Is he so *quod* Vertu wel he shall be taught.
¶ As a player shuld to draw another draught.

¶ And *with* that came sadnesse wyt his sober chere.
¶ Bryngyng Sensualite beyng ful of thought.
¶ And sayd that he had take hym prysonere.
¶ A welcome sayd Vertu now haue I *that* I sought.
¶ Blessed be the good lord as *thou* wold it is nought
¶ Why arte *thou* so wanton he sayd for shame.
¶ Or *thou* go at large *thou* shalt be more tame.

But stond a part a whyle tyl I haue spoke a word
¶ Wyth Frewyl a lytyl & then shalte *thou* knowe.
¶ What shalbe thy fynaunce & then he sayd in bord
¶ Vnto Frewyl the bend of your bowe.
¶ Begynnyth to slake but suche as ye haue sowe
¶ Must nedes reape there is none waye.

¶ Notwythstandyng that lette what ye can saye.

¶ What is your habilitie me to recompense.

¶ For the grete harme that ye to me haue do.

¶ Forsoth sayd Frewyll in open audyence.

¶ But oonly Macrocosme more haue I not loo.

¶ Take *that* yf it pleyse you I wyl that it be soo.

¶ Yf I may vnderstond ye be my good lorde.

¶ In dede sayd Vertu to that wyll I accomde.

¶ Then made Vertu Reason his leyftenaunte.

¶ And yaue him a grete charge macrocosme to kepe

¶ That done Sensualite yeld hym recreaunte.

¶ And began for anger bytterly to wepe.

¶ For he demed surely hys sorowe shold not slepe

¶ Then made Vertu Frewyll bayl vnder Reason.

¶ The feld for to occupy to his behoue that season.

¶ And then sayd Vertu to Sensualyte.

¶ Thou shalt be rewarded for thy besynesse.

¶ Vnder this furme al fragylyte

¶ Shalt *thou* forsake both more and lesse.

¶ And vnder the guydyng *thou* shalt be of sadnesse.

¶ All though it somewhat be agayn thy herte.

¶ Thy Iugements gyuen *thou* shalt it not asterte.

¶ And evyn *with* that came in dame Nature.

¶ Sayeng thus to Vertu syr ye do me wronge.

¶ By duresse & constreynt to put this creature.

¶ Gentyll Sensualyte *that* hath me *serued* longe.

¶ Clerely from his lyberte & set hym amonge.

¶ Theym that loue hym not to be her vnderloute.

¶ As it were a cast away or a sho cloute.

¶ And perde ye know well a rewle haue I must

¶ Wythin Macrocosme forsoth I say not nay.

Quod Vertu but sensualyte shal not perform your lust

¶ Lyke as he hath do befor this yf I may.

¶ Therfro hym restreyn sadnesse shal assay.
¶ How be it ye shal haue your hole lyberte.
¶ Wythin Macrocosme as ye haue had fre.

¶ And whan Vertu had to Nature sayd thus
¶ A lytyll tyne his ey castyng hym besyde.
¶ He se in a corner standyng Morpleus
¶ That hym before warned of *that* berely tyde.
¶ A syrs sayd Vertu yet we must abyde.
¶ Here is a frend of ours may not be forgete.
¶ After his deserte we shall hym entreate

¶ Morpleus sayd Vertu I thanke you hertely
¶ For your trew herte & your grete laboure.
¶ That ye lyst to come to me soo redely.
¶ Whan ye vnderstood *the* comyng of that shoure.
¶ I thanke god & you of sauynge of myn honour.
¶ Wherefore this preuylege now to you I grant
¶ That *within* Macrocosme ye shall haue your haunt

¶ And of fyue posternes *the* keys shall ye kepe.
¶ Lettyng in & out at hym whome ye lyst.
¶ As long as in Macrocosme your fader wyll crepe.
¶ Blere whos ey ye wyll hardely *with* your myst
¶ And kepe your werkes close there as in a chyst
¶ Saaf I wold desyre you spare Pollucyon.
For no thyng may me plesse *the* souneth to corrupcyon.

¶ And whan he had thus sayd *the* keyes he hym toke.
¶ And toward his castell *with* his people went
¶ Byddyng reason take good hede & about loke
¶ That sensualite by Nature were not shent.
¶ Kepe hym short he sayd tyll his lust be spent
¶ For better were a chylde to by vnbore
¶ Than let hym haue *the* wyll & foreuer be lore.

¶ And whan olde Attropos had seen & herd all this
¶ How Vertu had opteyned astonyed as he stood.

¶ He sayd to hymselfe somewhat there is amys.
¶ I trow well my patent be not all good.^[2]
¶ Sayeng to the goddys I see ye do but iape.
¶ After a worthy whew haue ye made me gape.

¶ How a deuyll way sholde I Vertue ouerthrow.
¶ When he dredeth not all your hole route.
¶ How cam ye make good your patent wold I know
¶ Hit is to Impossable to bryng that aboute.
¶ For stryke hym may I not *that* is out of doute.
¶ A good Attropos sayd god Apollo.
¶ An answer conuenient shall thou haue herto.

¶ The wordes of thy patent dare I well say
¶ Stretche to no farther but were dame Nature
¶ Hath Iurysdyccyon there to haue the way Nota.
¶ And largesse to stryke as longet to thy cure.
¶ And as for Vertu he his no cryature.
¶ Vnder the predycament conteyned of quantyte
¶ Wherefore his dystruccyon longeth not to the.

¶ A ha sayd Attropos then I see well.
¶ That all ye goddys be but counterfete.
¶ For oo God there is that can euerydell.
¶ Tourne as hym lest bothe drye & whete.
¶ In to whoos seruyce I shal assay to gete.
¶ And yf I may ones to his seruyce come.
¶ Your names shal be put to oblyuyone.

¶ Thus went Attropos fro the paleys wrooth.
¶ But in the mene tyme whyle *that* he there was.
¶ Glydyng by the paleys resyduacyon gooth.
¶ Towarde Macrocosme with a peynted fase.
¶ Clad lyke a pylgryme walkyng a grete pase.
¶ In the forme as he had ben a man of ynde.
¶ He wede haue made reson & sadnesse both blynde

¶ With sensualyte was he soone aqueynted.

¶ To whome he declared his mater pryuely.
¶ Yet he was espyed for all his face peynted.
¶ Then reson hym commaunded pyke hym thens lightly.
¶ For his ease quod sadnesse so counseyll hym wyll I.
¶ Soo was sensualyte ay kepte vnder foote.
¶ That to resyduacyon myght he doo no boote.

¶ Then went he to Nature & asked her auyse.
¶ His entent to opteynde what was best to doo.
¶ She sayd euer syth Vertu of vyce wan *the* pryse.
¶ Reson with sadnesse hath rewled the felde soo.
¶ That I & sensualyte may lytyll for the doo.
¶ For I may noo more but oonly kepe my cours.
¶ And yet is sensualyte strenger kept & wours.

¶ Thus heryng resyduacon fro thens he went ageyn
¶ Full of thought & sorow *that* he myght not spede.
¶ Than reson & sadnesse toke wedehokes tweyn.
¶ And all wylde wantonesse out *the* felde gan wede.
¶ With all the slyper grasse *that* grewe of the sede.
¶ That sensualyte before therin sew.
¶ And fro thens forth kept it clene for vertew

¶ Than began new grase in the felde to spryng.
¶ All vnlyke *that* other of colour fayr & bryght.
¶ But then I aspyed a meruelous thyng.
¶ For the grounde of *the* felde gan wex hore & whyt.
¶ I coude not conceyue how *that* be myght.
¶ Tyll I was enformed & taught it to know.
¶ But wher vertu occupyet must nedes wel grow

Yet in the mene tyme while the felde thus grow.
¶ And reson with sadnesse therof had goueraunce.
¶ Many a preuy messenger thyder sent Vertew.
¶ To know yf it were guyded to his plesaunce.
¶ Now prayer eft fastyng & often tyme penaunce.
¶ And whan he myght goo preuely almesdede.
¶ And bad hym to his power helpe where he se nede

While *that* felde thus rewled reson with sadnesse.

¶ Maugre dame Nature for all her carnall might

¶ Came thyder Attropos voyd of all gladnesse.

¶ Wrapped in his shete & axed of ony wyght.

¶ Coude wysse hym the vay to the lorde of light.

¶ Or ellis where myght fynde ryghtwysnesse.

¶ Forsothe sayd reyson I trow as I gesse.

¶ At Vertu his castell ye may soone hym fynde.

¶ If ye lyst the laboure thyder to take.

¶ And there shall ye know yf ye be not blynde.

¶ The next wey to the lord of lyght I vndertake.

¶ So thyder went Attropos petycyon to make.

¶ To ryghtwysnesse preyeng that he myght.

¶ Be take in to the seruyse of the lorde of lyght.

¶ What sad ryghtwysnesse *thou* olde dotyng foole.

¶ Whome hast thou seruyd syth the worlde began

¶ But oonly hym where hast *thou* go to scole.

¶ Whethery art *thou* double or elles the sam man.

¶ That thou were fyrst a syr sayd he than.

¶ I praye you hertely holde me excused.

¶ I am olde & febell my wyttys are dysused.

¶ Well sayd ryghtwysnes for as moche as thow.

¶ Knowest not thy mayster thy name shal I chaunge

¶ Dethe shalt *thou* be caled from hens forward now

¶ Among all the peple that shal be had straunge.

¶ But whan *thou* begynnest to make thy chalaunge.

¶ Dredde shalt thou be where so thou become.

¶ And to noo creature shalt thou be welcome.

¶ And as for theym whome thou dedest serue.

¶ For as moche as they presume on hem to take.

¶ That hygh name of god they shal as they deserue

¶ Therefore be rewarded I dare vndertake.

¶ Wyth payn perpetual among fendes blake.

¶ And her names shall be put to oblyuyon.

¶ Among men but it be in dyrysyon.

¶ Aha sayd Attropos now begynne I wex glad.

¶ That I shal thus auenged of hem be.

¶ Syth they so long tyme haue made me so mad.

¶ Yee *quod* ryghtwysnesse here what I say to the.

¶ The lorde of lyght sent the worde by me.

¶ That in Macrocosme sesyne shalt thou take

¶ wherfore thy darte redy loke thou make

¶ And as soone as Vertue that vnderstood

¶ He sayd he was pleased that it sholde soo be

¶ And euen forth with he *commaunded* presthood

¶ To make hym redy the felde for to se

¶ So thyder went presthode with benygnyte

¶ Conueyening thyder the blessyd sacrament

¶ Of Eukaryst but fyrst were thyder sent

¶ Confessyon contrycyon and satysfaccyon (*nota*

¶ Sorow for synne and grete repentaunce

¶ Holy deuocyon with good dysposycyon

¶ All these thyder came and also penaunce

¶ As her dewte was to make purueaunce

¶ Agayn the comyng of that blessyd lorde

¶ Feyth hope & charyte therto were acorde

¶ Reason with sadnesse dyde his dylygence

¶ To clense the felde within and without

¶ And whan they se the bodely presence

¶ Of that holy Eukaryst lowly gan they lout

¶ So was that lorde receyued out of dout

¶ With all humble chere debonayre & benygne

¶ Lykly to pleasure it was a grete sygne

¶ Then came to the felde the mynyster fynall

¶ Called holy vnccyon with a crysmatory

¶ The fyue hye wayes in especyall

¶ Therof he anoynted & made hit sanctuary

¶ Whome folowed deth whiche wolde not tary
¶ His feruent power there to put in vre
¶ As he was commaunded grauntyng dame Nature

¶ Nota.

¶ He toke his darte called his mortall launce
¶ And bent his stroke towarde the felde herte
¶ That seyng preesthode bad good remembraunce
¶ Towarde the felde tourne hym & aduerte
¶ For except hym all vertues thense must sterte
¶ And euen with that dethe there sesyne toke
¶ And then all the company clerely hit forsoke

¶ And as soone as dethe thus had sesyne take
¶ The colour of the felde was chaunged sodeynly
¶ The grasse therin seere as though it had be bak
¶ And the fyue hygh wayes were mured vpon hy
¶ That fro thensforwarde none entre shold therbi
¶ The posternes were also without lette
¶ Bothe inwarde & outwarde fyne fast shette

¶ Whiche done sodeynly dethe vanysshed a way
¶ And Vertu exalted was aboue the fymament
¶ Where he toke crowne of glory *that* is ay
¶ Preparete by Alpha & oo omnypotent
¶ The swete frute of macrocosme thyder *with* hym went
¶ And on all this mater as I stood musyng thus
¶ Agayn fro the felde to me came Morpleus

¶ Sayeng thus what chere how lyketh *the* this fyght
¶ Haste thou seen ynough or wyll thou see more
¶ Nay syr I sayd my trouthe I you plyght
¶ This is sufficyente yf I knew wherfore
¶ This was to me shewed for therof he lore
¶ Coueyte I to haue yf I gete myght
¶ Folow me quod he and haue thy delyght

¶ Soo I hym folowed tyll he had me brought
¶ To a foresquare herber walled round aboute
¶ Loo *quod* Morpleus here maist thou *that* thou sought
¶ Fynde yf thou wyll I put the out of doute
¶ A lytyll whyle we stood styll there withoute
¶ Tyll wytte chyef porter of that herber gate
¶ Requyred by stodye lete vs in there ate

¶ But whan I came in meruayled gretly
¶ Of that I behelde & herde reporte
¶ For fyrst in a chayre apparaylled royally
¶ There sate dam doctryne her childern to exorte
¶ And about her was many a sondry sorte
¶ Some wylling to lerne dyuerse scyence
¶ And some for to haue perfyte intellygence

¶ Crowned she was lyke an Emperesse
¶ With .iii. crownes standyng on her hede on by
¶ All thyng about her an Infynyte processe
¶ Were to declare I tell you certaynly
¶ Neuerthelesse some in mynde therof haue I
¶ Whiche I shall to you as god wyll yeue me grace
¶ As I sawe & herde tell in short space

¶ Fast by Doctryne on that one syde
¶ As I remembre sate holy Texte
¶ That opened his mouthe to *the* people wyde
¶ But not in comparyson to Glose *that* sate nexte.
¶ Moralyzacyon with a cloke contexte
¶ Sate & Scrypture was scribe to theym all
¶ He sate ay wrytyng of that that sholde fall

¶ These were tho that I there knewe
¶ By no maner waye of olde acqueyntaunce
¶ But as I before saw theym with Vertewe
¶ Company in felde & hauyng dalyaunce
¶ And as I thus stood halfe in a traunce
¶ Whyle they were occupyed in her besynesse

¶ Aboute the walles myn ey gan I dresse

¶ Where I beheld the meruaylous story
¶ That euer I yet sawe in ony pycture
¶ For on tho walles was made memory
¶ Syngulerly of euery creature
¶ That there had byn bothe forme & stature
¶ Whoos names reherse I wyll as I can
¶ Bryng them to mynde in ordre euery man

¶ Fyrst to begynne there was in portrature
¶ Adam & Eue holdyng an apell rounde
¶ Noe in a shyp & Abraham hauyng sure
¶ A flyntstone in his honde & Isaac lay bounde
¶ On an hyghe mounte Iacob slepyng sounde
¶ And a long ladder stood besyde
¶ Ioseph in a Cysterne was also there that tyde.

¶ Next whom stode Moyses with his tables two
¶ Aaron and Vvre his armes supportyng
¶ Ely in a brennyng chare was there also.
¶ And Elyze stode clad in hermytes clothynge.
¶ Dauid wyth an harpe and a stone slynge.
¶ Isaye Ieremy and Ezechyell.
¶ And closed wyth Lyons holy Danyell.

¶ Abacuc Mychee with Malachy.
¶ And Ionas out of a whales body comynge.
¶ Samuel in a Temple & holy zachary.
¶ Besyde an aulter all bloody stondynge.
¶ Osee wyth Iudyth stood there conspyryng.
¶ The deth of Dioferne & Salamon.
¶ A chylde wyth hys swerde dyuydynge in two.

¶ Many mo prophetes certeynly there were.
¶ Whoos names now come not to my mynde:
¶ Melchysedech also I espyed there.
¶ Brede & wyne offryng as fell to his kynde.

¶ Ioachym & Anna stode al behynde.
¶ Embraced in armes to the golden gate.
¶ And holy Iohan Baptyst in desert sat.

¶ And now comyth to my remembrunce.
¶ I am auysed I saw Sodechy:
¶ And Amos also with sober countenaunce.
¶ Stondyng wyth her faces towarde Sophony.
¶ Neemy & Esdras bare hem companye.
¶ The holy man Iob as an Impotente.
¶ Then folowed in pycture wyth Thoby pacyent

¶ Thyse wyth many mo on that one syde.
¶ Of that grene herber portrayed were.
¶ A sayd Morpleus a lytyll tyme abyde.
¶ Turn thy face where thy backe was ere.
¶ And beholde well what thou seeste there.
¶ Than I me turned as he me badde.
¶ With herte stedfaste & countenaunce sadde.

¶ Where I sawe Peter wyth his keyes stonde.
¶ Poule wyth a swerde and Iames also.
¶ Wyth a scalop & Thomas holdyng in his honde
¶ A spere and Phylp aproched hym to:
¶ Iames the lesse nexte hem in pycture too.
¶ Stode wyth Bartylmew whych was all flayn
¶ Symon & Thadee shewed how they were slayn

¶ Mathy and Barnabe drawyng lottys stode
¶ Nexte whome was Marke a Lyon hym by.
¶ Hys boke holdyng & Mathew in his mode.
¶ Resembled an aungell wyth wyngys gloriously.
¶ Luke had a calfe to holde his boke on hye.
¶ And Iohan wyth a cuppe & palme in his honde.
¶ An Egle bare his book thus saw I hem stonde

¶ Gregory and Ierome Austyn and Ambrose.
¶ Wyth pyllions on ther hedes stode lyke doctors

¶ Bernard wyth Amselme and as I suppose.
¶ Thomas of alquyne and Domynyk confessours.
¶ Benet and Hew relygyous gouernours.
¶ Martyn & Iohan with bysshops tweyne.
¶ Were there also and Crysostom certayne.

¶ Behynd all thyse was worshypfull Bede.
¶ All behynde and next hym stood Orygene.
¶ Hydynge his face as he of his dede.
¶ Had hem ashamed ye wote what I mene.
¶ For of errour he was not al clene.
¶ And on that syde stode laste of alle.
¶ The noble prophetyssa Sybell men her call.

¶ Let me remembre now I you pray
¶ My barayn is so thynne I deme in my herte
¶ Some of the felyshyp that I there say.
¶ In all this whyle to haue ouersterte.
¶ A benedicite none coude I aduerte.
¶ To thynke on Andrew the apostle *with* his crosse.
¶ Whome to forgete were a grete losse.

¶ Many one were peynted on that wall.
¶ Whoos names come not to my remembraunce.
¶ But thyse I marked in especyall.
¶ And moo coude I tell in countenaunce.
¶ Of tyme but forth to shewe you the substaunce.
¶ Of this mater in the myndys of that arbere.
¶ Sat Doctryne coloured as ony crystall clere.

¶ Crowned as I tolde you late here before.
¶ Whoos apparayl was worth tresour Infynyte
¶ All erthly rychesse count I no more.
¶ To that in comparyson valewyng then a myte.
¶ Ouer her hede houed a culuer fayr & whyte.
¶ Out of her byll proceded a grete leme.
¶ Downward to Doctryne lyke a sonne beme

¶ The wordes of Doctryne yaue grete redolens
¶ In swetnesse of sauour to her dyscyples al.
¶ It fer exceded myr & frankencense.
¶ Or ony other tre spyce or els galle.
¶ And whan she me espyed anone she gan me cal.
¶ And commaunded morpleus *that* he shold bryng me nere
¶ For she wold me hew the effect of my desyre.

¶ She sayd I know the cause of thy comyng.
¶ Is to vnderstond be myn enformal yon.
¶ Sensyble the mater of morpleus his shewyng
¶ As he hath the led about in vesyon.
¶ Wherfore now I apply thy natural reason.
¶ Vnto my wordes & or thou hens wend.
¶ Thou shalt it know begynnyng and ende.

¶ For whan Colus to pluto was broughte:
¶ By hys owne neclygence taken prysonere.
¶ Wythin the erth for he so fer foughte.
¶ Sygnyfed is no more be that matere.
¶ But only to shew the how it doth appere:
¶ That welth vnbrydeled at thyn eye.
¶ Enbraseth mysrewle and oft causyth foly.

¶ For lyke as Colus beyng at his large
¶ Stretyed hymself thugh his own lewdenesse
¶ For he wolde deepe where he had no charge
¶ Ryght soo wantons by her wyldenesse
¶ Oftesythe bryng hymselfe in dystresse
¶ Because they sometyme to largely deepe
¶ What may wors be suffred than ouermykell weepe

¶ By Mynos the Iuge of hell desparate
¶ May be vnderstonde goddys ryghtwysnes
¶ That to euery wyght his payne deputate
¶ Assygne the acordyng to his wyckednes
¶ Wherfore he is called Iuge of cruelnes
¶ And as for Dyana & Neptunus compleynte

¶ Fygured may be fooles reason feynt.

¶ For lyke as they made her suggestyon
¶ To haue me Colus from cours of hys kynde
¶ Which was Impossyble to bryng to correccyon
¶ For euermore hys lyberte haue wyll the wynde
¶ In lyke wyse fooles other whyle be blynde
¶ Wenying to subdew with her one honde
¶ That is ouermykell for all an hole londe

¶ But what foloweth therof that shall thou here
¶ When they were come to the bankete
¶ The grete Apollo with his sad chere
¶ Soo fayre & curtously gan theym entret
¶ That he made her beardys on the new gete
¶ Loo what wysdome dooth to a foole
¶ Wherefore are children put to scoole

¶ Ofte is it seen with sobre contenaunce
¶ That wyse men fooles ouercome ay
¶ Tornyng as hem lyst & all her varyaunce
¶ Chaunge from ernest in to mery play
¶ What were they bothe amendeth that day
¶ When they were dreuen to her wyttes ende
¶ Were they not fayne to graunt to be his frende

¶ Ryght soo fooles when they haue done
¶ All that they can than be they fayne
¶ Gyue vp hed mater to oblyuyone
¶ Without rewarde they haue no more brayne
¶ And yet ful ofte hath hit be sayne
¶ When they it haue foryete & set at nought
¶ That they full dere haue afterwarde it bought

¶ And as for all tho that represent
¶ To be called goddys at that banket
¶ Resemble false ydollys but to his entent
¶ Was Morpleus commaunded thyder the to fet

¶ That thou sholdest know the maner & the get
¶ Of the paynym law and of her byleue
¶ How false ydolatry ledeth hem by the sleue

¶ For soone vppon the worldys creacyon
¶ When Adam and Eve had broke the precept
¶ Whiche clerkes call the tyme of deuyacyon
¶ The worldly people in paynym law slept
¶ Tyll moyses vnder god the tables of stone kept
¶ In whiche tyme Poetes feyned many a fable
¶ To dyscrete Reason ryght acceptable

¶ And to the entent that they sholde sounde
¶ To the eeres of hem the more pleasantly
¶ That theym sholde rede or here the yaue theym a grounde
¶ And addid names vnto theym naturally
¶ Of whom they spake & callid hem goddis hy
¶ Some for the strength & myght of her nature
¶ And some for her sotyll wytty coniecture

¶ By nature thus as the seuen planettes
¶ Haue her propre names by Astronomeres
¶ But goddys were they called by old Poetes
¶ For her gret feruency of werkyng in her speres
¶ Experyence preueth this at all yeres
¶ And for as other that goddys called be
¶ For sotyll wytte that shall I teche the

¶ How they by that hyghe name of god cam
¶ In this sayd tyme the people was so rude
¶ That what maner creature man or woman
¶ Coude ony newelte contryue and conclude
¶ For the comon wele all the multytude
¶ Of the comon people a god sholde hym call
¶ Or a goddesse after hit was fall

¶ Of the same thyng that was so newefounde
¶ As Ceres for she the crafte of tylthe fonde

¶ Wherby more plentouously corne dyd habounde
¶ The people her called thurgh out euery londe
¶ Goddesse of corne wendyng in her honde
¶ Had layn all power of cornes habundaunce
¶ Thus were *the* Paynems deceyued by ignoraunce

¶ In lyke maner Isys was called the goddesse
¶ Of frute for she fyrst made it multiply
¶ By the name of graffyng & soo by processe
¶ The name of Pan gan to deify
¶ For he fyrst founde the mene shepe to guy
¶ Some toke it also by her condycyon
¶ As Pluto Fortune and suche other doon

¶ Thus all that Poetes put vnder couerture
¶ Of fable the rurall people hit toke
¶ Properly as acte refusyng the fygure
¶ Which errour some of hem neuer forsoke
¶ Ofte a false myrour deceyueth a mannes loke
¶ As thou mayst dayly pryue at thyne ey
¶ Thus were the paynymys deceyued generally

¶ That seyng the dedely enemy of mankynde
¶ By his pouer premyssyue entred the ymagys
¶ Within the Temples to make the people blynde
¶ In her ydolatry standyng on hyghe stagys
¶ Insomoche whoo vsed daungerous passagys
¶ Ony maner way by water or be londe
¶ When hyd his sacryfyce his answeere redy fonde

¶ Thus duryng the tyme of deuyacion
¶ From Adam to Moyses was ydolatry
¶ Through the worlde vsed in comon opynyon
¶ These were the goddys that thou there sy
¶ And as for the awayters that stood hem by
¶ They polytyke Phylosophers & Poetes were
¶ Whiche feyned the fables *that* I speke of here

¶ Then seased the tyme of deuyacyon
¶ When Moyses receyued that tables of stone
¶ Entryng the tyme of reuocacyon
¶ On the mounte of Synay stondyng allone
¶ God yaue hym myght ayene all his fone
¶ And then began the olde testament
¶ Whiche to the people by Moyses was sent

¶ And that tyme dured the Incarnacyon
¶ Of Cryste and then began it to sese
¶ For then came the tyme of reconcylyacyon
¶ Of man to god I tell the doutlese
¶ When the sone of man put hym in prese
¶ Wylfully to suffre dethe for mankynde
¶ In holy scrypture this mayst thou fynde

¶ This Reconcylyacyon was the tyme of grace
¶ When founded was the chirche vpon *that* fayre stone
¶ And to holy Peter the keye delyuered was
¶ Of heuen hell dyspoyled was anone
¶ Thys was mankynde delyuered from his fone
¶ And then began the newe testament^[3]

¶ Whiche .iii. tymes a sondry dyuyded
¶ Mayst thou here see yf thou lyst beholde
¶ The fyrst behynde the in pycture ^{.....} is prouyded
¶ The seconde of the lyft honde shew prophet olde
¶ The .iii. on the ryght honde here it is to *the* tolde
¶ Thus hast thou in vysyon the verrey fygure
¶ Of these .iii. tymes here shewed in portrayture

¶ That is to say fyrst of deuyacyon
¶ From Adam to Moyses recordyng scripture
¶ Seconde fro Moyses to the Incarnacyon
¶ Of Cryst kepeth reuocacyon cure
¶ And as for the thyrd thou mayst be verrey sure
¶ Wylt dure from thens to the worldes ende

¶ But now the .iiii. must thou haue in mynde

¶ Whiche is callid properly *the* tyme of pylgremage

¶ After some & some named it otherwyse

¶ And call hit the tyme of daungerous passage

¶ And some of werre that fully hit dyspyse

¶ But what so it be named I wyll the auyse

¶ Remembre it well and prynte it in thy mynde

¶ Wherof the fygure mayst thou me behynde

¶ And elles remembre thyselfe in thyne herte

¶ How Vyce & Vertue dayly theym occupy

¶ In maner one of hem hym to peruerte

¶ Another to bryng hym to endeles glory

¶ Thus they contynue fyght for the vycory

¶ Hit is no nede herof to tell the more

¶ For in this short vysyon *thou* hast seen it before

¶ And as for Attropos greuous compleynt

¶ Vnto the goddys betokeneth noo more

¶ But oonly to shew the how frendely constreynt

¶ On a stedfast herte weyeth full sore

¶ Good wyll requyreth good wyll ayene therfore

¶ Dyscorde to deth hathe ay byn a frende

¶ For Dyscorde bryngeth many to her ende

¶ Wherefore Dethe thought he wolde auenged be

¶ On his frendes quarell yf that he myghte

¶ For her gret vnkyndnesse is somoche as she

¶ Was among hem all had so in despyte

¶ And at that ba[n]ket made of soo lyte

¶ Which caused hym among *hem* to cast in a bone

¶ That founde theym gnawying ynough euerichone

¶ Thus ofte is seen on frende for a nother

¶ Wyll say & doo and some tyme maters feyne

¶ And also kynnysmen a cosyne or a brother

¶ Wyll for his alyer he haue cause compleyne

¶ And where that he loueth doo his besy peyne
¶ His frendes mater as his owne to take
¶ Whiche oft sythe causeth mychyll sorow awake

¶ Be hit ryght or wrong he chargeth not a myte
Ap towarde that poynt he taketh lytyll hede
¶ So that he may haue his frowarde appetyte
Performed he careth not how his soule spede (note
¶ Of God or Deuyll haue suche lytyll drede
¶ How be it one there is that lord is of all
¶ Whiche to euery wyght at last rewarde shall

¶ And as for *the* batayl betwene Vertu holde
¶ Soo playnly appereth to the inwardly
¶ To make exposycyon therof new or olde
¶ Were but superfluyte therefore refuse hit I
¶ In man shall thou fynde *that* were kept dayly
¶ Lyke as *thou* hast seen it fowty[u]e before thy face
¶ The pycure me behynde sheweth it *in* lytyll space

¶ And as for Macrocosme it is nomore to say
¶ But the lesse worlde to the comon entent
¶ Whiche applyed is to man both nyght & day
¶ Soo is man the felde to which all were sent
¶ On bothe partyes & they that thyder went
¶ Sygnyfye nomore but after the condycyon
¶ Of euery manes opynyon

¶ And as for the noble knygt Perseueraunce
¶ Which gate the felde when it was almost gone
¶ Betokeneth nomore but the contynuaunce
¶ Of vertuous lyvyng tyll dethe hath auergone
¶ Who soo wyll doo rewarded is anone
¶ As Vertue was with the crowne on hy
whiche is noo more but euerlastyng glory

¶ And as for Prestynacyon^[4]
¶ That eche of hem rewarded after his deserte

¶ Is to vnderstonde nomore but dampnacyon
¶ To vycyous people is the verrey scourge smert
¶ Rewarde for they fro Vertue wolde peruert
¶ And endelesse Ioye is to hem that be electe
¶ Rewarded & to all that folow the same secte

¶ And as for the keyes of the posternes fyue
Whiche were to Morpleus rewarded for his laboure
¶ Sygnyfye not elles but whyle man is on lyue
¶ His fyue inwarde wyttes shall be euery hour
¶ In his slepe occupied in hele & in langour
¶ With fantasyes tryfels Illusyons & dremes
¶ Whiche Poetes call Morpleus stremes

¶ And as for Residiuacyon is nomore to say
¶ But after Confessyon tornyng ayene to synne
¶ Whiche to euery man retornyth sauns delay
¶ To vycyous lyuyng agayn hym to wyne
¶ Whyle ony man lyueth wyll it neuer blynne
¶ That cursed conclusyon for to bryng aboute
¶ But Reason with Sadnes kepe it styll oute

¶ Here hast thou properly the verrey sentence
¶ Perde now declared of this vysyon
¶ The pycture also yeueth clere intellygence
¶ Therof beholden with good dyscresyon
¶ Loke well aboute and take consyderasyon
¶ As I haue declared whether hit soo be
¶ A syr quoth Morpleus what tolde I the

¶ Hast thou properly the verrey sentence
¶ Loke on yon wall yonder before
¶ And all that tyme stood I in a wyre
¶ Whiche way first myn hert wolde yeue more
¶ To loke in a stody stood I therfore
¶ Neuerthelesse at last as Morpleus me badde
¶ I loked forwarde with contenaunce sadde

¶ Where I beheld in portrayture
¶ The maner of the felde euen as it was
Shewed me before & euery creature
¶ On bothe sydes beyng drawyng in small space
¶ Soo caryously in soo lytyll a compace
¶ In all this worlde was neuer thyng wrought
¶ Hit were Impossyble in erthe to be thought

¶ And when I had long beholde that pycture
¶ What *quod* Morpleus how longe shalte thou loke
¶ Daryng as a dastard on yon portrayture:
¶ Come of for shame thy wytte stante a croke
¶ I heryng that myn herte to me toke
¶ Towarde the fourthe wall tornyng my vysage
¶ Where I sawe Poetes & Phylosophers sage

¶ Many one moo that at the banket
¶ Serued the goddes as I sayde before
¶ Som were made standyng & som in chayris set
¶ Som lokyng on bokys as they had stodyed sore
¶ Som drawyng almenakis & in her hondis bore
¶ Astyrlabes takyng the altytude of the sonne
¶ Among whome Dyogenes sate in a tonne

¶ And as I was lokyng on that fourthe wall
¶ Of Dyogenes beholdyng the ymage
¶ Sodeynly Doctryne began me to call
¶ And bad me tourne towarde hyr my vysage
¶ And soo then I dyde with humble corage
¶ Whan thynkest *thou* she sayd hast *thou* not thentent
¶ Yet of these foure walles what they represent

¶ The pycture on the fyrst *that* standeth at my bake
¶ Sheweth the *the* present tyme of pylgremage
¶ Of whiche before I vnto the spake
¶ Whiche is the tyme of daungerous passage
¶ The seconde dyscretly agayne my vysage
¶ The tyme expresseth of Deuyacyon

¶ Whyle paynyme lawe had the domynacyon

¶ The thryd wall standyng on my lyfe honde

¶ The tyme representeth of Reuocacyon

¶ And the fourthe standyng on my ryght honde

¶ Determyne the tyme of Reconsylyacyon

¶ This is the effecte of thy vysyon

¶ Wherefore the nedeth no more theron to muse

¶ Hit were but veyne thy wyttes to dysuse

¶ But duryng the tyme of Reconsylyacyon

¶ Thy tyme of pylgremage loke well *thou* spende

¶ And then woll gracyous Predestynacyon

¶ Bryng the to glory at thy law ende

¶ And euen with that came to my mynde

¶ My fyrst conclusyon that I was aboute

¶ To haue dreuen er slepe made me to lute

¶ That is to say how Sensualyte

¶ *With* Reason to acorde myght be brought aboute

¶ Whiche caused me to knele downe on my kne

¶ And beseke Doctryne determyne that doute

¶ Oo Lord god sayd Doctryne canst *thou* not withoute

¶ Me that conclusyon bryng to an ende

¶ Ferre is fro the wytte & ferther good mende

¶ And euen with that Dethe gan appere

¶ Shewyng hymselfe as though that he wolde

¶ His darte haue occupied within that herbere

¶ But there was none for hym yong nor olde

¶ Saue oonly I Doctrine hym tolde

¶ And when I herde hyr with hym comon thus

¶ I me withdrew behynde Morpleus.

¶ Dredyng full sore lest he with his dart.

¶ Through Doctrynes wordes ony entresse.

¶ In me wolde haue had or claymed ony part

¶ Which sholde haue caused me grete heuynesse

¶ Within whiche tyme & short processe
¶ Came thyder Reason and Sensualyte.
¶ A quoth Doctryne ryght welcome be ye

¶ Hit is not long sythe we of you spake
¶ Ye must er ye goo determyne a doute
¶ And euen with that she the mater brake
¶ To theym & tolde hit euery where aboute
¶ I wolde haue be thens yf I had moute
¶ For fere I loked as blake as a cole
¶ I wolde haue copen in a mouse hole

¶ What quoth Doctryne where is he now
¶ That meu[i]d this mater straunge & dyffuse
¶ He is a cowarde I make myn auow
¶ He hyded his hede his mocyon to refuse
¶ Blame hym not *quod* Reason alway *that* to vse
¶ When he seeth Dethe soo nere at his honde
¶ Yet is his part hym to withstonde

¶ Or at the leste way elles fro hym flee
¶ As long as he may who dooth other wyse
¶ Is an ydeote quoth Sensualytee
¶ Who dredeth not Dethe wyse men hym dyspyse
¶ What said Doctryne how long hathe this gyse
¶ Be holden & vsed thus atwixe you tweyne
¶ Ye were not wonte to acorde certeyne

¶ Yes quoth Reason in this poynt alway
¶ To euery man haue we yeuen our counsayll
¶ Dethe for to flee as long as they may
¶ Although wo otherwyse haue done our trauayl
¶ Eche other to repress yet withoute fayll
¶ In that poynt oonly dyscordeth we neuer
¶ Thus condescended therin be we for euer

¶ Aha sayd Doctryne then is the conclusyon
¶ Clerely determined of the gret doute

¶ That here wes meuyd & halfe in derysyon
¶ She me then called & bade me loke oute
¶ Come forth she sayd & feere not this route
¶ And euen with that Reason & Sensualyte
¶ And Dethe fro thens were vanysshed all thre

¶ Then loked I forth as Doctryne me badde
¶ When Dethe was gone me thought I was bolde
¶ To shewe myselfe but yet was I sadde
¶ Me thought my doute was not as I wolde
¶ Clerely and openly declared & tolde
¶ Hit sowned to me as a parable
¶ Derke as a myste or a fayned fable

¶ And Doctryne my conceyte gan espy
¶ Wherefore sayd she standest thou soo styll
¶ Wherin is thy thought arte thou in stody
¶ Of thy questyon hast thou not thy fyll
¶ To the declared tell me thy wyll.
¶ Herdest thou not Reason & Sensualyte
¶ Declared thy doute here before the

¶ Forsothe quoth I I herde what they sayde
¶ But neuerthelesse my wytte is so thynne
¶ And also of Dethe I was so afrayde
¶ That hit is out where hit vent ynne
¶ And so that mater can I not wynne
¶ Without your helpe & benyuolence
¶ Therof to expresse the veray sentence

¶ Well quod Doctryne then yeue attendaunce
¶ Vnto my wordes & thou shalt here
¶ Openly declared the concordance
¶ Atwene Sensualyte & Reason in fere
¶ If thou take hede hit clerely dooth apere
¶ How they were knette in one opynyon
¶ Bothe agayn Dethe helde contradycon

¶ Whiche concordance no more sygnyfyeth
¶ To playne vnderstandyng but in euery mane
¶ Bothe Sensualyte & Reason applyeth
¶ Rather Dethe to flee then with hir to be tane
¶ Loo in that poynt accorde they holly thane
¶ And in all other they clerely dyscorde
¶ Thus is trewly set thy doubtfull monacorde

¶ I heryng that kneled on my kne
¶ And thanked her lowly for her dyscyplyne
¶ That she wouchesafe of her benygnyte
¶ Of tho gret doubtes me to enlumyne
¶ Well was she worthy to be called Doctryne
¶ If it had be no more but for the solucyon
¶ Of my demaunde & of this straunge vysyon

¶ And as I with myne hede began for to bow
¶ As me well ought to do her reuerence
¶ She thens departed I can not tell how
¶ But within a moment gone was she thens
¶ Then sayd Morpleus let vs go hens
¶ what sholde we here tarye lengere
¶ Hast thou not herde a generall answeare

¶ To all thy materes that thou lyst to meue
¶ My tyme draweth nere that I must rest
¶ And euen therewith he toke me by the sleue
¶ And sayd goo we hens for that sholde I best
¶ As good is ynough as a grete fest
¶ Thou hast seen ynough holde the content
¶ And euen with *that* forthe with hym I went

¶ Tyll he had me brought agene to my bedde
¶ where he me founde and then pryuely
¶ He stale awaye I coude not vnderstande
¶ were he became but sodeynly
¶ As he came he went I tell you veryly
¶ whiche done fro slepe I gan to awake

¶ My body all in swet began for to shake

¶ For drede of the syght that I had sene
¶ wenyng to me all had be trew
¶ Actuelly done where I had bene
¶ That batyll holde twene Vyce & Vertew
¶ But when I see hit hit was but a whew
¶ A dreame a fantasy & a thyng of nought
¶ To study thereon I had nomore thought

¶ Tyll at the last I gan me bethynke
¶ For what cause shewed was this vysyon
¶ I knew not wherefore I toke pen & ynke
¶ And paper therof to make mencyon
¶ In wrytyng takyng consyderacyon
¶ That noo defaute were found in me
¶ whereon accused I ought for to be

¶ For slouth that I had left hit vntolde
¶ Neyther by mouthe nor in remembraunce
¶ Put it in wrytyng where thorough manyfolde
¶ wayes of accusacion myght torne me to greuaunce
¶ All this I sawe as I lay in a traunce
¶ But wheder it was with myne ey bodely
¶ Or not in certayn god knoweth & not I

¶ That to dyscerne I purpose not to dele
¶ Soo large by my wyll it longeth not to me
¶ were hit dreame or vysyon for your owne wele
¶ All that shall hit rede here rad or se
¶ Take thereof the best & let the worst be
¶ Try out the corne clene from the chaff
And then may ye say ye have a sure staff

¶ To stande by at nede of ye wyll it holde
¶ And walke by the way of Vertue
¶ But alwey beware be ye yong or olde
¶ That your Frewyll ay to Vertue more

¶ Apply than to Vyce the easier may be bore
¶ The burden of the felde that ye dayly fyght
¶ Agayn your .iii. enemyes for all her gret myght

¶ That is to say the Deuyll & the Flesshe
¶ And also the worlde with hith his glosyng chere
¶ Whyche on you loketh euer newe & fresshe
¶ But he is not as he dooth apere
¶ Loke ye kepe you ay out of his daungere
¶ And soo the vycory shall ye obteyne
¶ Vyce fro you exyled & Vertue in you reyne

¶ And then shall ye haue the triumphall guerdon
¶ That god reserued to euery creature
¶ Aboue in his celestyall mansyon
¶ Ioye & blysse infynyte eternally to endure
¶ Wherof we say we wolde fayne be sure
¶ But the way thyderwarde to holde be we lothe
¶ That oft sythe causeth *the* good lord to be wrothe

¶ And by our deserte our habytacyon chaungeth
¶ Fro Ioye to payne & woo perpetuely
¶ From his glorious syght thus he vs estraungeth
¶ For our vycyous lyuyng thorough our owne folly
¶ Wherefore let vs praye to that lorde of glory
¶ Whyhe we in erthe be *that* he wyll yeue vs grace
¶ So vs here to guyde that we may haue a place

¶ Accordyng to oure Regeneracyon
¶ Which heuenly spyrytes his name to magnify.
¶ Whiche downe descendeth for oure redempcyon
¶ Offryng hymselfe on the crosse to his fader on hy
¶ Now benygne Ihesu that boren was of Mary
¶ All that to this vysyon haue gyuen her audyence
¶ Graunte eternal Ioye after thy last sentence

A M E N

¶ Here endeth a lytyll Treatyse
named The assemble of goddes





TRANSCRIBER'S NOTES:

 next line is missing from the original. The missing line reads:

he went thederward I shall tell you more

 next line is missing from the original. The missing line reads:

n to the palyse as he had be wood

 next line is missing from the original. The missing line reads:

ie Crystyn pepyll beleve in present.

s line has some missing letters from the middle. The line should read:

for Prescience and Predestinacion

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OF GODDES ***

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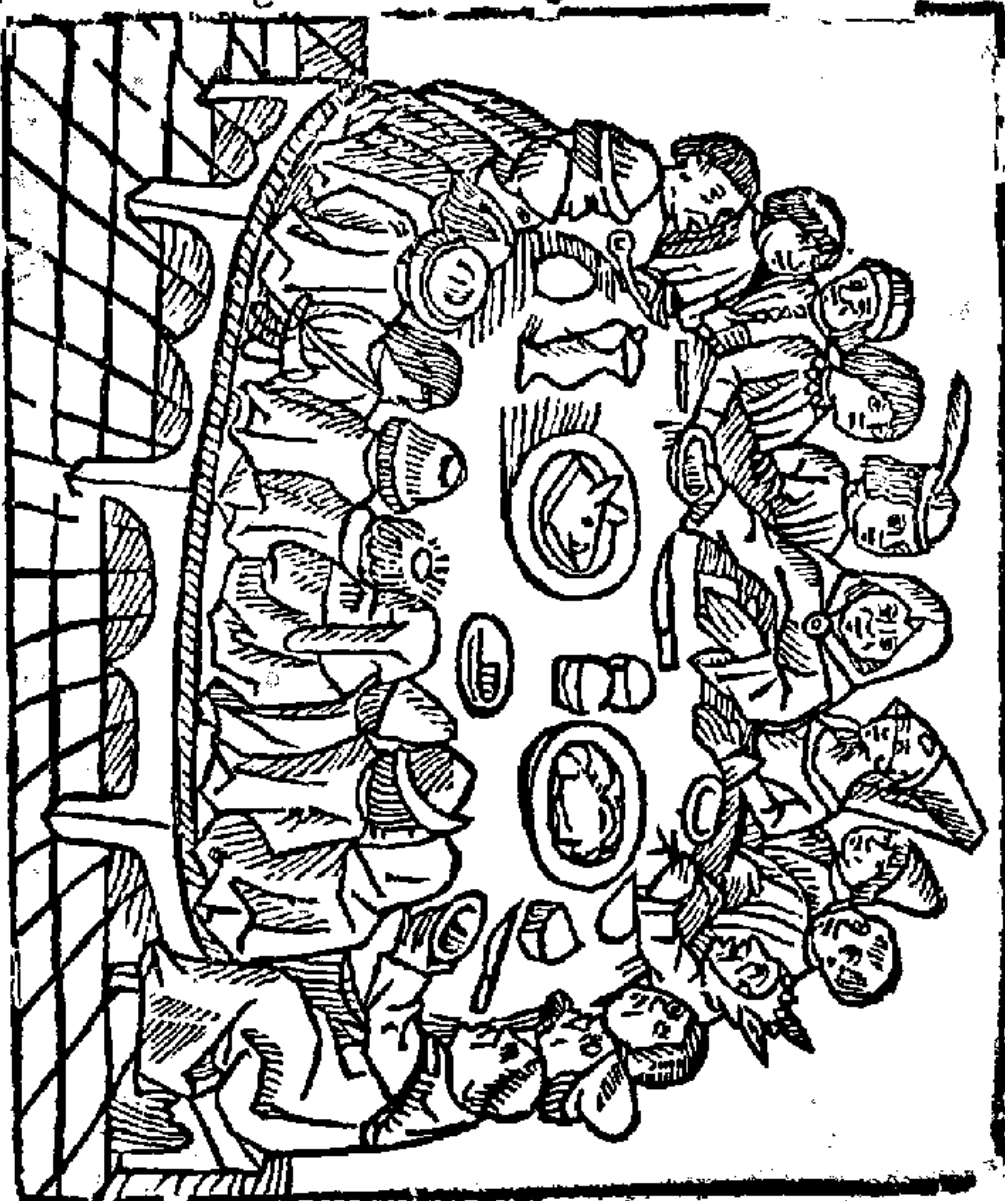
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Here foloweth the Interpretacoin of the na
mes of goddes and goddesses as is reherced
in this tretyse folowynge as Poetes wypte



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Cerberus is as moche to saye as the **S**onne.
Apollo is the same or elles **G**od of syght.
Morpleus **S**hower of drems
Pluto **G**od of hell.
Mynos **J**uge of hell.
Cerberus **P**orter of hell.
Eolus the wynde or **G**od of the **E**ye.
Diana **G**oddesse of wode and chafe.
Phebe the **M**one or **G**oddesse of waters.
Aurore **G**oddess of **p** mornynge or **s**pyng of **d** daye
Mars **G**od of batayll
Jupiter **G**od of wysdom.
Juno **G**oddesse of rycheffe
Saturne **G**od of colde.
Ceres **G**oddesse of corne.
Cupido **G**od of loue.
Othea **G**oddesse of wysdome.
Fortune **T**he varyant **G**oddesse
Pan **G**od shepherdes.
Jlys **G**oddess of frute.
Neptunus **G**od of the se.
Mynetue **G**oddess of **p** bataill or of herueit
Bachus **G**od of wyne.
Mercurius **G**od of langage.
Venus **G**oddesse of loue.
Dyscorde **G**oddess of debate & stryffe
Altropos **D**ethe
Here endeth **p** interpretacyon of the names
of **G**oddess & **G**oddesses as is rehersed in the
treatyse folowynge as poetes wyte.

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Whan Phebus the crabbe had
nere his cours ronne
And toward þe Leon his Jour
ney gan take,
To loke on Pythagoras speere/
I had begonne

¶ Sytting all solytary allone besyde a lake.
¶ Quiyng on a maner how þe I myght make.
¶ Realon and sensualyte in one to a corde.
¶ But I coude not bryng about þe manacorde.

¶ For longe er I myght slepe me gan oppres
¶ So ponderous þe I coude make none obstacle
¶ In myne hede was fall suche an heuynesse.
¶ I was fayne to drawe to myne habytacle.
¶ To rowne w a pylow me lemyd best tnyacle.
¶ So leyde I me downe myn dycale to releue.
¶ Anone cam in Morpleus & toke me by þe sleue

¶ And as I soo lay halfe in a traunse
¶ Twene slepyng & wakyng he bad me aryse.
¶ For he sayd I must yeue attendaunce.
¶ To the grete Courte of Wynes the Justyle.
¶ We nought auayled ayene hym to lylogyle.
¶ For hit is oft sayd by hem that yet lyues.
¶ He must nedes go that the deuell dryues.

¶ Whan I see noo better but I must go.
¶ I sayd I was redy at his comaundment.
¶ Wheder that he wolde me lede to or fro.

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¶ Soo by Jazole and forth with hym went.
¶ Tyll he had me brought to the parliament.
¶ Where Pluto late and kepte is estate.
¶ And with hym Hypnos the Juge desperate.

¶ But as we thyderwarde went by the way.
¶ J hym besought his name me to tell.
¶ Morpleus he sayde thou me call may.
¶ As he sayde J thay where do ye dwell.
¶ In heuen or in ethe eyther elles in hell.
¶ Nay he sayde myn abydyng most comonly
¶ Is in a lytyll corner called fantasy.

¶ And as sone as he thyle wordes had sayd.
¶ Cerberus the porter of hell w his cheyne.
¶ Brought theder Colus i ragges euyl arayd.
¶ Agayst whom Neptun⁹ & Dyana dyd copeyt.
¶ Saynge thus O Hypnos þ Juge souerayn.
¶ Gyue thy cruell iugemēt aye this traytour so
¶ That we may haue cause to p[er]sele thy lord Pluto.

¶ Then was there made a proclamacyon.
¶ In Plutoos name comaunded scylence.
¶ Upon the payn of strait correccyon.
¶ That Dyana & Neptun⁹ might haue audience.
¶ To declare her grefe of the grete offence.
¶ To hem do by Colus wheron they complained.
¶ And to begyn Dyana was constreyned.

¶ Whiche thus begyn as ye shall here.

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¶ Saynge in this wyse. O thou lord Pluto.
¶ Wyth thy myge Hymnos lyttynge wth thei fere
¶ Execute your fury vpon Colus soo.
¶ Accordyng to thofence that he to me hath do
¶ That I haue no cause forther to appele.
¶ Whyche yf I do shall not be for youre wele.

¶ Remembre fyrst how I a goddesse pure.
¶ Duer all desertes/forestes and chaces.
¶ Haue the gudyng and vnder my cure.
¶ This traytour colus hath mani of my places
¶ Destroyd wth his blastes & daily me manaces
¶ Where ony wood is he shall make it playne.
¶ If he to his lyberte may reso^rte ageyne

¶ The grettest trees that ony may may fynde
¶ In forest to shade the deere for her comfo^rte.
¶ He breketh hē aloder or rendith he rote & ride
¶ Out of the erthe this is his dyspo^rte.
¶ So that the deere shall haue noo reso^rte.
¶ Wythin sho^rte tyme to noo maner shade
¶ Where thozough the game is lykly to fade.

¶ Which to my name a reproche synguler.
¶ Sholde be for euer whyle the worlde laste.
¶ And to all the goddes an hygh dysple^rer.
¶ To see the game soo destroyed by his blaste.
¶ Wherfore a remedy puruey in haste.
¶ And lete hym be punysshed attter his offence.
¶ Cousyder the cryme and geue your sentence.

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And whan Dyana had made her compleyst
To mynos the Juge in Plutoos presence.
Came forth Neptun⁹ wth bysage pale & feynt
Despyng of fauour to haue audyence.
Saynge thus Pluto to thy magnyfycence.
I shall reherce what this creature.
Colus hath done me out of mesure.

Thou knowest well that I haue the charge
Ouer all the se and th^{er}of god I am.
No shyp may sayl Keruel/bote ne barge.
Grete karyk nor hulke wth ony lpyng may.
But he haue my saueconduyte than.
Who me offendith wythin my Jurysdyccyon.
O wyth to submyt him to my correccyon.

But in asmoche as it is now soo.
That ye hym here haue as your prysoner
I shall shew my compleynt soo.
Wherfore I pray you that ye wyll here.
And let hy not escape out of your daunger.
Tyl he haue made full sethe & recompence
For hurt of my name throught his grete offence

Fyrst to begyn this Colus hath ofte.
Made me to retozne mi course agein nature.
Wyth his grete blastes whan he hath be alofte
And charged me to labour fer out of mesure.
It was grete merueyl how I might endure
The com of my swete wyll testyfy.

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That on the se bankes I be beten full hye.

Secundly where my nature is.

Both to eb & flowe and so thy course to kepe.

Ofte of myne entent hath he made me mys

Where as I shulde haue fylled dykes depe.

At a full water I myght not theder crepe.

Before my season came to retorne ageyn.

And than went I faster than I wold certayn

Thus he hath me dryuen ayen myn entente

And contrary to my course naturall.

Where I shuld haue be he made me absente

To my grete dyshonour & in especyall.

Do thyng he vled that worst was of all.

For where I my lauegard graunted

Any that coste he comonly haunted

Of very pure malyce and sylfwill.

They to destroy in dyspyte of me.

To whome I promised both in gode & yll.

For to be her protectour in all aduersyte.

That to they shulde fall vpon the se.

And euen sodenly or they coud beware

Wyth a soden pyrry he lapped they in care.

And full oft syth wyth hys boystous blaste.

Or they myght bewat he drof he on þe sond

And other while he brake top sayl & mast.

Which caused thei to peryssh or thei cā to lond

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Then curled they the tyme þ̄ euēr thei me fāð
Thus amonge the people lost is my name.
And so by his labour put I am to blame.

Consyder this mater and ponder my case.
Tender my compleynt as rygure requyareth
Shew forth poure sentence w̄ a breef clause
I may not longe tary the tyme fast erpyreth
The offence is grete wherfoze it despyreth.
The more greuous payn and hasty iugemēt
For offence donwylfully wyl non auylement.

And whā þ̄ god pluto a whyl had hi bethought
He rowned w̄ mynos what was to do.
Then he sayde openly loke thou sayl nought
Thy sentence to prue wythoute fauoure soo.
Lyke as thou hast herde the causes the too.
And so euently dele twene thise partyes twain
That none of hē haue cause on þ̄ other cōpleint.

Thenne sayd mynos full indyfferently.
To Dyana & Neptunus is there ony more.
That ye wyl declare ageyn hym openly.
Nay in dede they sayd we kepe none ynstore/
We haue sayd I nough to punyshe hym foze
If ye in this mater be not parcyall.
Remembre your name was wont to be egall.

Well than sayd Mynos now let vs see.
What this boystous Colus for hyself can say

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¶ For here Prima facie to vs doth appere.
¶ That he hath offended no man can say naye
¶ Wherefore thou Colus withoute more delaye
¶ Shape vs an answer to thyne accusemente
¶ And elles I must procede vpon thy iugement

¶ And euen as col^{us} was onward to haue said
¶ For his excuse came in a messengere.
¶ Fro god Appolo to Pluto and hym prayde.
¶ On his behalfe that he withoute daungere
¶ Wolds to hym come & br^{ig}ge w^{it}h hym w^{it}h sc^{re}
¶ Dyana and Neptunus vnto his banket
¶ And yf they dysdeyred hys self he wold hē fet.

¶ Moreover he sayde to god Appolo
¶ Desyred to haue respyte of the iugemente
¶ Of Colus bothe of Hynos and Pluto
¶ So Dyana & Neptun^{us} were ther w^{it}h cōtēt
¶ And yf they were dyspoled to assente
¶ That he myght come vnto his presente
¶ He it desyred to knowe his offence

¶ What say ye herto sayd Pluto to hem twayne
¶ Wyl ye both assente that it shal be thus
¶ Ye sayd the goddesse for my parte certeyne
¶ And I also sayd this Neptunus
¶ I am well plesid quod this Colus
¶ And whan they had a whyle th^{er} tog^{et}her spoke
¶ Pluto commaunded the court to be broke

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And thay togeder went they in fere.
Pluto and Neptunus ledynge the goddesse
Whome folowed Cerberus w his pysonere.
And alderlast wth grette heuynesse.
Came J and Morpleus to the foxteresse.
Of the god appolo vnto his banket.
Where many goddes and goddesles met.

Whay Appolo se that they were come.
He was ryght glad & prayed theym to syt.
Nay sayd Dyana this is all and some.
Ye shall nie pardone J shall not syt yet.
J shall fyrste know why Colus abyde.
And what execucyon shall on hym be doo
For his offence well sayd Appollo.

Madame ye shall haue all your plesere.
Syth that it wyl none otherwyle be.
But fyfte J pray pou let me p mater here
Why he is brought in this perplexyte.
Well sayd Pluto that shall ye sone se.
And gay to declare euen by and by.
Bothe theyr complayntes ordynatly.

And whay Appolo had herd the reporte
Of Pluto in a maner smyllynge he sayd.
J se well Colus thou hast small comferte.
Thy selfe to excuse thou maylt be dylmayde.
For to here so grette cōpleyntes aye the layd
And not wthstondyng if thou can say ought

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For thyne own wele say and tary nought

Nota

Horloth sayd Colus yf I had respyte.

Hereto any answere coude I counterfete.

But to haue her grace more is my delyte.

Wherfore I pray you all for me entrete.

That I may by your request her gode grace gete

And what payn or greif ye for me prouyde

Wythout any grutchyng I shall it abyde.

To good dame sayd god Appollo.

What may he do more but sew to your grace.

Beholde how the tezes from his eyen goo.

It is satisfaction half for his trespase.

Now gloꝝyous goddes shew your petioⁿ face

To this poore prysoner at my request.

All we for youre honour thynke thus is best.

And yf it lyke you to do in thys wyle.

And so to foryeue hym clerely his offence.

One thyng surely I wylI you promyse.

If he ought rebell and make resystence

Or dysobey vnto your sence.

For euery tree that he maketh fall.

Out of the erthe any Cryle shall.

Soo that youre game shall not dyscrease

For lacke of shade i dare vndertake

Well syꝝ Appollo sayd she than wylI I cease

Off all my rancour and mercy w you make

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¶ And than god Neptune of his maner spak
¶ Sayng th^o appolo though dyana hym relese
¶ Yet shall he sue to me to haue his pease.

¶ A layd Appolo ye wende I had forgete.
¶ You for my lady Dyana the goddesse.
¶ Nay thynke not so for I wyl you entrete.
¶ As well as her wythoute longe procelle.
¶ Wyl ye agre that Phebus your maystrelle.
¶ May haue the guydyng of your barpaunce.
¶ I shall abyde quod he/her ordynaunce.

¶ Wel than quod appolo I pray you godds all
¶ And goddeses that ben here presente.
¶ That ye companable wyl a boorde falle.
¶ Nay than layd Othea it is not conueniente.
¶ A dew ordre in euery place is expediente.
¶ To be hadde wherfore ye may not lette.
¶ To be your own marshal at your own baket

¶ And whan appolo se it wolde none other be
¶ He called to hym Aurora the goddesse.
¶ And layd though ye wepe ye shall before me.
¶ Kepe your courte and put yourself in p^lse
¶ Soo he her set syt at his owne messe.
¶ Wyth her myst clothes w^h teres all be i^lpt
¶ The medewes in may knew therof her topleit

¶ Next her sat Mars myghty god and strong
¶ Wyth a flamme of fyre enuyroned all aboout

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A crown of yron on his hede a spere i his hōd
It semed by his chē as he wold haue fought.
And next vnto hym as I perceyue mought.
Satthē goddesse Dyana in a mantell fyne.
Of black sylke purfyled w poudered crimine

Lyke as he had take h mantell & the ryng
And next vnto her arayed roally.
Sat the god Juypter in his demenynge.
Full sad and wyle he semed lykerly.
A crowne of tynne stood on his hede.
And that Irecorde of all phylosophers.
Elytyll stoze of Coyne kepe in her cofres.

Torned to hē in syttyng next there was
The goddesse Juno full rychely besene.
In a lercote h thone as bryght as glas
Of goldsmyth werk w spāgles wrought beben
Of royall ryches wanted she none I wene.
And next to her sat the god saturne.
That oft tyth causeth many one to moene.

But he was clad methought straungely
For of froste & snowe was all his aray.
In his honde he helde a sawchon all bloody
It semed by his chere as he wold make a frai
A baudryck of Ilykles about his neckegape
He had. and aboue on hygh on his hede.
Couchid w hayl stōes he wered a crow of lede:

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And nexte in ordre was set by his syde.
Ceres the goddesse in a garmente.
Of lache cloth made wth sleues large & wyde
Embrowdered wyth sleues and cycles bent
Of all maner greynes she sealed y^r patente.
In token y^r she was goddes of corne.
Olte Poetes saye she beryth the heruest hoyn

Then was there set the god cuppydo.
All frellhe & galaunte and costly in aray.
Wyth ouches and rynges he was beset so.
y paleys therof shyn as though it had be day
A kerchyff of pleisuris stood ouer his helm ay
The goddesse Ceres he looked in the face.
And wyth one arme he her dyde embrace.

Next to Cupido in order by and by
Of wordly wysdum sat the foxterelle.
Called Dichea chyef grounde of polycy.
Reuler of knyghthode of prudence y^r goddes
Clad all in purpure was she more & lesse.
Saaf on her hede a crowne there stode.
Couched wyth perles oryent fyne & good.

And nexte to her was god Pluto set
Wyth a derke myste enuyrond al about.
His clothy was made of a smoky net.
His colour was bothe wythin & wythoute.
Foule derke & dymme his eyen grete & stoute.
Of fyre & sulfure all his odoure wase.

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¶ That was me while I beheld his face

¶ Fortune the goddesse wth her perty face.

¶ Was unto Pluto next in order sette.

¶ Warpant she was ay in thorte space.

¶ Her whele was redy to turne wythout let.

¶ Her gowne was of gawdy grene clamelet

¶ Chaungeable of sondry dyuerse colours.

¶ To þ^e condycyous accordyng to her shoures

¶ And by her sat thoughe he vnworthy were.

¶ The reorde god Pan of shepherdes þ^e gyde

¶ Glad in tussel frese & breched lyke a bere.

¶ Wyth a grete terbor hangyng by his syde.

¶ A shepcok in his hōd he spared for no pryde.

¶ And by his fete lay a prekered curre.

¶ He rateled in þ^e throte as he had þ^e murre.

¶ I lvs the goddess bare hym company.

¶ For at the table next she sat by his syde.

¶ In a close byz^e all embrowdered curpously

¶ Wth braunches and leues brood large & wyde.

¶ Grene as any grasse in þ^e somer tyde.

¶ Of all maner frute she had the gouernaunce

¶ Of fauours odyferous was her sustynauns

¶ Next to her thay was god Neptunus set.

¶ He saoured lyke a fysshcr of h^y i spak before

¶ It semed by his clithes as they had be wet.

¶ About h^y i his gyrdelsted hig fysshes mani a xx^{ix}

score

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Of his straunge aray merueyled Iose.
Ashyp wyth a top and sayle was hys cresse.
He thought he was gayly dysgysled at f fess.

Than toke mynerue the goddes her sete.
Joyntly to Neptunus all in curas cladde.
Gaulelettis on hōdes & sabatōis on her fete
She loked about as though she had be mad.
Alyhamer and a sythe on her hede she hadde
She wered two bokelers one by her syde.
That other ye wote were this was al her pyd

Thā cam f god bach⁹ & by her set hū down
Holdynge in his honde a cuppe full of wyne.
Of grene vyne leues he wered a Joly croun
He was clad in clustres of grapes gode & fine
A garlonde of yuy he chose for his lpygne.
On his hede he had a thredbare kēdail hode.
A gymlot and a fauset therupon stode.

Next hym sat phebus wyth her colour pale.
Sat she was of face but of complexion feynle.
She sayd she reweled Neptun⁹ & made hū bayl
And ones in f monthe w pheb⁹ was she meit
Allo ne were she Ceres were ateynte
Thus she sat & tolde the myght of her nature
A on her hede she wered a croun of siluer pure

Joyntly to her Marcurys toke his lee.
As came to his cours wytnesse the zodpake.

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¶ He had a gylden tonge as fyll for his degree
¶ In eloquence of langage he passed al þ pake
¶ For in his talkyng noman coud fynde lake
¶ A box wyth quyk syluer he had in his honde/
¶ Multyplyers know it wel in euery londe

¶ By hym sat dame Uen⁹ w colour crySTALLINE
¶ Whos long here shone as wyre of gold bryzt
¶ Cryspe was her skyn her eyen columbyne
¶ Raupshed myne herte her chere was so lyzt
¶ Patrones of plesaunce be named wel she myzt
¶ A smocke was her wede garnysshed curpulle
¶ But all other she had a wanton eye

¶ On her hede she wered a red copet crowne
¶ A nosegay she had made ful plesauntly
¶ Bytwene her & aurore Apollo let hym doune
¶ Wyth his beames bryght he shone so feruently
¶ That he ther wyth gladyd al þ company
¶ A crown of pure gold was on his hede let
¶ In syne þ he was mayster & lord of þ banquet

¶ Nota

¶ Thus was the table set round aboute
¶ Wyth goddes & goddesses as i haue you told
¶ Alwaytynge on the bord was a grette route
¶ Of sage phylosophers & poetes many fold
¶ There was sad Sychero & Arystotle olde
¶ Cholome Doxothe wyth Dyogenes
¶ Plato Myllchala and wyle Socrates

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¶Sortes & Sapha? w^h hermes stode behynd
¶Auyten & Aueroys wyth hem were in fere
¶Calpen & ppocras that phylsoph^{ys} haue in mynd
¶Wyth help of Esculappo toward hē drowner
¶Allyggle Orace Duyd and Omcre
¶Euclyde and albert yauē her attendaunce
¶To do the goddys & goddesses plesaunce

¶Horcherded Orphe? was there w^h his harpe.
¶And as a poyt musycal made he melody
Other mistral had thei non saf Dangā to carpe
¶Of his leud bagpyp which caused h^e compani
¶To law yet many mo thei wē yf i shuld notly
¶Som yong som old both better and worse
¶But mo of they? names can I not reherce

¶Of al maner deyntes there was habūdālice
¶Of metes & drynkes foyson plenteuous
¶In cam Dyscord to haue vanyaunce
¶But there was no roum to set her i that hous
¶The goddis remembred the scylme odious
¶Among the thre goddesses h^e had wrought
¶At the fest of Peleus wherfore they thought

¶They wold not w^h her delc in a venture
¶Lest she hem brought to som inconueniente
¶She scyng this was wroth out of melure
¶And in that grete wrath out of h^e paleysle wēt
¶Sayng to herself that there shuld thei repent
¶And anone w^h Atropes happed the to mete.

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As he had ben a goost came in a wyrdyng shete

She toke hym by þe hond & rowned in his ere

And told hy of the banket þe was so delycate.

How he was receyued & what chere she had þere

And how euery god sat in his astate

Is it thus quod attropos what in þe deupls date

And he sayd I se well how the game goth

Ones yet for your sake shal I make he wroth

And whan she had hym al togyder told

From her he departed & of her toke his leue

Sayng þe for her sake his way take he wolde

In to the paleys his maters to meue

And or he thens went he trowed he to greue.

Wyth such tydynges as he wold hem tel

So forth he went & spake wordes fell

Whan he came in the pience of þe goddis yle

As he had ben mad he loked hym a bout

His shete from his body downe he let fall

And on a reud maner he saluted al the route

Wyth a bold boys spekyng wordes stoute

But he spake all holow as it had ben one

Had I poke in a nother world þe had wo begon

He stode forth boldly wth gryn countenaunce

Sayng on this wyle as ye shal here

All ye goddes yeue attendaunce

Unto my wordes wout all daungere

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¶ Remembre how ye made me your offycere
¶ All tho wyth my darte fynally to chastyle
¶ That I dysobeyed or wolde your lawdyspise

¶ And for the more surete seiled my patent
¶ Gyping me full power so to occupy
¶ Wherto I haue employed myn entent
¶ And that can dame Nature testefy
¶ If she be examyned she wyll not it deny
¶ For whan she forsakyth any creature
¶ I am al redy to take hy to my cure

¶ Thus haue I deuily wyth al mydyligence
¶ Executed the offyce of olde antyquyte
¶ To me by you graited by your comyn sctee
¶ For I spared none hygh nor low degre
¶ So that on my parte no faute hath be
¶ For as sone as ony to me commytted was
¶ I mote hy to þ hert he had none other grace

¶ Hector of Troy for al his cheualry
¶ Alexander the grete & myghty conquerour
¶ Iulius Cesar w al his companye
¶ Dauid nor Iosue nor worthy Artur
¶ Charlis the noble that was so gret of honour
¶ Nor Judas Machabee for al his trew herte
¶ Nor Godfrey of Boleyn coud me not aserte

¶ Nabugodonozor for al his grete pryde
¶ Nor the kyng of Egypt cruel Pharaon

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Iason ne Hercules went they neuer so wyde.
Coldras Hanyball nor gentyll Syppo.
Acyllus Achilles nor many a nother mo
For fayr nor foule gat of me no grace
But al be at y last I lealed hem w my mace.

Thus haue I brought euery creature
To an ende both may tyll he foule and best
And euery other thyng w whome dame nature
Hath my Iurysdyccion eyther most or lest
Except oonly one w whome your be best
Is to me broke for ye me promysed
That my myght of non shold haue be dyspyled

Wherof the aontrary daoe I well a uow
Is trew for one there is that wyl not apply
Into my correction nor is no wyse how
To the dynt of my darte for dole nor desteny.
What conifort he hath nor the cause why
That he so rebellyth I can not thynk of ryzt
But yf ye hy graunted your alders lascondyght.

And yf he so haue than do ye not as goddis.
For a goddys wrytyng may not reuerled be.
If it shold I wold not gyue you a pefecoddy
For graut of your patent of offycenere of fee.
Wherfore y this mater do me equyte
Accerday to my patent for tyl this be do
The haue nomore my scrupse nor my gode wy

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And whan al the goddis had attropos hered
As they had ben wode brayd by attones
A sayd they wold not rest tyll he were conqred
Taken and dystroyed body blode and bones
And that they swere grete othes for þ nonis
Her laū to dyspyce that was so malapert
They sayd he shuld be taught for to be so pert

Wel sayd Appollo yf he on erth be
Wyth my brennyng chare I shall hy cōfound
In feyth quod neptunus & he kepe the se
He may be well sure he shall be drownd
A syr sayd Mars this haue we wel found
That ony dysubeyed oure goodly precept
We may well thynk we haue to long slept

But neuertheles where I may hym fynd
Wyth thūd & lyghtning about I shall hy chase
And I quod Saturnus before and behynd,
W my bytte cold shall shew hy harde grace
Wel sayd Mercurus yf I may se his face,
For euer of his spech I shall hym depreur
So that hym were better dede than alque

E quod Othea yet may he well be
In the eyr where he wyl & ar you no leue
Wherfore my counseyl is that all we
May entrete Neptun⁹ his rahcour forpene.
And than I dout not Colus wyl hy myscheue
So may ye be sure he soal you not escape

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Ce ellis. of you anger he wyl make but a lape.

But for to tel you how Colus was brought.

In daungere of Pluto yet had I forget

Wherfore on this mater forther wyl I nouzt.

Procede tyll I therof haue knowlege you let

It besell on a day the weder was wete

And Colus thought he wold on his dysport.

Goo in reioyle his spyrtis and comforte

He thought he wold se what was in þe ground

And in a krauers forth he gay hym dresse

A drough had the erthe late before found.

That caused it to chyne & kraup more & lesse

Sodenly by wete constreyned by duresse

Was the ground to close his supfycyall face.

So sheyt that to scape col^r had noo space

This seying Colus be styll wythin abode.

Sekyng where he myzt haue gene fet or nere.

Auone he was espyed and one to Pluto rode

And told hy how Colus was in his daungere.

Thay sayd he to Cerber^r fet me þe prysonere

Tyl I haue hy sene lest hy not go at large

As þe wylt answere of hen I geue the charge

Thus was this Colus take prysonere

Thay happed it so that thys laue day

Pluto had presyded for a grete mater

Arynos to syt in his robe of Bay

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¶ Wherefore Cerber⁹ toke the next way
¶ And led hy to the place where the court shalbe
¶ Where I told you Morpleus brought me

¶ So thyder came Dyaua carped in carre
¶ To make her compleynt as I told you all
¶ And so dyd Neptunus y doth make and mar
¶ Walewyrng w his wawys & tōblyng as a ball
¶ Her matters they meued fal what may befall
¶ There was the fyrst syght y euer I them saw
¶ And yf I neuer do eft I care not a straw

¶ But now to my matter retourne agayn
¶ And tu begyn new where I left.
¶ Whan al the goddis had done her besy payne.
¶ The way to contriue how it shuld be rest
¶ Of his lyf Attropos had no cause eft
¶ To cōpleyn than Phebus stert bpon her fete/
¶ And sayd I pray you let me speke a word yet

¶ Othea menyth wel to say on this wyle
¶ But al to entret Neptun⁹ i hope shal not nede
¶ He senyth I alone durst take y entespyse.
¶ Er I am begyled or ellie I shal spede
¶ How say ye Neptunus shal I do this dede.
¶ Wy ye your rancour seale at my request
¶ Madame quod he reule me as ye lyketh best

¶ O remerry sayd she of your good wyll
¶ That it pleyfeth you to shew methat fauours

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Wherfoze the goddys hygh pleyfure to fulfyll
Performe my delyre & leue al olde rancoure
For our elders wele & faupng of oure honour
Agayn this colus that ye long haue had
It is done quod he forsoth than am I gladd

Sayd he now than Colus be þ to vs trewe
Kepe well the eyz and oure grete rebell
May we than sone euer to vs subdew
Yes and that quod Colus shall here tell
Nowhere in the eyz shall he rest nor dwell
If he do therof put me in the faute
Wyth my bytter blastes so shal I hyf asaut

What sayd the god Pluto what is his name.
That thus presumpt agayn vs to rebell
Mertu quod attropes þ haue he mykyl shame
He is neuer confounded thus of hyf here I tell
I sayd this pluto in dede I know hyf wel
Ho hath ben euer myn vtter ennemye
Wherfoze this mater agayn hyf take wyll I

For all the baytes þ we for hym haue layde
Wythout my helpe be not worth a peze
For though ye all the contrary had sayd
Yet wold he brede right nigh pour althris ere
No maner of thyng can hym hurt or dere
Sauely a sone of my bastard
Whos name is vice he kepyth my vamarad.

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¶ Wherfore you Cerber⁹ now I the charge
¶ Of Colus & wyl that thou heder fet
¶ My dcre lone Wyce & say that I h⁹ charge,
¶ That he to me come wythout ony let
¶ Armed at all poyntes for a day is let
¶ That he w⁹ Vertu for al þ⁹ goddis sake
¶ In our defence must on hym batayl take.

¶ North they went Cerberus w⁹ his fyry cheyn
¶ Brought thyn⁹ wyce as he cōmaūded was
¶ Agayn noble Vertu þ⁹ batayl to dercigne
¶ On a glydyng serpent rydyge a grete pace
¶ Formed lyke a dragon scaled hard as glas
¶ Whooos mouth flammed fyre wout fayll
¶ Wyngs had it serpentyne & a long tayll

¶ Armed was wyce all in cure boyll
¶ Harde as horne blacker fer than lute
¶ An vngoodly sort folowed hym perde
¶ Of vnhappy capteyns of myschyfe crop & rot
¶ Pryde was the fyrst þ⁹ next h⁹ rode god wote
¶ On a rozyng Lyon next whom came Enuye
¶ Syttyng on wolfe he had a scornful eye

¶ Wrath bestrode a wylde boze & next h⁹ gā ride.
¶ In his hond he bare a bloddy swerd
¶ Next whom cam couetise ygoth so fer & wide
¶ Rydyng on a Dylfaūt as he had ben a ferd
¶ After whom rode Gloteny wyth his fat berd
¶ Syttyng on a bere wyth his grete bely

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And next hy on a gote folowed Lechery

Sloth was so slepy he came all behynd

On a dull asse a full wery pale

Thyse were þe captcyns that byce coud fynde

Best to let his feld & folow on the chafe

As for pety capteyns many mo there was

As sacrilege symony & dyssymulacyon

Man slaughter mozdre theft & extorcyon

Arrogaunce Presumpcyon wyth contumact

Contempcyon Cōtempt & Inobedience

Malyle frowardnes grete Jelasy

Ewodnes Hate Stryf and Impacyence

Unkyndnes Oppressyon w wolfull neglygēce.

Murmur Myschete falschod & detraccyon

Usury Perjury Lye and adulacyon

Wrong Ravyne Sturdy byolence

Fals Jgement w Obstynacyon

Dysceyt Drunknes & Improurydence.

Boldnes in yll w foule and kybaudy.

Fornycacyon Incest and Auoutry

Unshamfastnes w Prodygalyte

Blaspeme baynglozy & worldly banpte

Ignoraunce Dyssydence w Fpocryfy

Scylme Bancour Debate and Offence

Herely Errour w Idolatry.

New fangylnes and sotyll false Pretence

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Fordynat desyre of worldly excellence
Fayned pouerte wyth apostasy
Dysclaunder scoyn & vnkynd Jelousy

Hoordom baudry false mayntenaunce
Trepyon abulyon and pety bybry
Usurpacyon wth horryble vengaunce
Came alder last of that company
All thyle pety capetayns folowed by and by.
Sherwyng theymself in the palayse wyde
And say th^{is} y were redy that batayl to abyde

Dylines sett the comyns in a ray
Without the palayse on a fayr felde
But there was an ost for to make a fray
I trowe suche a nother neuer may beheld
Many was the wepyng among hē y they weld
What they were y came to that dysporte
I shall you declare of many a sondry sort

There were hosters crakers & brybours
Draters salers stretchers and wrythers
Shamefull shakelers solcyn claue dours
Oppressours of people and myghty crakers
Mayntenours of quarels horryble spers
Theues traytours wth falle heretykes
Charmars sojcerers & many scylmatykes.

Dreuy symonyakes wyth falle blurers
Multyplyers coryn wallhers & clyppers

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Through blurpers wyth grete extorcyoners
Wacbyters Glosers and fayre flaterers.
Malycyous murmurers wyth grete claterers
Tregetours Trefelers fcyners of tales.
Lassuous lurdeyns and Bykers of malys.

Rouners Wagabundes forgers & lesingis.
Robbers Reuers Rauenous Ryfelers.
Choppers of Chyches fynders of tydynges
Mezers of maters and monymakers.
Sralkers by nyght wyth Cuyldroppers.
Fygthers Brawlers Brekers of louedayes
Gettters Chyders Caulers of trapes.

Typuyllis Tyraūtis w Tourmentours.
Corlpyd apostatis Kelyggous dyslymuleys:
Closshers Carders wyth comon hasardours.
Tyburne colops and Durkytters.
Dylary knyghtys double tolyng Myllers.
Gay Joly tapters w hostelers of the stewes.
Hozes and Bardes that many bale brewes

Boldblassemers wyth falle Ipocrytes.
Brothellers Brokers abhomynable sweeters.
Drypuyllis Bastardes dyspyllers of ryghtis
Homycydes Hoyseners & comon morderers
Scoldis Caytyues Comberous clappers.
Idolatre's Enchauntors w falle regenerates.
Sotyl ambydextrys and sekerrs of debatis.

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Pseudo Prophetes false Sodemytes.
Quelmers of chyldren wyth fornycatours.
Wetewoldes that suffre syn in their syghtis.
Auoutres and abhomynable auauntours.
Of syn grete clappers & makers of clamours
Unthryftes & vnlustes came al to that game
Wlusk & loselis þe might not thryue for sham

These were the comons þe came thid þe day.
Wedy boune in batayl Wertu to abyde.
Apollo theyn beholdyng began to say.
To the goddys & goddesles beynge there þe tid
Me semyth conuenient an herowd to ryde
To Wertu & byd hy to batayl make hy boune
Hys self to defend forsoth it shal be sone.

And let hym not be sodeynly take.
All dyspurneyed oz that he beware.
For thay shold our dyshonour awake.
If he were cowardly take in a snare.
Ee quod Wyre for that haue I no care.
I will auantage take where I may.
That heryng Noxplous puely stalc away.

And went to warne Wertu of al this afray.
And bad hy awake and make hymself strong
For he was lyke to endure that daye.
A grete mortall shoure et. it were euen songe.
W Wyre wherfore he bad hym not longe.
Cary to lend after moze socoure.

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¶ If he dyde it shold tozneyne hym to bolour.

¶ And brefely the matyr to be declared.

¶ Lyke as ye haue herd begynnynge and ende.

¶ Well quod Vertu he shall not be repared

¶ To the feld I wyl go how it wende.

¶ But gramercy Horple? myn own dere frēde

¶ Of your trewe hert & faythfull entente.

¶ That ye in this mat to meward haue ment.

¶ This done Horpleus departed away.

¶ Fro Vertu to the palayse retozneyng agayn.

¶ None hym aspyed that I dare well say.

¶ In whych tyme Vertu dyde his hely payn

¶ People to reyle his quarell to maynteyn.

¶ Pmagynacyon was his messengere.

¶ He went to warne people both ter & nere.

¶ And bad hem come in all hast they myght

¶ For to strength Vertu for wyth out fayll.

¶ He layd he shold haue long or it were nyght.

¶ Wyth Wyce to do a myghy strong batayl.

¶ Of bugtacyo? gesses he byngyth a gret tayll

¶ Wherefore it behouyth to help at this nede.

¶ And after this shal Vertu rewar yo? mede

¶ Whan pmagynacyon had gone his cyrcuyte

¶ To Vertues frendis thus all about.

¶ Wythyn short tyme many men of myght

¶ Gadered to Vertu in all that they myght.

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¶ They hym comforted & had hy put no doute.
¶ His better enemy Wyce to ouerthrowe.
¶ Thoughe hyd hy brouzt neuer so gret awe

¶ And whan Vertu se the sustaunce of his oste
¶ He prayed all the comons to the feld hem hye
¶ Wyth her pety capteyns both lest and mooste
¶ And wyth his capteyns shold folow redely.
¶ For he sayd he knew well þe wyce was ful nye.
¶ And who myght fyrst of þe feld recouer þe cētre
¶ Wold kepe out þe other he shuld not esely etre

¶ Then sent he forth Baptym to þe feld before
¶ And prayed hym hartely it to ouerle.
¶ That no maner trayn nor cottrop thei wot
¶ To noy nor hurt hym nor his meyne.
¶ And whan he thyder came he began to se.
¶ How Wyce his pursuauant cryme ovygynall.
¶ Was entred before and had sealed vp all.

¶ But as sone as herof Baptym had a syght.
¶ He fled fast away and left the feld alone.
¶ And anone Baptym entred wyth his myght.
¶ Serchyng al about where this crym had gon
¶ But the feld was ciene defaut found he none.
¶ Then came Vertu after with his gret oste.
¶ And his myghy capteyns both lest and moost.

¶ But to enfourme you how he thyder came.
¶ And what maner captains he to þe feld brouzt.

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Hymselfe lekerly was the fyrst man.
Of all his grete host þ̄ thyderwarde sought.
Syttynge in a chare þ̄ rychely was wrought.
Wyth golde and peerles algemmes precyous.
Crowned with laurer as lord byctoryous.

Houere doubty knyghtes about þ̄ chare went.
At euery corner one hit for to gyde.
And conuey accordyng to. Vertue his entent.
At the fyrst corner was wyghtwysnesse þ̄ tyde.
Prudence at the seconde was set to abyde.
At þ̄ thyrd strength þ̄ fourth kept temperaunce.
These þ̄ chare gyded to. Vertue his pleasaunce.

Next to þ̄ chare leuen capyteyns there roode.
Echone attre other in ordre by and by.
Humylte was þ̄ fyrst a lambe he bestroode.
With contentaunce demure he rood full soberly.
A few congentyll stood on his helme on hy.
And next after hym came there. Charpte.
Rydyng on a tygre as fylle to his degre.

Roode as a roole as he kept his chere.
On his helme on hygge a pellycan he bare.
Next whom can pacyēce þ̄ nowhere hath no pere
On a camell rydyng as boyde of all care.
Afenix on his helme stood so forth gay he fare.
Who next hym folowed but lyberalte.
Syteng on a dromedary þ̄ was both good & fre.

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¶ On his helm for his crest he bare on ospray.
 ¶ And next after hym folowed abstynence.
 ¶ Rydyng on an hete was trapure and gay.
 ¶ He semed a lord of ryght grete excellence.
 ¶ A popynay was his crest he was of gret dyscre.
 ¶ Next hym folowed chastyte on an brucorne.
 ¶ Armed at all portes behynde & befoze.

¶ A tortylou he bare on hyghe for his crest.
 ¶ Than came good besynelle last of þe seven.
 ¶ Rydyng on a panter a sondry coloured best.
 ¶ Gloriously beseen as he had come from heuen.
 ¶ A crane on his hede stood his crest for to steuyn.
 ¶ All these. iiii. capteyns had standardis of pyte.
 ¶ Eche of hem accordyng after his dyscre.

¶ Many pety capteyns after these went.
 ¶ As trewe feyth & hope mercy peale & pyte.
 ¶ Ryght trouthe mekenesse wrood entent.
 ¶ Goodnes conorde & parfyte knyght.
 ¶ Hocest trewe loue with symplycite.
 ¶ Prayer fastyng preyng almyghede.
 ¶ Joyned with þe artycles of the crede.

¶ Confessyon contricyon & satisfaccyon.
 ¶ With sorow for synne & grete repentaunce.
 ¶ Forveuenesse of trespass w good dysposycyon.
 ¶ Resystence of wrong performyng of penance.
 ¶ Holy deuocyon wyth good contynauce
 ¶ Preceded hem folowed with the sacramentis

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And sadnesse alle wyth the commaundementes

Suffraunce in trouble wyth Innocensy
Clenne contynence and birgynyte
Ryndnes reuerence w curteply
Content & pleased wyth pyteous pouerte
Entendyng wel mynistryng equyte
Twene ryght & wrong hole indyfferently
And labouryng the scruple of god to multiply

Refuse of ryches & worldly bayngloze
Perfeccon wyth persyght contemplacon
Relyggon professyon wel kept in memozy
Merry drede of god wyth holy prebycacoon
Celestyall sappyence wyth gostly inspyracoon
Grace was the gypde of al this meyne
Whome folowed konnyng w his genealogy

That is to say gramer and Sophistry
Phylosophy naturall logyke and Rhythyke
Arismetrycke geometry wyth astronomye
Canor and Cyupll melodyous mulyke
Noble Theology and corporal physyke
Moralizacyon of holy scrypture
Deposound poetry and drawyng of pycture

Thys folowed connyng & thyng wyth h' hean
Wyth many one mo offeryng her scrupie
To Vertu at that nebe but not wyth stodyng than
Some he refused and sayd in nowyse

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¶ They shuld wyth hym go & as I coude auyse
¶ Theylewore her names fyrst Bygromancy
¶ Geomanly magyke and glotony

¶ A dryomanly Dynomancy wth pyromancy
¶ Iflenomy also and pawmestry
¶ And al her sequeles yf I shal not lye
¶ Yet connyng prayed Uertu he wold not deny
¶ Theym for to know nor dysdeyn his eye
¶ On hem to loke wherto Uertu graunted
¶ How be it in his werres ge wold not they haüted

¶ So had they connyng lyghly to depart
¶ From Uertu his feld and they seyng this
¶ By connyng assent hyred them a carte
¶ And made hem be caryed toward Wyce & wys.
¶ Fro thens forth to serue hy this wold, not mys
¶ For loth they were to be maysterles
¶ In stede of the better the worse there they ches

¶ But forth to relese al the crmenant
¶ Of pety capteins that wyth Uertu were
¶ Moderate dyet and wysdom auenant
¶ Euen weyght and mesure ware of contagioⁿ ge
¶ Loth to offend ann louyng ay to lere
¶ Worshyp and profyte wth myght in maner
¶ Theyse pety capteyns wyth Uertu were in fere

¶ Comons hem folowed a grete multitude
¶ But in came pylson to that olier syde

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I trow there was not brefely to conclude.
The .x. man that batayl to abyde.
Yet neuertheles I chal not from you hyde.
What maner people they were & of what secte
As nere as my wyt therto wyll me direct.

There were noble and famous doctours.
Example ycuets of lyuyng gracyous.
Perpetuall prestes and dyscrete confessours.
Of holy scriptrue declarers fructuous.
Rebukers of syn & myscheues odious.
Fyschers of soules & louers of clennes.
Dyspyssers of beyn and worldly rychesse.

Dealyble prelatys Justycyal gouernours.
Founders of chyrches wyth mercyfull peres.
Reformers of wrong of her progenytours
Ony peynfull poxe pyteous compassyoners
Well menyng marchautes w trew artefecers
Wyggyngs pure and also Innocentes
Hooly matrones w chast contynence

Oylgymnes & palmers w trew laborers
Holy heremytes goddys solycytours
Monesteryal monkes & well dysposed freres
Chanons and nonnes seyth pfessours
Of worldly people trew conuugatours.
Louers of Cryst Confounders of yll.
And all that to godward yeue her good wyll

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¶ Mayntenours of ryghte berey penytentes.
¶ Dystroyers of errour causers of knyghte.
¶ Crew actyf lyuers that let her ententis
¶ The dedis to perfoyme of mercy and pyte
¶ Contemplatyf people that desyre to be.
¶ Salvtary seruauntis vnto god alone.
¶ Rather the to habound in rychesles & chone.

¶ Thyle wyth many mo than Treherce can
¶ Were come thyder redy that batayll to abyde.
¶ And take such part as fyl to Vertu than
¶ Wyce to uercome they hoped for al his pryde
¶ Al though he had more people on his syde
¶ For the men that Vertu had were ful sure.
¶ To trust on at nede & connyng in armure

¶ Macrocolme was the name of the feld
¶ Where this grete batayll was let for to be
¶ In the myddys therof stode cōspence & beheld
¶ Whyche of hem shold be brought to captiuyte
¶ Of that noble tryūph Juge wold he be
¶ Synderelys late hy wythyn closed as a park
¶ In his table in his honde her dedys to marke.

¶ To come in to the feld were hygh wayes .ii.
¶ Fre to both partyes large brode and wyde
¶ Vertu wold not tari but highed hy thyn blinde
¶ Lest he were by wyce deceyued at that tyde
¶ Long out of the feld loth was he to abyde
¶ In auenture that he out of it were kept.

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For thā wold he haue thouzt he had to long slept

¶ In this mene tyme whyle Vertu th⁹ pceded

¶ For h^y & his people the feld for to wyne.

¶ He charged euery man by grace to be guyded

¶ And al that euer myght þ feld to enter ynnē.

¶ In all that season went ozygynal synne.

¶ To let Uyce know how Waptym w³ his hoste.

¶ Had entred Macrocolme & serched euery cooste

¶ A sayd Uyce I se well it is tyme.

¶ Baners to dysplay & standardes to auaunce.

¶ Almost to long haddest þ tarped cryme.

¶ To let vs haue knolege of this puruepaunce.

¶ Yet I trow I chal lerne hem a new daunce.

¶ Wherfore I commaund you al w³out delaye

¶ Toward the felde draw w³ all the hast ye may

¶ Than sayd þ god Pluto þ al men myzt here

¶ Uyce I the charge as thou wylt elchem.

¶ Our heuyous Indygnacyō þ draw not arete

¶ But put þ forth boldly to ouerthrowe Vertu.

¶ In sayth quod Atropos & I chal after sew

¶ For yf he escape oure hondys this day.

¶ I tell you my scruple haue lost for ay.

¶ Forth than rode Uyce w³ al his hole strength

¶ On his stede serpentyne as i feld you byfore.

¶ The ost that h^y folowed was of a grete lēgth.

¶ Amōg whō were penous & gnyts mani a scoṛ

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Of hys pety capteynes he made many a knyt
For they shuld not fle but manly w him fight

He doubted fallshod wyth Dysmylacyon.
Symony Usury Wrong and Rybawdy.
Malycie Deceit Lye wythout Exorcyon.
Deuiry Dysfydence and Apostasy.
Wyth boldnes myl to bere hym company.
Thyse. xiii. knyghtes made byte that daye.
To wyth her spores they sayd they wold assay

In lyke wyse Vertu doubted on his syde:
Of pety capteyns other fourtene.
Whyche made her auou wyth hym to abyde:
Her spores wold they wyl day shold it be len
Thyse were her names yf it be as I wene
Feyth Hope & Mercy Trowth & also Ryght.
In Resystence of wronge a full hardy wyghte

Confessyon Contrycyon wyth Satisfaction
Verrey drede of God Performyng of penaunce
Perfeccon Connyng and Good dyspocicon
And all knyt to Vertu they were by alyaung
Wherfore to hym they made assuraunce.
That feld to kepe as long as they myght.
And in his quarel agayn Wyse to fyght.

The lord of Macrocolme & reuoler of þe see
Was called Frewyl chaunger of the chaunce:
To whome Vertu sent embassatours thre

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¶ Beson dyscrecyon & good remembrance.
¶ And prayed hys be fauorable his honoure to chas
¶ For but he had his fauour at y poynt of nece.
¶ He stood in gret doute he coude not lightly speke.

¶ In lyke wyse. Wyce embassatours thre.
¶ For his party vnto frewyl sent.
¶ Temptacyon folow & sensualyte.
¶ Praying hys of fauour that he wolde assent.
¶ To hys as he wolde at his comaundement.
¶ Haue hys estones whan he lyst to call.
¶ On hys for any thyng y afterward myght fall.

¶ Answer gaue he non to neyther party.
¶ Saue oon he sayd y batayll wolde he le
¶ To wete whiche of hys thold haue y byctory.
¶ Wit hys in his balaunce y ambyguyte.
¶ He sayd he wolde not restrayne his lyberte.
¶ Whan he come where sorow thold awake.
¶ Than it thold be know what part he wyl take

¶ Whan. Vertu & Wyce be her ambassatours.
¶ Knew of this answer they stood in gret doute.
¶ Neuertheles they seyde they wold endure thos hours
¶ And make an ende shortly of y they wet aboute.
¶ Soo forth came. Wyce w all his grete route.
¶ Er he came at y felde he sent yet priuely.
¶ Sensualyte before in maner of a spy.

¶ Whiche sewe y felde w his vnkynde seede.

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¶ That caused Vertu after mykyl woo to feele
¶ For therof grewe nought but all conly weede.
¶ Whiche made the grounde as sleper as an yele.
¶ He went ayene to vice & tolde hym euery dele.
¶ How he had done and bad hym come a way.
¶ For he had so purueyde þ byce sholde haue þ day.

¶ Soo as it happed at þ felde they mete.
¶ Frewyll vertu and vice as tripartite.
¶ Saaf vertu a litul befoze the felde had gete.
¶ And ellis his auatage forsoth had be ful pyght.
¶ Not for they encombred so was neuer wyght.
¶ As vertu & his men were with the ranke. wede
¶ That by þ felde gre w of sensualitees fede

¶ But as soone as byce of vertu had a pyght.
¶ He gaynswage gonnes as he had be wcode
¶ That herpyng vertu comaunded euery wyght
¶ To paupce hym vnder the sygne of þ rode.
¶ And bad he not drede but kepe styll wherethy.
¶ It was but a shour shold lone cōfoūde (stode.
¶ wherfoze he comaūded the stād : kepe her grouūd

¶ And whan byce cam nerer to the felde.
¶ He callyd soze for bowes : bad hem shote faste
¶ But vertu & hys men ny bare of with þ held.
¶ Of the bylyd Trynyte ap tyll shot was past.
¶ And whā shot was done byce cam forth at last.
¶ Purpolsyng the felde wyth assaute to wyth.
¶ But vtu kept it long he myght not ent theryn.

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All that tyme frewyl stode & hym bethought.
To which he myghte & what he wold take.
At last sensualite had hy so fer brought.
That he sayd playnly he wold forsake.
And in vyce hys quarell all his power make.
Nota Thus quod reason he is not for the beste.
Proforse sayd frewyl I wyl do as my lyst.

Bertu was full heuy when he see frewyl
Take part with vyce but yet neuerthelelle.
He dyde that he myght the felde to kepe styll.
Tyll vyce with frewyl so sore gan hy oppresse.
That he was constrained clerely by duresse.
A lpyll tyne abacke to make abew retret.
All thyng consydered hit was the best feet.

Fyrst to remembre how vyce parte was.
Ten apen one strenger by pylpynesse.
And than how frewyl was with hym alas.
Who coude deme bertu but in heuy nesse.
Moreouer to thynke how that sleper gresse.
That of sensualyte hys on kynde leede grew.
Under foot in standyng encombred bertu

Et notwithstanding bertue his men all.
Sobelly theym bare and faught myghtyly.
Howbeit he sleper gresse made many of he fall.
And from thense in maner departe sodenly.
That scyng vyce his hoost began to shout & cry.
And sayd on Pluto name on all is ouer

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For this day shal Wyce be made a conquerour.

Thus Vertu was by myght of wyce & strew
Dryuen out of the feld it was the more pyte. yll
How by it yet Baptym kept his ground styll.
And wth hym abode feyth hope & vyte.
And konnyng also wth a grete myght.
Confessyon constrycyon were redy at her hond.
And Satisfaction Wyce to wythstand.

But al the tyme whyle Vertu was away.
A mysty conflycte kept they wth Wycys rout.
And yet neuertheles for al that grete afay.
Hope stod byrght & feyth wold neuer lout
And euermore sayd Baptym syres put no dout.
Vertu shal return & haue his entent.
This feld shal be ours or let me be hent.

And whyl thys pety capteys sustend th^{is} feld
Wyth Vertu his reward come good pleurauns
An hugy mysty hoost & whan he beheld.
How Vertu hym withdrew he toke dyspleasur.
And whā he to h^{is} cam he sayd ye shal your chās
Take as it fallyth wherfore returne ye must.
Pet ones for your sake wth Wyce shal I Just.

Alas that euer ye shold lese your honour.
And therwyth also y^e h^{igh} ppetuel crown.
Which is for you kept in the celestyal tour.
Wherfore be ye called chrystys champpon.

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How is it that ye haue noo compassyone.
On baptyme seyth a hope konnyng a brute.
That stād so hard bestad a fyght as ye may see.

All the tresour erthely vnder þe fyrnamēt
That euer was made of goddys creacyon.
To reward theym euently were not equyualent.
For her noble labour in his affleccyon.
Wherfore take vpon you your Ju rildrecyon
Rescu ponder knyghtes a recontynu fyght.
And els a dew your crown: or al your gret myzt

With these a luche wordys as I haue you tolde
By good perseueraunce vttered in this wyse.
Vertulym remembred a gay to nere holde.
And sayd yeuetrew knyghtis to rescu I auyse
Let vs no lengar tary from this entrepyse.
Again to þe felde soo Vertu retourned.
That caused he be mery þe lōg afore had moyned

Auaunt baner qd he in þe name of Jesu
And with þe his people set vp a gret shoute.
And cryed with a loude voce a Vertu a Vertu.
They began Uyce his hoost for to loke a boute.
But I trow pleuerasice was not long withoute
He bathed his swerd in his foos blood.
The boldest of hem all not ones he withstoode.

Constaunce hym folowed a brought he his spere
But when pleuerasice saw Uyce on his stede.

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¶ Noman coude hym let till he came there.
¶ For to byd hym ryde I trow it was no nede.
¶ All Vertu his oost prayed for his good spede.
¶ Agayn Wyce he rode with his grete staff.
¶ And hym ouerthrow for all his sorpyll craft.

¶ That seying frewill came to conscience.
¶ And gayn hym to repente þ he with hym had be.
¶ Prapeng hym of couzell for his grete offence.
¶ That he agayn Vertu had made his arme.
¶ What was best to doo to humylyte:
¶ And conscience must þ go so þ he hym thyder sent.
¶ Dysguyled þ he were not knowen as he went.

¶ And whan he thyder came humylyte hym toke.
¶ A token a bad hym go to confessyon.
¶ And shew hym his mater with a peteous loken.
¶ Whiche done he hym sent to contrycyon.
¶ And fro then forth to satysfaccyon.
¶ Thus fro poost to ppler was he made to daunce.
¶ And at the last he went forth to penaunce.

¶ But now for to tel you whē Wyce was outhrow.
¶ A gret part of his oost about hym gayn resorte.
¶ But he was so febyll þ he coude noman know.
¶ And whan they se þ they knew no comforte.
¶ But carped hym a way be a preuy porte.
¶ And as they carped dyspeyre with hū met.
¶ With Wyce his rewarde he cam theym for to fet.

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¶ Then came there downe goodly ladies tweyn.
¶ From the hyghe heuen aboue the firmamente.
¶ And sayd the gret Alpha & Do moost souereyn.
¶ For that nobell tryumphe had hem thyder sent.
¶ One of hem to dryue Uyce to grete tormente.
¶ With a fery strong & she bare in her hande.
¶ And so he dede dysperce & all his hole bande.

¶ The name of this lady was called Drestynce.
¶ She neuer left Uyce ne none & wolde hy folow.
¶ Tyll they were comytted by & dyuine sentence.
¶ All to payne perpetuell & Infynyte sorow.
¶ Wightwylnes went to le & nomā shold he borow.
¶ Wh^o al entreted sharpely were they tyll Cerber^o
¶ Had hem belhut within his gates tenebr^o.

¶ And all & whyle & Drestynce w her scorge smert
¶ To rewarde Uyce gan her thus occupy.
¶ With all his hole bende after her desert.
¶ That other glorio^o lady & came fro heuē on hy.
¶ Hauyng in her honde the palme of byctory.
¶ Came downe to Uertu & toke hym to & p^{re}scent.
¶ Sayeng thus that Alpha & Do hath hym sent.

¶ And as ferre as I ryght coude vnderstonde
¶ That ladies name was Dredestynacyon.
¶ Uertu & his oost he blestyd w^{ith} her honde.
¶ And in heuyn graunted hem habytacyon.
¶ Whereto eche of hem reseruyd was a crowne.
¶ She sayd in token that they enherytours.

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Of the glory were & gracious conquerours.

Wyth done the ladyes' ayen to gyder met
And towarde heuen vp they gan to sty
Embraced in armes as they had ben knyght.
Cogyd w a gyrdyl but so sodenly.
As þy wet banysshyd saw I neuthyr w ey.
And anone Uertu wyth al his company.
Kneled doūy & thaked god of þ byctory.

Et had I forget what Uyce was ouerthrow:
To haue told you hou many of Uycys hoost.
Gay to seke pease & darked doūy ful low.
And besought mercy what so euer it coste.
To be her mene to Uertu els þy wē but lost.
And some in .yke wyle to seyth & hope sought.
What to do for pease they sayd they ne rouse.

Some also Baptym sewed to be her mene.
Some to one som to other as thei hē gete myzte.
But al to Confessyon wēt to make hē clene
And as þy came to cōspēce he they bad go lyzte.
Er thā old attropes of hē had a lyzt.
For yf he so theym toke lost they wē for euer
He sayd Uyce to forlake better late thā neuer.

Some eke for solout drew to circūcisiō.
But by hē coud they gete but smal fauoure.
For he in that company was h. d but in derypōd
Neuer lesse to seyth he bad hē go labour.

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Prayng they for olde acqweyntāce they socoure
Wel qd feth for his sake I shal do y I may doo
But fyrste for the best way baptym go ye to.

For by hym sonest shal ye recouer grace.
Which shal to Vertu bryng you by processe.
Wherfore inony wyle loke ye make good face.
And let noman know of your heupnes.
So they were by baptym brouzt out of distress
Turned al to Vertu & whan this was done.
Vertu cūmaided frewyll before hym come.

To whom thus he sayd I haue grete merueyl
Ye durst be so bold Wyces party to take.
Who bad you do so & yauē you that counseyl.
Justly vnto that ye shal me preuy make.
They sayd frewyll & swenifullly spake.
Knelyng on his kne wyth a chere benyng.
I pray you fyr let ppte your eyes to me enclyne.

And I shall yow tel the berrey soth of all.
How it was & who made me that way drawe.
For soth sensualyte his ppze name they call.
Al layd reason then I know wel that felowe.
Wylde he is & wanton of me stan t hy none awe.
Is he so qd Vertu wel he shall be taught.
As a player shuld to draw another draught.

And w that came sadnesse wyth his sober chere.
Bryngyng Sensualite beyng ful of thought.

honye
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will
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pene

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And sayd that he had take hym prylonere.
A welcome sayd Wertu now haue I þe I souzt.
Blessed be the good lord as þe wold it is nought
Why arte þe so wanton he sayd for shame.
O þe go at large þe shalt be more tame.

But stode a part a while tyl I haue spoke a word
Wyth frewyl a lye þe then shalt þe knowe.
What shalbe thy tynauce: then he sayd in boord
Unto frewyl the bend of your bowe.
Begynnyth to like but suche as ye haue sowe
Whit needes reþe there is none waye.
Frotyth stondyng that lette what ye can saye.

What is your habillite me to recompense.
For the grete harme that ye to me haue do.
Forsoth sayd frewyl in open audyence.
But oonly Macrocolme more haue I not loo.
Take þe yf it pleyse you I wyl that it be soo.
Yf I may vnderstand ye be my good lord.
In dede sayd Wertu to that wyl I accorde.

Then made Wertu Reason his leyf tenaunte.
And gaue hi a grete charge macrocolme to kepe
That done Sensualite yeld hym recreaunte.
And began for anger bytterly to wepe.
For he demed surely hys sorowe shold not slepe
Then made Wertu frewyl bayl vnto Reason.
The feld for to occupy to his behoue that season.

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And then sayd Vertu to Sensualyte.
Thou shalt be rewarded for thy besynesse.
Under this furnie al fragylte.
Shalt þ forlake both more and lesse.
And vnd the guyd þ shalt be of sadnesse.
All though it somwhat be agayn thy herte.
Thy Iugement is geyuen þ shalt it not aſserte

And eyn w that came in vaine nature.
Sayeng th^o to Vertu ſp^r ye do me wronge.
By durſſe a conſtreynt to put this creature.
Genyll Sensualyte þ hath me ſued longe.
Clerely from his lyberte a ſet hym amonge.
The þ that loue h^y not to be het vndoute.
As it were a caſt away or a ſho cloute.

And perde ye know well a crowle haue I muſt
Wy: hy Macrocolme forlooth I ſay not nay.
No Vertu bu t ſensualyte ſhal not pform your luſt
Lyke as he hath do befor this yf I may.
Therfro h^y reſtreyn ſadnesſe ſhal aſſay.
How be it ye ſhal haue your hoſe lyberte.
Wythyn Macrocolme as ye haue had fre.

And when Vertu had to Nature ſayd thys
A ltyll tynche his ey calleng hym beſyde.
He ſe in a corner ſtondyng Morpleus.
That h^y beſore warncd of þ verely tyde.
A lrys ſayd Vertu yet we muſt abyde.
Here is a frend of ours may not be forgete.

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After his deserte we shall hys entreate

Moyle^s sayd. Vertu I thanke you hertely.
For your trewe herte & your grete laboure.
That ye lyst to come to me soo redely.
Whan ye vnderstod þe comyng of that shoure.
I thanke god & you of sauþg of my honour.
Wherfore this pryncplege now to you I grāt
That wth Macrocolme ye shall haue your haūt

And of fyue posternes þe keys shall ye kepe.
Lettyng in & out at hy whome ye lyst.
As long as in Macrocolme your sad wyll crepe.
Blere whos ey ye wyll hardely wth your myst
And kepe your werkes close there as in a chyst
Saaf I wold desyre you spare Dollucyon.
For no thyng may me plesse þe souereth to corrupcyon.

And whā he had th^s sayd þe keyes he hy toke.
And toward his castell wth his people went
Byddyng realon take good hede & about loke.
That lesualite by nature were not shēt.
Kepe hy thort he sayd tyll his lust be spēt
For better were a chylde to by vnboze.
Thay let hy haue þe wyll & foreuer be lore.

And whā olde Attropos had seen & herd all this
How Vertu had opteyned astonyed as he stood,
He sayd to hy selfe som what there is amys.
I trow well my patent be not all good.

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¶ Sayeng to the goddys I see ye do but iape.
¶ After a worthy whew haue ye made me gape.

¶ How a deuyl way sholde I Vertue ouerthrow.
¶ When he dredeth not all your holeroute.
¶ How can ye make good your patēt wold I know
¶ Hit is to Impossible to byng that aboute.
¶ For stryke hym may I not his out of doute.
¶ A good Attropos sayd god Apollo.
¶ An answer conuenient shall thou haue hertō.

¶ The wordes of thy patent dare I well say
¶ Stretch to no forther but were dame Nature
¶ Hath Iurysdyccyon thē to haue thy way Nota.
¶ And largesse to stryke as longe to thy cure.
¶ And as for Vertu he his no cryature.
¶ Under the pretycament conteyned of quantyte
¶ Wherefore his dysstruccyon longeth not to the.

¶ A ha sayd Attropos then I see well.
¶ That all ye goodys be but couēterfete.
¶ For so God there is that can euer ydell.
¶ Tourne as hym lest bothe dye a whete.
¶ In to whoos seruyce I shal assaye to gete.
¶ And yf I may ones to his seruyce come.
¶ Your names shal be put to oblyuone.

¶ Thus went Attropos fro the paleys wrooth.
¶ But in the mene tyme a hyle þe there was.
¶ Glydyng by the paleys resyduacyon gooth.

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Towarde Macrocolme with a pēynted face.
Clad lyke a pylgryme walkyng a grete pale.
In the forme as he had ben a man of ynde.
He wode haue made reson & sadnesse both blynde

With sensualyte was he soone aqueynted.
To whome he dec.ared his mater pryuely.
Et he was espyed for all his face pēynted.
Then reson hȝ comaunded pykchȝ thēs lightly.
For his ease qđ sadnesse so cou.eyll hym wyll J.
Soo was sensualyte ap kepte vnder foote.
That to respyduacion myght he doo no boote.

Then went he to Nature & asked her auple.
His entent to opteynde what was he sto doo.
She sayd euer syth Uerru of vyce man hȝ pryse.
Reson with sadnesse hath reweled the felde loo.
That J & sensualyte may lytill for the doo.
For J may noo more but oonly kepe my cours.
And yet is sensualyte stronger kept & wours.

When her pȝ respyduacion fro thēs he went ageyn
Full of thought & sorow hȝ he myght not spece.
Than reson & sadnesse toke wedehokes tweyn.
And all wyldē wātonesse out hȝ felde gan wede.
With all the sylper grasle hȝ grewe of the sede.
That sensualyte befoze therein sew.
And so thens forth kept it clene for better w

Than began new grasle in the felde to spryng.

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¶ All bnylyke & other of colour fayr & bryght.
 ¶ But then I aspyed a meruelous thyng.
 ¶ For the groude of þe felde gan wey hore & whyt.
 ¶ I coude not conceyue how þe myght.
 ¶ Tyll I was enformed & taught it to know.
 ¶ But wher vertu occupyet must nedes wel grow.

¶ Yet in the mene tyme while the felde thus grow.
 ¶ And reison with sadnesse therof had gouernaunce.
 ¶ Many a preuy messenger thyder sent Werten.
 ¶ To know yf it were guyded to his plesaunce.
 ¶ How prayer est fastyng & often tyme penaunce.
 ¶ And whan he myght goo preuely almeseede.
 ¶ And bad hym to his pouer helpe wher hele nede.

¶ While þe felde thus reuled reison with sadnesse.
 ¶ Mangre dame Nature for all her carnall myght.
 ¶ Came thyder Attropos boyd of all gladnesse.
 ¶ Wrapped in his shere & axed of eny wyght.
 ¶ Coude wysse hym the way to the lord of light.
 ¶ Or ellis where myght fynde rygh wysnesse.
 ¶ For sothe sayd reyson I trowas I gesse.

¶ At Werten his castell ye may scone hym fynde.
 ¶ I fele yf the laboure thyder to take.
 ¶ And there shall ye know yf ye be not blynde.
 ¶ The next way to the lord of lyght I undertake.
 ¶ So thyder went Attropos preyng to make.
 ¶ To ryght wysnesse preyng that he myght.
 ¶ He take in to the scruple of the lord of lyght.

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What sad ryghtwysnesse þe olde dotyng foole.
Whome yast thou seruyd syth the worlde begā
But oonly hym where hast þe go to scole.
Whether y art þe Doubl coz elles the sam man.
That thou were fyrst a syr sayd he than.
I praye you hertely holde me excused.
I am olde & febell my wyttys are dysused.

Well sayd ryghtwysnes for as moche as thou.
Knowest not thy mayst thy name shal I chaunge
The shalt þe be caled from hēs forwarde now
Among all the peple that I hal be had straunge.
But whan þe begynnest to make thy chalaunge.
Dredde shalt thou be where so thou become.
And to noo creature shalt thou be welcome.

And as for theym whome thou dedest serue.
For as moche as they presume on hem to take.
That hygh name of god they shal as they desue
Therfore be rewarded I dare vndtake.
Wyth payn ppetual among fendes blake.
And her names shall be put to oblyuon.
Among men but it be in dyspyon.

Aha sayd Attropos now begyne I wex glad.
That I shal thus auenged of hem be.
Syth they so long tyme haue made me so mad.
Pre qd ryght wysnesse here what I say to the.
The lord of lyght sent the worde by me.

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That in Macrocolme selfyne shalt thou take
Wherfore thy darte redy loke thou make

And as soone as Vertue that understood
He sayd he was pleased that it sholde soo be
And euen forth with he commaunded presthood
To make hym redy the felde for to se
So thyder went presthode with benygnyte
Conueyeng thyder the blessyd sacrament
Of Eukaryst but fyrst were thyder sent

Confessyō contricyon and satisfaccyō (nota
Sorrow for synne and grete repentaunce
Holy deuocyon with good dysposycyon
All these thyder came and also penaunce
As her dewte was to make purueaunce
Agayn the comyng of that blessyd lord
Feyth hope & charyte therto were acoorde

Reason with sadnesse dyde his dyslygence
To clesse the felde within and without
And whan they se the bodely presence
Of that holy Eukaryst lowly gan they lout
So was that lord receyued out of dout
With all humble chere debonayre & benygne
Apkly to pleasure it was a grete sygne

Then came to the felde the mynyster fynall
Called holy vnccyon with a crysmatory
The fyue hye wayes in especyall

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¶ Therof he anoynted & made hit sanctuary
¶ Whome folowed deth whiche wolde not tary
¶ His feruent power there to put in bze
¶ As he was comaūded graūtyng dame Paūre

¶ Nota.

¶ He toke his darte called his mortall iounce
¶ And bent his stroke towarde the felde herte
¶ That seying preeſthode had good remembraūce
¶ Towarde the felde tourne hym & aduerte
¶ For except hym all vertues thenſe muſt ſterte
¶ And euen with that deſhe there ſelyne toke
¶ And then all the company clerely hit forſoke

¶ And as ſoone as dethe thus had ſelyne take
¶ The colour of the felde was chaūged ſodeynly
¶ The graſſe therin ſeere as though it had be bak
¶ And the fyue hygh wayes were niured. vpon hy
¶ That fro theſe forwarde none entre ſhold therbi
¶ The poſternes were alſo without lette
¶ Bothe inwarde & outwarde ſyne faſt ſhette

¶ Whiche done ſodeynly dethe banyiſhed a way
¶ And Vertu exalted was aboue the fyrmanent
¶ Where he toke crowne of glozy ꝑ is ay
¶ Preparate by Alpha & oo omnyppotent
¶ The ſwete frute of macrocolme thyn w hſ wzt
¶ And on all this mater as ꝑ ſtood muſyng thus
¶ Agayn fro the felde to me came Morpleus

¶ Sayēg thus what there how lyketh ꝑ this fyght

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Haste thou seen ynough or wyl thou see more
Nay syr I sayd my trouthe I you plyght
This is suffycyente pf I knew wherfore
This was to me shewed for therof he loze
Coueyte I to haue pf I gete myght
Folow me quod he and haue thy delyght

Soo I hym folowed tyll he had me brought
To a foresquare herber walled round aboute
Loo qd Morple^r here maist thou þ thou sought
Fynde pf thou wyl I put the out of doute
Alytyll whyle we stood styll there withoute
Tyll wytte chyef porter of that herber gate
Requyred by stodye lete vs in there ate

But whan I came in meruayled gretly
Of that I behelde & herde reporte
For fyrst in a chayre apparaylled royally
Theresate dam doctryne her childern to exorte
And about her was many a sondry sorte
Some wyllyng to lerne dyuerse scyence
And some for to haue perfyte intellygence

Crowned she was lyke an Emperesse
Wich iii. crownes standyng on her hede on by
All teyng about her an Infynyte processe
Were to declare I tell you certaynly
Neuerthelesse some in mynde therof haue I
Whiche I shall to you as god wyl yeue me grace
As I sawe & herde tell in short space

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Tast by Doctryne on that one syde
As I remembre late holy Terte
That opened his mouth to þ people wyde
But not in comparyson to Glose þ late nexte
Moralyzacyon with a cloke contexte
Sate & Sctypture was sctybe to theym all
He late ay wytyng of that that sholde fall

These were tho that I there knewe
By no maner waye of olde acquyntaunce
But as I before saw theym with Wlterwe
Company in felde & haupng dalyaunce
And as I thus stood halfe in a traunce
Whyle they were occupped in her besynesse
Aboute the walles myn ey gan I dresse
Where I beheld the meruaylous stozp
That euer I yet sawe in ony ppycture
For on tho walles was made memory
Syngulerly of euery creature
That there had byn bothe forme & stature
Whoos names reherse I wyl as I can
Bryng theym to mynde in ordre euery man

Fyrst to begynne there was in portrature
Adām & Eue holdyng an apell rounde
Noe in a shyp & Abraham haupng sure
A flyntstone in his honde & Isaac lay bounde
On an hygge moute Jacob slepyng sounde
And a long ladder stood belyde
Joseph in a Cysterne was also there that tyde.

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Next whom stode Moyses with his tables two
Aron and Ure his armes supportynge .
Ely in a brennyng chare was there also.
And Elze stode clad in hermytes c'othynge.
Dauid wyth an harpe and a stone synge.
Isaie Jeremy and Ezechyell.
And closed wyth Lyons holy Danpell.

Abacuc Mychce wyth Malachy.
And Jonas out of a whales body comynge.
Samuel in a Temple a holy zachary.
Belyde an aulter all bloody stondynge.
Olee wyth Judyth stood there conspyryng.
The deth of Dioferne & Salamon.
A chylde wyth hys swerde dypdyng in two.

Many mo pphetes certeynly there were.
Whoos names now come not to my mynde.
Melchisedech also I espyed there.
Bede & wyne offryng as fell to his kynde.
Joachym & Anna stode al behynde.
Embraced in armes to the golden gate.
And holy Johan Baptyst in desert sat.

And now comyth to my remembrance.
I am auyled I saw Sodechy:
And Amos also with sober countenaunce.
Stondyng wyth her faces towarde Sophony.
Neemy & Eldras bare hem companye.
The hoyr man Job as an Impotente.

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¶ Then folowed in pycture wyth Choby pacyent

¶ Thyle wyth many mo on that one syde.

¶ Of that grene herber portrayed were.

¶ As sayd Morpleus a lypill tyme abyde.

¶ Turn thy face where thy backe was ere.

¶ And beholde well what thou seeſte there.

¶ Than I me turned as he me badde.

¶ With herte ſtedfaſte & countenaunce ſadde.

¶ Where I ſawe Peter wyth his keyes ſtonde.

¶ Poule wyth a ſwerde and James alſo.

¶ Wyth a ſcalop & Thomas holdyng in his honde.

¶ As pere and Whyllyp aproched hym to:

¶ James the leſſe nexte hem in pycture loo.

¶ Stode wyth Bartylmew whych was all flayn

¶ Synion & Thadee ſhewed how they were ſlayn

¶ Mathy and Barnabe drawyng lottys ſtode

¶ Nexte whome was Marke a Lyon hym by.

¶ Hys boke holdyng & Matthew in his mode.

¶ Reſembled an aungell wyth wyngys g' pouly.

¶ Luke had a calfe to holde his boke on hye.

¶ And Johan wyth a cuppe & palme in his honde.

¶ An Eggle bare his book thus ſaw I hem ſtonde

¶ Gregory and Jerome Auſtyn and Ambroſe.

¶ Wyth pyllyōs on ther hedys ſtode lyke doctors

¶ Bernard wyth Anſelme and as I ſupple.

¶ Thomas of alquyne and Romynyſe cōfeſſours

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¶ Benet and Hewrclygous gouernours.
¶ Martyn & Johan w. h. byllhops tweyne.
¶ Were there alio and Crylostom certayne.

¶ Behynd all thyle was worshypfull Bede.
¶ All behynde and next hym stood Orygene.
¶ Hydynge his face as he of his dede.
¶ Had hem a shamed ye wote what I mene.
¶ For of errour he was not al clene.
¶ And on that syde stode laste of alle.
¶ The noble pphetyssa Sybell men her call.

¶ Let me remembre now I you pray
¶ My baraynis so thynne I deme in my herte
¶ Some of the felyshyp that I there lay.
¶ In all this whyle to haue ouerserte.
¶ A benedicte none ere coude I aduerte.
¶ To thynke on Andrew the apostle w. his crosse.
¶ Whome to forgete were a grete losse.

¶ Many one were peynted on that wall.
¶ Whoos names come not to my remembraunce
¶ But thyle I marked in espe cyall.
¶ And moo coude I tell in countenaunce.
¶ Of tyme but for to shewe you the substaunce.
¶ Of this mater in the myndys of that arbere.
¶ Sat Doctryne coloured as ony crystall clere.

¶ Crowned as I tolde you late here before.
¶ Whoos apparayl was worth tresour In fynyte

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¶ All earthly rychesse count I no more.
¶ To that in cōparyson valewȝg the ampte.
¶ouer her hede hōued a culuer sayz a whpte.
¶ Out of her byll pceded a grete leme.
¶ Downward to Doctryne lyke a sonne beme

¶ The wordes of Doctryne gaue grete rebolēs.
¶ In swetnesse of sauour to her dyscyples al.
¶ It fer exceded myz a frankencense.
¶ Or any other tre spyce or els galle.
¶ And whan she me espyed anone she gay me cal.
¶ Ad cōmaūded morple? þhes hold be me nere
¶ For she wold me her the effect of my desyre.

¶ She sayd I know the cause of thy comyng.
¶ Is to vnderstand be myn enformayon.
¶ Sensyble the mater of morp lens his she wyng.
¶ As he hath the led about in besyon.
¶ Wherfore now I apply thy natural reason.
¶ Unto my wordes a or thou hens wend.
¶ Thou shalt it know begynnynge and ende.

¶ For whan Colus to pluto was broughte:
¶ By hys owne neclygence taken prysone.
¶ Wythin the erth for he so fer soughte.
¶ Sygnifyd is no more be that matere.
¶ But only to shew the how it doth appere:
¶ That welth vnbrydeled at thyne eye.
¶ Enbraleth myn frewle and oft causyth foly.

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¶ For lyke as Colus bepng at his large
¶ Strepted hymselfe thugh his own lewdenelle
¶ For he wolde deele where he had no charge
¶ Wyght soo wantons by her wylidenelle
¶ Ofte sythe bypng hymselfe in dystresse
¶ Be cause they somtyme to largely deele
¶ What may woꝝ be suffred thā ouermykell weele

¶ By Mynos the Juge of hell desperate
¶ May be vnderstonde goddys ryght wysnes
¶ That to euery wyght his payne deputate
¶ Allyneth acorþyng to his wyckednes
¶ Whertoe he is called Juge of cruelnes
¶ And as for Dyana & Neptunus compleynt
¶ Fygured may be fooles reason feynt.

¶ For lyke as they made her sugg^{er} syon
¶ To haue me Colus from cours of his kynde
¶ Whiche was Impossyble to bypng to correccyon
¶ For euermore his lyberte haue wpll the wynde
¶ In lyke wyse fooles other whyle be blynde
¶ Wenyng to subdew with her one honde
¶ That is ouermykell for all an hole londe

¶ But what foloweth therof that shall thou here
¶ When they were come to the bankete
¶ The grete Apollo with his sad chere
¶ Soo fayre & curiously gan theym entret
¶ That he made her beerdys on the new gete
¶ Soo what wysdome dooth to a foole

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Wherefore are children put to scoole

Ofte is it seen with sobre countenance
That wyle men fooles overcome ay
Cornyng as hem lyst & all her barpaunce
Chaunge from ernest in to mery play
What were they bothe amendeth that day
When they were dreuen to her wyttes ende
Were they not fayne to graunt to be his frende

Ryght soo fooles when they haue done
All that they can than be they fayne
Gyue by hed mater to oblyuone
Without rewarde they haue nomore dayne
And yet ful ofte hath hit be fayne
When they it haue forpete & let at nought
That they full dere haue afterwarde it bought

And as for all tho that represent
To be called goddys at that banket
Resemble falle ydollys but to his entent
Was Morpleus comaunded thyder the to fet
That thou sholdest know the maner & the get
Of the paynym law and of her byleue
How false ydolatry ledeth hem by the sleue

For soone bypon the worldys creacyon
When Adam and Eue had broke the precept
Whiche clerkes call the tyme of deuyacyon
The worldy people in paynym law slept

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¶ Till moyses had god the tables of stone kept
¶ In which tyme Poetes feyned many a fable
¶ To discrete Reason ryght acceptable

¶ And to the entent that they sholde founde
¶ To the eeres of hem the moze pleasantly
¶ That they sholde rede oꝛ here they gaue they a
¶ And addid names vnto they naturally (groun
¶ Of whom they spake & callid he goddis by
¶ Some for the strength & myght of her nature
¶ And some for her sotyll wyty coniecture

¶ By nature thus as the seven planettes
¶ Haue her propre names by Astronomeres
¶ But goddis were they called by olde Poetes
¶ For her gret feruency of workyng in her speres
¶ Experyence preueth this at all yeres
¶ And for as otheꝛ that goddis called be
¶ For sotyll wytte that shall feteche the

¶ How they by that hyghe name of god cam
¶ In this sayd tyme the people was so rude
¶ That what maner creature man oꝛ woman
¶ Coude ony newelte contryeue and conclude
¶ For the comon wele all the multytude
¶ Of the comon people a god sholde hym call
¶ Oꝛ a goddesse after hit was fall

¶ Of the same thyng that was so newe founde
¶ As Ceres for the crafte of tylthe fonde

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Wherby more plentouously corne dyd haboude
The people her called thurgh out euery londe
Goddesse of corne wendynge in her honde
Had layn all power of cornes habundaunce
Thus were þe Paynems deceyued by ignorance

In lyke maner Jlys was called the goddesse
Of frute for she fyrst made it multiply
By the name of grassyng & soo by proccesse
The name of Pan gan to deysse
For he fyrst founde the mene shepe to guye
Some toke it also by her condycyon
As Pluto fortune and suche other doon

Thus all that Poetes put vnder couerture
Of fable the rurall people hit toke
Properly as arte refusynge the fygyre
Whiche errour some of hem neuer forsoke
Ofte a false myrour deceyueth a mannes loke
As thou mayst dayly pryue at thynne ey
Thus were the paynems deceyued generally

That seying the dedely enemy of mankynde
By his pouer premyssyue entred the ymagys
Within the Temples to make the people blynde
In her ydolatry standynge on hyghe stages
In sonioche whos bled daungerous passagys
Any maner way by water or be londe
When hyd his sacryfyce his answere redy founde

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Thus duryng the tyme of deuycacion
From Adam to Moyses was ydolatry
Through the worlde vled in conion opynyon
These were the goddys that thou there sy
And as for the a wayters that stood hem by
They polytyke Phyllosophers & Poetes were
Whiche feyned the fables þ I speke of here

Then ceased the tyme of deuycacion
When Moyses receyued that tables of stone
Entryng the tyme of reuocacion
On the mounte of Synay stondyng allone
God gaue hym myght ayene all his sone
And then began the olde testament
Whiche to the people by Moyses was sent

And that tyme dured the Incarnacion
Of Cryste and then began it to sele
For then came the tyme of reconcyliacion
Of man to god I tell the doutlele
When the sone of man put hym in pisele
Wylfully to suffre dethe for mankynde
In holy scripture this mayst thou fynde

This Reconcyliacion was the tyme of grace
When founded was the churche vpon þ fayre stoe
And to holy Peter the keye deliuered was
Of heuen hell dyspoyled was anone
Thys was mankynde deliuered from his sone
And then began the newe testament

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¶ Whiche.iii.tymes a sondry dyuyded
¶ Mayst thou herce yt thou lyst beholde
¶ The fyrst behynde the in pycture in prouyded
¶ The seconde of the lyft honde thew pphes olde
¶ The.iii.on the ryght honde here it is to y tolde
¶ Thus hast thou in bypon the verey fygure
¶ Of there.iii.tymes here shewed in portrapture

¶ That is to say fyrst of deuyacyon
¶ From Adam to Moyles recordeyng scripture
¶ Seconde fro Moyles to the Incarnacyon
¶ Of Cryst kepeth reuocacyon cure
¶ And as for the thyrd thou mayst be verrey sure
¶ Wyl dure from thens to the worldes ende
¶ But now the.iii.must thou haue in mynde

¶ Whiche is callid pperly y tyme of pylgremage
¶ After some & some named it otherwyle
¶ And call hit the tyme of daungerous passage
¶ And some of werre that fully hit dyspyle
¶ But what so it be named I wyl the auyse
¶ Remembre it well and prynte it in thy mynde
¶ Wherof the fygure mayst thou me behynde

¶ And elles remembre thyselfe in thynne herte
¶ How Wyce & Vertue dayly theyn occupy
¶ In maner one of hem hym to peruerte
¶ Another to byng hym to endeles glory
¶ Thus they contynue fyght for the vyctory
¶ Whis no nede herof to tell the moze

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For in this short byspon þ hast seen it before

And as for Attropos greuous compleynt

Unto the goddys betokeneth noo more

But only to shew the how frendely constreint

On a stedfast herte weyeth full soze

Good wyll requyret good wyll ayene therfore

Dyscorde to deth hathe ay byn a frende

For Dyscorde bynggeth many to her ende

Wherfore Deth thought he wolde auenged be

On his frendes quarell yf that he myghte

For her gret unkyndnesse in somoche as she

Was among hem all had so in despyte

And at that bauket made of sookyte

Whiche caused hym among hē to cast in a bone

That foude they gnawynge ynough euerichone

Thus ofte is seen on frende for a nother

Wyll lay & doo and some tyme maters feyne

And also kynnyngmen a colyne or a brother

Wyll for his alpe he haue cause compleyne

And where that he loueth doo his bely payne

His frendes mater as his owne to take

Whiche oft sythe causeth mychyll sorow awake

Be hit ryght or wrong he chargeth not a myte

Ap towarde that poynt he taketh lytyll hede

So that he may haue his frowarde appetyte

Ber forned he careth not how his soule spede not

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Of God oꝛ Deuyl haue suche lypyl drede
How be it one there is that lord is of all
Whiche to euery wyght at last rewarded hall

And as foꝛ þ̄ batayl betwene Vertu holde
Soo playnly appereth to the inwardly
To make expolycyon therof new oꝛ olde
Were but superfluyte there foze refuse hit
In man shall thou fynde þ̄ were kept dayly
Lyke as þ̄ hast seen it fowtyue befoze thy face
The pycture me behynd sheweth it i lypyl space

And as foꝛ Macrocolme it is nomoze to say
But the lesse worlde to the comon entent
Whiche applyed is to man both nyght & day
Soo is man the felde to whiche all were sent
On bothe partyes & they that thyder went
Sygnifye nomoze but after the condycyon
Of euery manes opynyon

And as foꝛ the noble knygt þ̄ perseueraunce
Whiche gate the felde when it was almost gone
Betokeneth nomoze but the contynuaunce
Of vertuous lyuyng tyll dethe hath auergone
Who soo wyl doo rewarded is anone
As Vertue was with the crowne on hy
Whiche is noo moze but cuerlastyng gloꝛy

And as foꝛ þ̄ destynacyon
That eche of hem rewarded after his deserte

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¶ Is to vnderstonde nomore but dampnacyon
¶ To bycypous people is the berey scourge smert
¶ Rewarde for they fro Vertue wolde peruert
¶ And endelese Joye is to hem that be electe
¶ Rewarded & to all that folow the same secte

¶ And as for the keyes of the posternes fyue
whiche were to Morple⁹ rewarded for his labour
¶ Sygnifye not elles but whyle man is on lyue
¶ His fyue inward wyttes shall be every hour
¶ In his slepe occupied in hele & in langour
¶ With fantasyes tryfels Jullysons & dremes
¶ whiche Poetes call Morpleus stremes

¶ And as for Residuiacyon is nomore to say
¶ But after Confessyon fornyng avene to synne
¶ whiche to every man retoznyth sauns delay
¶ To bycypous lyuyng agayn hym to wyne
¶ whyle ony man lyueth wyll it neuer blynne
¶ That cursed conclusyon for to byyng aboute
¶ But Reason with Sadnes kepe it styll oute

¶ Here hast thou properly the berrey sentence
¶ Herdenow declared of this byspon
¶ The pycture also pructh clere intellygence
¶ Therof beholden with good dyscrecyon
¶ Loke well aboute and take consyderacyon
¶ As I haue declared whethyr hit soo be
¶ I syr quoth Morpleus what tolde I the

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Hast thou properly the verey sentence
Loke on yon wall ponder before
And all that tyme stood I in a wyre
In hiche way fyrst myn hert wolde peue more
To loke in a stody stood I therfore
Neuethelesse at last as Morpleus me badde
I looked forwarde with contenaunce sadde

Where I behelde in portraiture
The maner of the felde euen as it was
Shewed me before & euery creature
On bothe sydes beyng drawyng in small space
Soo carpyouly in soo lytyll a compace
In all this worlde was neuer thyng wrought
It were Impossyble merte to be thought

And when I had long beholde that pycture
What qd Morpleus how longe I halte thou loke
Daryng as a dastard on yon portraiture:
Come of for shame thy wytte stante a croke
Iheryng that myn herte to me toke
Towarde the fourthe wall toznyng my bysage
Where I sawe Poetes & Phylosophers sage

Many one moo than at the banket
Serued the goddes as I sayde before
Som were made standyng & som in chayris set
Som lokyng on bokys as they had stodyed sore
Som drawyng almenakis & in her hondis bore
Altyrlabes takyng the altytude of the sonne

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¶ Among whome Dyogenes late in a tonne

¶ And as I was lokyng on that fourthe wall

¶ Of Dyogenes beholdyng the ymage

¶ Sodeynly Doctryne began me to call

¶ And bad me tourne towarde hyt my bylage

¶ And soo then I dyde with humble corage

¶ Whan thynkest þ she sayd hast þ not thentent

¶ Yet of these fourc walles what they represent

¶ The pycture on the fyrst þ standeth at my bak

¶ Sheweth the þ present tyme of pylgremage

¶ Of whiche before I into thespake

¶ Whiche is the tyme of daungerous passage

¶ The seconde dyscretly agayne my bylage

¶ The tyme expreth of Deuyacyon

¶ Whyle paynymelawe had the domynacyon

¶ The thryd wall standyng on my lyfe þ ende

¶ The tyme representeth of Reuocacyon

¶ And the fourthe standyng on my ryght honde

¶ Determyneeth the tyme of Reconspacyon

¶ This is the effecte of thy byspon

¶ Wherfore the nedeth no more theron to muse

¶ Hit were but vayne thy wytes to dysfuse

¶ But duryng the tym of Reconspacyon

¶ Thy tyme of pylgremage loke well þ spende

¶ And then well gracys þredestynacyon

¶ Wrynge to glory at thy law ende

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¶ And euen with that came to my mynde
¶ My fyrst conclusyon that I was aboute
¶ To haue Dzeuen er slepe made me to lute

¶ That is to say how Sensualyte
¶ W Reason to acorde myght be brought aboute
¶ Whiche caused me to knele downe on my kne
¶ And beseeke Doctryne determyne that doute
¶ O lord god sayd Doctryne canst þ not withoute
¶ Me that conclusyon byng to an ende
¶ Ferre is fro the wyte & ferther good mende

¶ And euen with that Dethe gan appere
¶ Shewyng hymselfe as though that he wolde
¶ His dartte haue occupied within that herbere
¶ But there was none for hym yong nor olde
¶ Saue oonly I Doctrine hym tolde
¶ And when I herde hyr with hym comon thus
¶ I me withdrew behynde Morpleus.

¶ Dredyng full soze lest he with his dart.
¶ Through Doctrynes wordes ony entresse.
¶ In me wolde haue had or claymed ony part
¶ Whiche sholde haue caused me grete heynesse
¶ Within whiche tyme & short processe
¶ Came thyder Reason and Sensualyte.
¶ I quoth Doctryne ryght welcome be ye

¶ Hit is not long sythe we of you spake
¶ We must er ye goo determyne a doute

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¶ And euen with that ſhe the mater brake
¶ To theym & tolde hit euery where aboute
¶ I wolde haue be thens yf I had moute
¶ For fere I loked as blake as a cole
¶ I wolde haue copen in a mouſe hole

¶ What quoth Doctryne where is he now
¶ That meurd this mater ſtraunge & dyffuſe
¶ He is a coward I make myn auoyſe
¶ He hyded his hede his mocyon to reſuſe
¶ Blame hym not qd Reaſon alway ſ to ble
¶ When he ſeeth Dethe ſoo nere at his honde
¶ Pet is his part hym to withſtonde

¶ Or at the leſſe way elles fro ſym flee
¶ As longe as he may who dooth other wyſe
¶ Is an ydeote quoth Senſualyte
¶ Who dyedeth not Dethe wyſe men hym dyſpyle
¶ What ſaid Doctryne how long hathe this gyle
¶ We holden & uſed thus a tyme you twayne
¶ Ye were not wonte to ſcorde certeyne

¶ Yes quoth Reaſon in this poynt alway
¶ To euery man haue we geuen our counſayll
¶ Dethe for to flee as long as they may
¶ Although wo other wyſe haue done our trauayll
¶ Eche other to reſſelle yet withoute fayll
¶ In that poynt oonly dyſcordeth we neuer
¶ Thus condeſcended therin be we for euer

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¶ A ha sayd Doctryne then is the conclusyon
¶ Clerely determined of the gret doute
¶ That here was meuryd & halfe in deryfyon
¶ She me then called & bad me loke oute
¶ Come forth she sayd & feere not this route
¶ And euen with that Reason & Sensualyte
¶ And Bethe fro thens were banysht all thre

¶ Then lokyd I forth as Doctryne me badde
¶ When Bethe was gone me thought I was bolde
¶ To shewe myselfe but yet was I sadde
¶ Me thought my doute was not as I wolde
¶ Clerely and openly declared & tolde
¶ Hit sound to me as a parable
¶ Werke as a mythe or a fayned fable

¶ And Doctryne my concepte gan espy
¶ Wherefore sayd she standest thou soo styll
¶ wherein is thy thought arte thou in stody
¶ Of thy questyon hast thou not thy fyl
¶ To the declared tell me thy wyll
¶ Herdest thou not Reason & Sensualyte
¶ Declared thy doute here before the

¶ Forsothe quoth I. I herde what they sayde
¶ But neuerthelesse my wytt is so thynne
¶ And also of Bethe I was so afrayde
¶ That hit is out where hit bent ynne
¶ And so that mater can I not wynne
¶ Without your helpe & benpuolence

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Therof to expresse the betray sentence

Well quod Doctryne then yeue attendaunce

Unto my wordes & thou shalt here

Openly declared the concordance

Atwene Sensualyte & Reason in fere

If thou take hede hit clerely dooth apere

How they were knette in one oppynon

Bothe agayn Bethe helde contradycon

Whiche concordance nomoze sygnifyeth

To playne vnderstandyng but in euery mane

Bothe Sensualyte & Reason applyeth

Either Bethe to flee then with hit to be tane

Loom that poynt accorde they holly thane

And in all other they clerely dyscorde

Thus is trewly set thy doubtfull monacorde

Iherpyng that kneled on my kne

And thanked her lowly for her dyscyplyne

That she wouchelafe of her benygnyte

Of tho gret doubtles me to enlumyne

Well was he worthy to be called Doctryne

If it had be nomoze but for the solucyon

Of my demaunde & of this straunge dysyon

And as I with myne hede began for to bow

As me well ought to do her reuerence

She thens departed I can not tell how

But within a moment gone was she thens

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¶ Then sayd Morpleus let vs go hens
¶ What I holde we here tarpe lengere
¶ Hast thou not herde a generall answere

¶ To all thy materes that thou lyst to meue
¶ My tyme draweth nere that I must rest
¶ And euen therwith he toke me by the sleue
¶ And sayd goo we hens for that I holde I best
¶ As good is ynough as a grete fest
¶ Thou hast seen ynough holde the content
¶ And euen with þ forthe with hym I went

¶ Till he had me brought agene to my bedde
¶ Where he me founde and then pryncely
¶ He stalle awaye I coude not vnderstande
¶ Were he became but sodaynly
¶ As he came he went I tell you verily
¶ Whiche done fro slepe I gan to awake
¶ My body all in swet began for to shake

¶ For drede of the syght that I had sene
¶ Wenyng to me all had be trewe
¶ Actuelly done where I had bene
¶ That batyll holde twene Wyce & Vertue
¶ But when I see hit hit was but a whew
¶ A dreame a fantasie & a thyng of nought
¶ To study thereon I had nomore thought

¶ Till at the last I gan me bethynke
¶ For what cause shewed was this byspon

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¶ I know not wherfore I toke pen & ynke
¶ And paper therof to make mencyon
¶ In wrytyng takyng consyderacyon
¶ That noo defaute were found in me
¶ Wheron accused I ought for to be

¶ For slouth that I had lest hit bntolde
¶ Neyther by mouthe nor in remembraunce
¶ Put it in wrytyng where thourgh manyfolde
¶ Wayes of accusacio myght forne me to greuaunce
¶ All this I sawe as I lay in a traunce
¶ But wheder it was with myne ey bodely
¶ Or not in certayn god knoweth & not I

¶ That to dyscerne I purpose not to dele
¶ Soo large by my wyll it longeth not to me
¶ Were hit dreine or byspon for your owne wele
¶ All that shall hit rede here rad or se
¶ Take therof the best & let the worst be
¶ Try out the corne clene from the chaff
¶ And then may ye say ye haue a sure staff

¶ To stande by at nede of ye wyll it holde
¶ And walke by the way of Vertue
¶ But al wey beware be ye yong or olde
¶ That your frewyll ay to Vertue more
¶ Apply than to Wyce the easer may be bore
¶ The burden of the felde that ye dayly fyght
¶ Agayn your .iii. enemyes for all her gret myght

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That is to say the Deuyll & the Fleſhe
And alſo the worlde with hys gloſyng there
Whiche on you loketh euer newe & freſhe
But he is not as he dooth apere
Loke ye kepe you ay out of hys daungere
And ſoo the byctory ſhall ye obteyne
Upre fro you exyled & Vertue in you reyne

And then ſhall ye haue the trūphall guerdon
That god reſerued to euery creature
Aboue in hys celeftyall manſyon
Joye & blyſſe in ſynpte eternally to endure
Wherof we ſay we wolde fayne be ſure
But the way thyderwarde to holde be we lothe
That oft ſythe cauſeth þ good lord to be wrothe

And by our deſerte our habytacyon chaūgeth
Fro Joye to payne & woo perpetuelly
From hys glorious ſyght thus he vs eſtraūgeth
For our bycrous luyng thorough our owne folly
Wherfore let vs praye to that lord of glory
Whyle we in erthe be þ he wyl proue vs grace
So vs here to guyde that we may haue a place

Accordyng to oure Regeneracyon
Which heuently ſpyrtes his name to magnify.
Whiche downe deſcendeth for oure redempcyon
Offeryng hymſelfe on the croſſe to his ſad on hy
Now benygne Jeſu that bozen was of Mary
All that to this byſyon haue gyue her audyence

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E Braunte eternal Joye after thy last sentence

A M E

Here endeth a lityll Treatyse
named The assemble of geddes



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